

THINK COLLEGE NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

Annual Report on the Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities

Year 3 (2012–2013)



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Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities,
Year 3 (2012–2013)

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Office of Postsecondary Education





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DISCLOSURE OF POTENTIAL CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

The research team for this report consists of key staff from the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston. The organizations and the key staff members do not have financial interests that could be affected by findings from the evaluation.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Higher Education Act as amended in the Higher Education Opportunities Act contained several provisions aimed at increasing access to higher education for youth and adults with intellectual disabilities (ID). One outcome of these provisions was the appropriation of \$10.6 million by Congress to create a model demonstration program aimed at developing inclusive higher education options for people with ID.

In 2010, the Transition Postsecondary Education Program for Students with Intellectual Disability, or TPSID, model demonstration program was implemented by the Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE), which awarded five-year grants to 27 institutes of higher education (IHEs). These IHEs were tasked with creating, expanding, or enhancing high-quality, inclusive higher education experiences to support positive outcomes for individuals with ID.

Congress also appropriated \$330,000 for the establishment of a national coordinating center for the TPSID program. OPE awarded the TPSID National Coordinating Center (NCC) to the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston in October 2010. The mission of the NCC is to provide technical assistance to IHEs that offer comprehensive transition and postsecondary programs for students with ID. The NCC also evaluates the TPSID projects, creates recommended standards for programs, and builds a valid and reliable knowledge base around program components.

This Year Three Report describes the types of colleges that received TPSID grants, characteristics of attending students, and detailed information about academic access, employment and career development, campus membership, and program elements that supported self-determination, such as person-centered planning. The report also details the TPSID programs' efforts at collaborating with internal and external partners, the extent to which the TPSID programs are integrated into the existing policies and practices of the college, efforts aimed at sustaining these programs, and evaluation strategies employed by the TPSID programs beyond those used by the NCC.

Additionally, the report addresses changes in each of these areas over time, as well as qualitative insights derived from program personnel about critical features and challenges of implementing a TPSID program within a college or university.

PRIMARY FINDINGS OF THE YEAR THREE REPORT

DEMOGRAPHICS

Year Three of the Transition Postsecondary Program for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSID) program commenced on October 1, 2012 and projects were implemented on 44 college or university campuses in 23 states. In 2012–2013, 15 programs operated on single college campuses and 12 operated as consortia, with various satellite college campuses. Fifteen of these sites were located at two-year Institutes of Higher Education (IHEs) and 29 sites were located at four-year IHEs.

Overall, 838 students attended the 44 TPSID programs in Year Three, for an average of 19 students per site. As of July 2013, ten TPSID sites had been approved as a Comprehensive Transition Program and were able to offer eligible students access to certain forms of Title IV student aid. In the 2012–2013 school year, 838 students attended TPSID programs; of these, 429 students were newly enrolled, 284 had entered the TPSID program in 2011–2012, and 121 students had entered in 2010–2011. The remaining 4 students were returning students for whom year of program entry was unknown because they were from student data reported at the aggregate level.

In 2012–2013, 59% of students were male and 41% female¹. The majority of students were white (73%), 16% were black or African American, and 11% were Hispanic or Latino. Over ninety percent of students were between the ages of 18 and 25, and 95% of enrolled students had an intellectual disability and/or autism. Just under a quarter of students (22%) were dually enrolled, i.e., receiving special education transition services from a public school system while attending the TPSID program.

ACADEMIC ACCESS

In Year Three, course enrollment information was reported for 733 of the 838 students who attended TPSID programs. These 733 students enrolled in a total of 5,584 college or university courses. This is an average of 8 courses per student taking courses per year.² Students at two-year IHEs took an average of seven courses, while those at four-year IHEs took an average of nine courses a year. A majority of course enrollments (58%) were in academically specialized courses, i.e., courses designed for and delivered to only students with ID in the TPSID. The remaining 42% were in academically inclusive courses, i.e., typical college courses attended by students with an ID and other college students. The percentage of enrollments in inclusive courses was higher at two-year IHEs than at four-year IHEs.

The most common accommodations were academic supports such as note-takers and readers. Students also received enrollment accommodations, such as modified course loads, substitutes for required courses, and priority registration, as well as academic accommodations, such as access to professors' notes, advance access to materials, and alternative test formats. A majority of students attending TPSIDs (71%) were seeking a credential in 2012–2013. A majority (84%) of TPSID programs use peer mentors to provide academic supports to students in the programs.

CAREER DEVELOPMENT AND EMPLOYMENT

Of the 838 students attending TPSID programs in 2012–2013, 298 (36%) held a total of 424 paid jobs. One hundred twenty-seven of students with paid jobs had two or more paid jobs in Year Three. Thirty-five of these jobs (9%) were those that the student also worked in during Year One, and 134 (32%) were jobs the student worked in during Year Two. Forty-two percent of students employed in Year Three had never held a paid job prior to entering the TPSID.

¹ Omits data reported at the aggregate level

² Some students did not take any courses because they were in a stage of their program where the focus was not on academics, but rather on employment and career development. Therefore, course enrollment data were not reported for some students.

Individual paid jobs accounted for 192 of the paid jobs held by students (45%), and paid internships (credit and non-credit) accounted for 22%. Eighty-two percent of jobs paid at or above minimum wage. In Year Three, 73% of students participated in career development activities, including paid employment, internships or other paid or unpaid career development activities. Length of student attendance impacted rates of employment, the longer students attended, the more likely they were to be employed. Challenges to engaging in paid employment included lack of preparation and career assessment prior to students entering their college program as well as a lack of staff knowledge and training about state-of-the-art customized and integrated employment practices.

SELF-DETERMINATION

In Year Three of the program, person-centered planning was used in 98% of TPSIDs. Students sought academic advising from existing academic advising offices in 52% of TPSIDs, and 48% (n=21) used only a separate advising system specially designed for students who attend the TPSID.

Common motivations for students to enroll in coursework were that the course: a) was required for the TPSID credential (60% of course enrollments), was related to the student's career goals (53%) or related to a personal interest (41%), or was required for a degree or certificate (31%). Year Three saw more students taking courses because they were related to their career goals (53% of enrollments) than in Year One (44%) and Year Two (39%). A majority of TPSIDs (55%) offered students' families information about IHE-related issues such as social activities (77%), IHE code of conduct (77%), disability-related services available at the IHE (73%), FERPA (66%), non-disability-related services (64%), and financial aid (59%).

CAMPUS MEMBERSHIP

In 2012–2013, every TPSID reported facilitating or supporting student participation in campus social activities including attending events on campus, going out with friends, and attending or participating in sporting events. Some students participated independently; others received support from TPSID staff or peer mentors. A small minority (8.9%) of students was reported as not participating in any social activities. Addressing some of the inherent risks of college life, such as drinking and sexual behavior, posed challenges to promoting independence and campus participation in some of the TPSIDs.

In 2012–2013, half of TPSIDs (50%) were being implemented at IHEs that did not provide housing to any students. Of those TPSIDs located at IHEs that did offer housing, 14 provided students in the TPSID access to that housing, and eight did not. Most of the 162 students living in TPSID- or IHE-provided housing lived in residence halls or off-campus apartments where most residents were other students attending the college. Just under half of those living off-campus (but not with their families) lived independently, with another quarter in supervised living settings. Students who lived in TPSID or IHE housing generally had higher levels of participation in social activities.

EXITING STUDENTS

A total of 297 students exited their TPSID program in Year Three. The most common reason for exit was having completed the program and earned a credential (52%). Overall, 60% of the students who exited earned one or more credentials before exiting. Students who exited programs at two-year IHEs were slightly more likely to have earned a credential than students who exited programs at four-year IHEs (63% versus 56%). A certificate specifically for students in the TPSID program granted by the IHE was the most common credential at both two-year and four-year IHEs.

Over half of the students who exited in Year Three (57%) were reported as having a paid job, participating in unpaid career development activities, or doing both at the time they exited. At exit, 65 students were working in a paid job, and 133 participated in some sort of unpaid career development activities. Twenty-nine students were both employed

for pay and participating in unpaid career development activities when they exited their program. Students who were dually enrolled (in high school and college) were more likely to exit their program with a paid job than students who were enrolled as an adult student for part or all of the time they attended the TPSID.

EVALUATION

Each TPSID, in addition to using the NCC evaluation system, created its own mechanisms for self-assessment. The evaluation tools used by TPSIDs included assessment of students' academic and career interests and progress, goal attainment, and self-determination. TPSIDs regularly sought feedback from students, faculty, peer mentors, family members, TPSID staff, and employers of students via interviews and meetings. Thirty six percent of TPSIDs also collected follow-up data on students who exited the program, which is an increase from Years 1 and 2.

ALIGNMENT WITH COLLEGE SYSTEMS AND PRACTICES

In Year Three, TPSID programs followed the academic calendar used by the IHE at 93% of the reporting TPSIDs (N=44). The majority (98%) indicated that they held students to the IHE's code of conduct, and 91% issued students college or university ID cards. Eighty-four percent issued students a transcript. Almost two thirds of programs issued regular transcripts. Sixty percent of TPSIDs stated that students accessed all campus resources that were listed as options in the evaluation system. The most commonly accessed resources were the student center, dining hall, bookstore, and library. Consistent growth has been seen in the percentage of campuses at which students use career and tutoring services over the first three years of the program.

COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION

The 44 participating TPSIDs partnered with 236 external organizations. The most common external partnerships in Year Three were with local education agencies (LEAs), vocational rehabilitation (VR) agencies, and state IDD services agencies, with over half of the TPSIDs partnering with these organizations. The three most common partner roles were participating in a project advisory committee, conducting recruitment or outreach, and providing services directly to students. The percentage of TPSIDs partnering with employers increased from 29% in Year One to 43% in Year Three. Staff from 84% of TPSIDs participated in professional development from their IHE and 82% had staff that participated in professional development provided by an entity external to the IHE.

SUSTAINABILITY

In Year Three, 93% of TPSIDs received financial support from external sources such as State VR agencies, and state IDD services agencies. In 15 of the 28 instances where VR agencies partnered with TPSIDs, the agency provided funds for student tuition. For tuition and non-tuition expenses, private pay (i.e., personal funds) was the option most commonly used. Tuitions were waived for various reasons for 14% of students. Ten TPSIDs were approved Comprehensive Transition Programs (CTPs), and could offer eligible students access to certain forms of federal student aid. Pell Grants were the most common form of federal student aid. Annual costs varied widely ranging from no cost at all to \$51,000, and depended upon the type of institution (two-year or four-year) and whether the IHE charges were residency-dependent, e.g. in-state, out-of-state, city resident, etc.

The TPSID programs described here have provided an unprecedented opportunity for 838 students with ID to access college courses, participate in internships and integrated competitive employment, and engage in the same social and personal development activities that other college students enjoy throughout the country.



INTRODUCTION

In the 21st century, going to college is becoming a minimum requirement for getting a good job and succeeding in the workforce. College and career readiness is now the driving force behind school improvement efforts such as the Common Core State Standards Initiative (ACT, 2010) and college access and completion initiatives are consistently part of the research and funding agenda of the Department of Education. Higher education is frequently seen as a pathway toward better employment outcomes and better life outcomes.

However, up until recently these research practice and funding initiatives focused primarily on certain groups; those students who come from disadvantaged populations, or first generation college students or those who may face challenges in adequate preparation or and access to higher education. These efforts were not directed at increasing access to higher education for students who were the least likely to be prepared for or to gain access to colleges or universities in the untitled states, people with intellectual disabilities.

Students with intellectual disabilities have the least inclusive educational experiences, the lowest levels of academic achievement, and the fewest postsecondary education goals reflected on their transition plans (Grigal, Hart, & Migliore, 2011; Newman, Wagner, Cameto, Knokey, & Shaver, 2010). Only 11% of high-school students with ID have the goal of attending a two-year or four-year college in their education plan (Grigal, Hart, & Migliore, 2011).

Subsequently, students with ID also have the poorest college access and employment outcomes of all disability groups (Windsor & Butterworth, 2007; Newman, Wagner, Cameto, & Knokey, 2009). The lack of opportunity to prepare or plan for higher education or meaningful paid work, leads to long-term inadequacy and inequality in these students' education and employment outcomes.

Most students with ID exit high school and enter into a lifetime of sheltered employment earning subminimum wage or day habilitation (Gidugu & Rogers, 2012; Siperstien, Parker, & Drascher, 2013). A recent survey of 11,599 adults with ID in 16 states found that only 14.7% were competitively employed (HSRI, 2012). In 2011, the employment rate for transition-aged individuals with ID/A (ages 16-21) was 18%—less than half the employment rate for transition-aged students without disabilities (Butterworth et al., 2013). This inequity becomes worse as people with ID/A age. Only 32% of adults between the ages of 20 and 30 are employed, compared to 74% of those without disabilities (Sulewski, Zalewska, Butterworth, & Migliore, 2013).

In response to these deplorable outcomes, when the Higher Education Act was reauthorized in 2008, it contained several new provisions aimed at increasing access to higher education for youth and adults with ID. To address these provisions, Congress appropriated \$10.6 million for creation of a new model demonstration program via the Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) (Duncan, 2010).

In 2010, the Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) awarded grants to 27 institutes of higher education (IHEs) to fund model demonstration projects. These are referred to as Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSIDs). The goal of the TPSID program is to create, expand, or enhance high-quality, inclusive higher education experiences to support positive outcomes for individuals with ID.

The OPE also awarded a TPSID National Coordinating Center (NCC) grant to the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston. Among the responsibilities of the TPSID NCC was the development of a valid and reliable evaluation framework for the TPSID programs. This Year Three Report provides an overview of the evaluation framework and a comprehensive look at critical components of the TPSID program throughout the U.S. in the 2012–2013 academic year, the third year the program was funded.

The report describes the types of colleges that received TPSID grants, characteristics of attending students, and detailed information about academic access, employment and career development, campus membership, and program elements that supported self-determination, such as person-centered planning. The report also details the TPSID programs' efforts at collaborating with internal and external partners, the extent to which the TPSID programs are integrated into the existing policies and practices of the college, efforts aimed at sustaining these programs, and evaluation strategies employed by the TPSID programs beyond those used by the NCC.

Additionally, the report addresses changes in each of these areas over time, as well as qualitative insights derived from program personnel about critical features and challenges of implementing a TPSID program at a college or university.

METHOD

The NCC was charged with development and implementation of a valid and reliable evaluation framework to evaluate the overall TPSID program. Work commenced with a comprehensive review of each TPSID grant application to determine the common measures and terminology that would best reflect the various programs. NCC staff also reviewed online data management tools to ensure that the platform chosen for the evaluation system would be both reliable and flexible meeting the needs of the NCC and the TPSID users. We selected a management system that provided TPSID personnel with ease of access and use.

Tool Development. A draft evaluation tool was developed reflecting the Government Performance and Results Act (GPRA) measures that TPSID grant recipients were expected to report on and were aligned with the Think College Standards for Inclusive Postsecondary Education (Grigal, Hart, & Weir, 2012). In February 2011, draft versions of the tool were shared with all TPSID Principal Investigators to gather input on clarity of questions, adequacy of response options, and comprehensiveness of the variables. The extensive comments received from TPSID personnel were reviewed in detail by project staff in March 2011 and incorporated into the second version of the tool. This tool was then programmed into a secure online database using software purchased from Intuit Quickbase (quickbase.intuit.com).

From May through August 2011, the online evaluation system was piloted in three waves of nine sites each, and further feedback on content as well as function was obtained and a third version of the tool was created. The resulting tool was submitted in August 2011 to the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) for approval under the Paperwork Reduction Act (44 U.S.C. 3501). After extensive feedback and revision, the OMB approved the evaluation tool in July 2012. Upon receipt of this approval, NCC staff made the required modifications to the tool and the system as deemed necessary by the OMB. The evaluation system was then made available to the TPSIDs for ongoing data entry starting in August 2012. The findings of years 1 and 2 were summarized in the previous annual report, *Think College National Coordinating Center: Annual report on the transition and postsecondary programs for students with intellectual disabilities*, which is available on the www.thinkcollege.net website.

Quantitative Data Collection. Data for this Year Three report was entered by TPSID personnel between October 2012 and August 2013. TPSID program staff entered data into the system for the third year of implementation (2012–2013). Various TPSID personnel entered data into the system, including Principal Investigators, program staff, administrative staff, student interns, graduate assistants, and external evaluators.

After TPSIDs indicated data entry was complete, NCC staff conducted cleaning and verification of all data entered. The system has many validation rules built into data collection forms to ensure data entry is accurate at the point of entry. For situations where automatic validation was not possible, e.g., number of courses taken by students, number of program partners and staff, NCC staff members developed reports summarizing data entered and asked TPSIDs to review these reports to ensure data entry was complete.

Qualitative Data Collection. As part of its qualitative evaluation activities, on July 8, 2013, NCC staff conducted focus groups with TPSID grantees to gain input and perspectives on critical program areas. This activity consisted of four focus groups with a total of 50 participants. All participants were project directors or other staff of TPSID programs. The focus groups lasted one hour and took place in person, in a meeting room at the site of the annual TPSID project directors' meeting.

Each of the focus groups had a particular topical focus: (1) accessing and succeeding in inclusive courses, (2) facilitators and barriers to employment, (3) campus membership, and (4) planning and advising activities. A protocol was provided to each focus group facilitator outlining how to introduce the activity to all participants and outlining guiding questions for

each topical focus group. Each group was recorded on a digital audio recorder. Each focus group was guided by a protocol with questions tailored to the focus group's particular topic. The focus group recordings were transcribed by an ICI staff member for qualitative analysis.

Qualitative analysis consisted of coding and memo writing. Coding is an early and ongoing way of labeling data to sort it and assign meaning (Miles & Huberman, 1994). Operational definitions for each code were developed to ensure that all members of the research team have a shared understanding of the code. The definitions describe the codes as the cases emerge. A qualitative software program (Atlas.ti for the PC) was used to conceptualize themes, store coded transcripts, and sort data. The researchers coded and analyzed the data, comparing specific passages, improve the team's understanding of the data, and explore the similarities and differences between participant experiences (Charmaz, 2000).

Once all transcripts were coded, findings were organized into themes. The themes that emerged from the focus groups included Employment Barriers, Employment Strategies, Balancing Independence and Related Risks, Course Registration, Person-Centered Planning, Family/Parents, and Campus Partnerships. Relevant findings from the focus groups are incorporated into corresponding sections of this report.

TPSID PROGRAM, YEAR THREE: 2012–2013

Year Three of the TPSID program commenced on October 1, 2012 and projects were implemented in 23 states. In 2012–2013, 15 programs operated on single college campuses and 12 operated as consortia, with satellite college campuses. In total, TPSIDs comprised 27 model demonstration projects being implemented on 44 college or university campuses. Fifteen of these sites were located at two-year IHEs and 29 sites were located at four-year IHEs.

Twenty-nine of the 44 IHEs implementing a TPSID Project had previously supported students with intellectual disability (ID) in a program prior to receiving the TPSID grant. The remaining 15 programs were at IHEs that did not serve students with ID prior to receiving the TPSID grant. Programs at two-year IHEs were more likely to have served students with ID prior to receiving TPSID grant funding than four-year IHEs (73% versus 62%).

Three sites began serving students in Year Three. The first new site was Vincennes University Jasper Campus which was affiliated with the TPSID at Indiana University Purdue University Indianapolis. The second new site at Western Piedmont Community College was affiliated with the TPSID at Western Carolina University. Finally, Hawaii Community College, affiliated with the University of Hawaii at Manoa TPSID program, was in a planning year in Year Two and began serving students in Year Three. One site that had served students stopped participating as a TPSID satellite campus prior to Year Three.

In addition to establishing the TPSID model demonstration program, the Higher Education Opportunities Act (HEOA) also created a new type of Title IV federal student aid program called a Comprehensive Transition Program (CTP). CTPs allow approved IHEs to provide eligible students with intellectual disability access to certain forms of federal student aid.

The CTP approval process is coordinated by the Office of Federal Student Aid and is separate from the TPSID Program that is overseen by the Office of Postsecondary Education. As of July 2013, ten TPSID sites had been approved as a CTP. Only approved CTPs are able to offer federal student aid (e.g., Pell Grants, Supplemental Education Opportunity Grants, work-study) to students with ID. Therefore, students with ID who are attending TPSIDs that are not approved CTPs are unable to use federal financial aid to help pay for college.

TPSID sites that were approved Comprehensive Transition Programs

- | | |
|--|---|
| » Appalachian State University | » Monroe Community College |
| » California State University, Fresno | » Taft College |
| » Camden County College | » The College of New Jersey |
| » College of Charleston | » University of California Los Angeles |
| » Kent State University | » Western Carolina University |

FSA provides an updated list of approved programs: <https://studentaid.ed.gov/eligibility/intellectual-disabilities>

Overall, 838 students attended the 44 TPSID programs in Year Three, for an average of 19 students per site. An overview of student enrollments at TPSID sites appears in Table 1 and the complete list of campuses serving students appears in Table 2.

TABLE 1. STUDENT ENROLLMENTS IN YEAR THREE BY PROGRAM ATTRIBUTES

	Number of sites in Year 3	Mean # of students per site
All programs	44	19
Served students with ID prior to TPSID Program	29	23
Did not serve students with ID prior to TPSID Program	15	11
Two-year IHE	15	26
Four-year IHE	29	16

TRANSITION AND POSTSECONDARY PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH INTELLECTUAL DISABILITIES GRANTEES

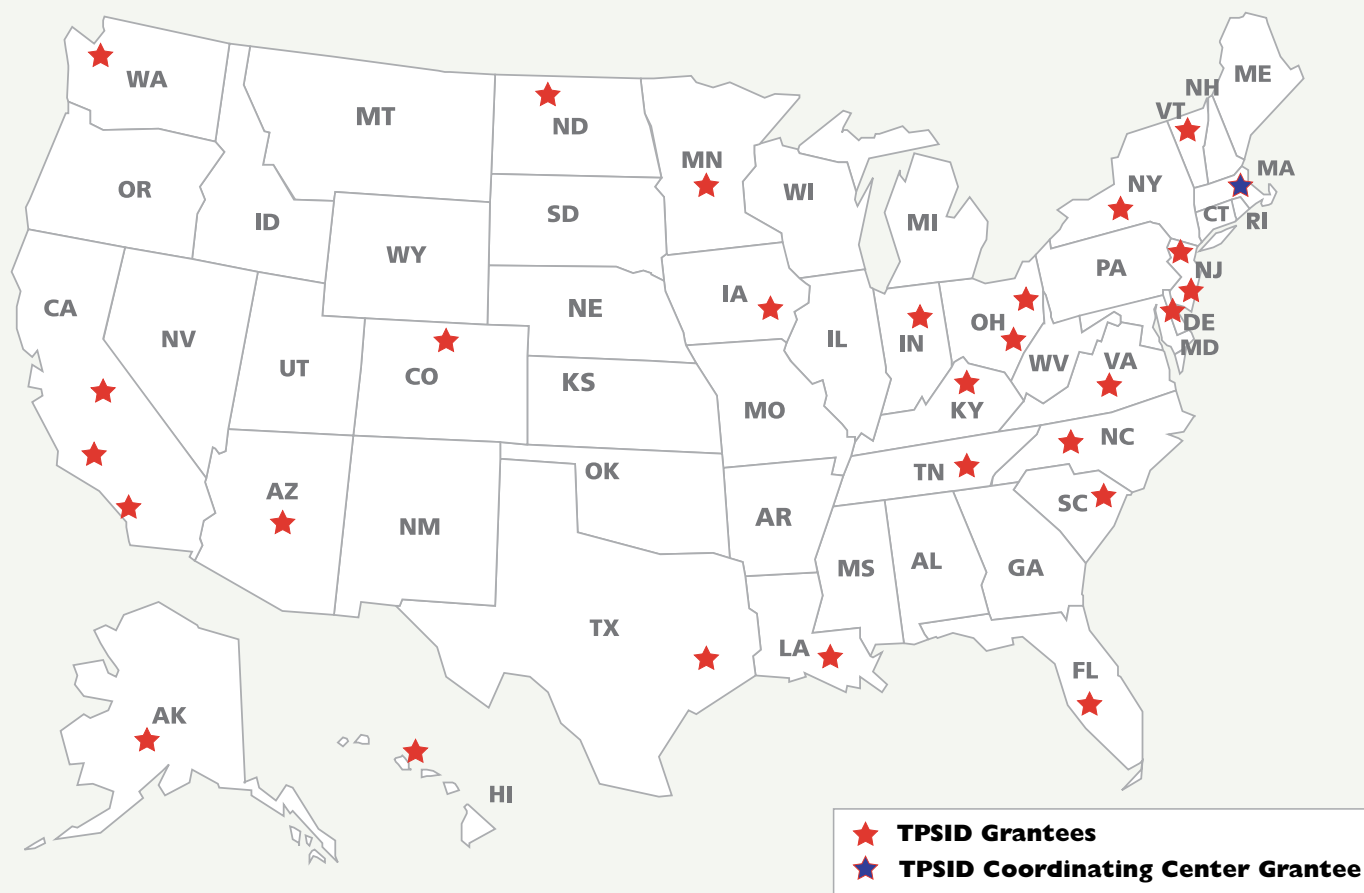


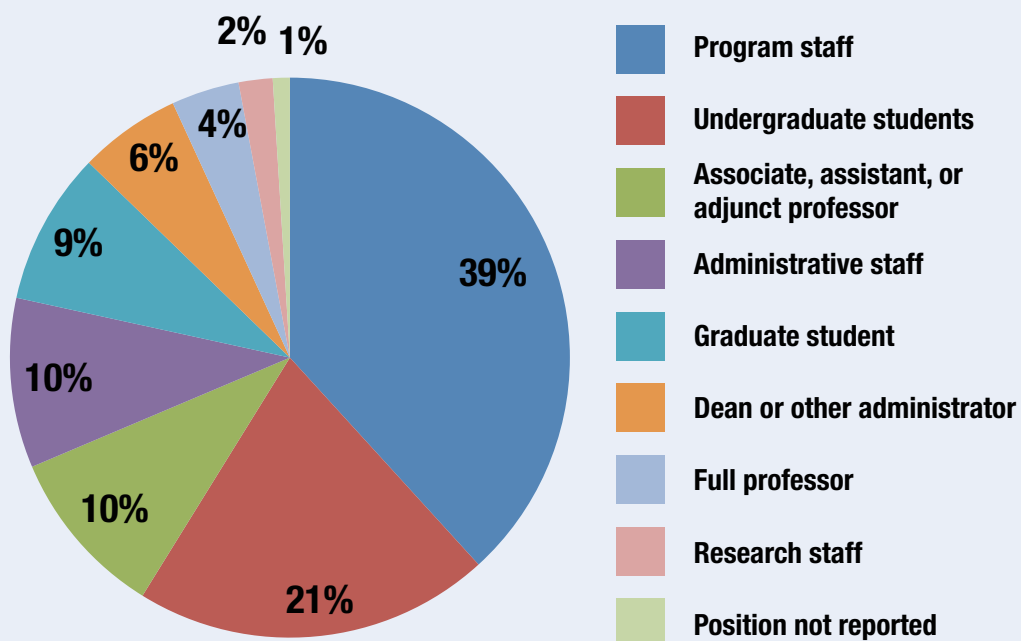
TABLE 2. CAMPUSES OPERATING A TPSID PROGRAM IN 2012–2013

Programs operating on a single campus	Programs operating as a consortium
California State University, Fresno	Bergen Community College (NJ)*: Camden County College
College of Charleston (SC)	Central Lakes College (MN)*: Ridgewater College
College of New Jersey	Colorado State University*: Front Range Community College
Highline Community College (WA)	Houston Community College (TX) *: HCC Central, HCC Northwest (Spring Branch)
Kent State University (OH)	Indiana University Purdue University Indianapolis (IN) *: Vincennes University Jasper Campus (VUJC)
Louisiana State University Health Sciences Center - Delgado Community College	Ohio State University*: University of Toledo
Minot State University (ND)	University of Hawaii at Manoa*: Hawaii Community College, Honolulu Community College
Taft College (CA)	University of Kentucky*: Northern Kentucky University
The University of Arizona	University of Rochester (NY) *: Keuka College, Monroe Community College, Roberts Wesleyan College
UCLA (CA)	University of South Florida St. Petersburg*: Lynn University, University of North Florida
University of Alaska Anchorage	University of Vermont*: Johnson State College
University of Delaware	Western Carolina University (NC) *: Alamance Community College, Appalachian State University, Western Piedmont Community College
University of Iowa	
University of Tennessee	
Virginia Commonwealth University	

*Indicates TPSID Lead Applicant for programs operating as a consortium

A total of 402 staff worked for the 39 programs that reported staff info in Year Three (Figure 1). Program staff and undergraduate students, who were often paid to provide supports to students in the TPSID, were the most common positions. More than half of the staff worked no more than 25% of full-time equivalent, indicating that TPSIDs rely heavily on part-time employees.

FIGURE 1: TPSID STAFF BY JOB TYPE IN YEAR THREE (N=402 STAFF AT 39 SITES)



OVERVIEW OF STUDENT CHARACTERISTICS

STUDENT DEMOGRAPHICS

In the 2012–2013 school year, 838 students attended TPSID programs across the 44 sites. Eight hundred twenty-one student records were collected from campuses that report student data at the individual level and the remaining 17 student records were collected from a campus that reports student data at the aggregate level. Of these, 429 students were newly enrolled, 284 had entered the TPSID program in 2011–2012, and 121 students had entered in 2010–2011. The remaining 4 students were returning students for whom year of program entry was unknown because they were from student data reported at the aggregate level. In 2012–2013, 59% of students were male and 41% female.³ As shown in Table 3, the majority of students were white (74%), 16% were black or African American, and 10% were Hispanic or Latino.

Programs at two-year IHEs had a higher proportion of minority students (see Table 3) and of Hispanic or Latino students (14% vs. 6%). The higher representation of minority racial and ethnic groups at two-year IHEs is consistent with Fall 2012 enrollees in the United States college population as a whole (U.S. Department of Education, 2013).

Both women and minorities continued to be less present in TPSID programs than in the general college population, in which 57% were female, 42% were non-white, and 14% were Hispanic in 2012 (U.S. Department of Education, 2013). The lower percentage of women in TPSID programs may be due to the fact that there are fewer females who are diagnosed with ID, resulting in a lower number of potential female TPSID students. Research studies have shown that approximately 30% more males are diagnosed with ID in the United States than females (Kaufman, Ayub, & Vincent, 2010).

Students’ ages ranged from 17 to 60, with a median age of 20. The majority (over 90%) of students were between the ages of 18 and 25, a typical age range for college students.

TABLE 3. RACE OF PARTICIPATING STUDENTS, 2012–2013, BY TYPE OF IHE				
	Number	Percent	2-year	4-year
White	620	74%	65%	84%
Black or African American	137	16%	22%	12%
Asian	38	5%	7%	3%
American Indian or Alaska Native	9	1%	2%	1%
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	11	1%	2%	1%
Unknown	39	5%	5%	4%

DISABILITY

The most common disabilities reported for students attending TPSID programs in 2012–2013 in order of prevalence were intellectual disability, autism, other health impairment, and specific learning disability (Table 4), with students with ID the overwhelming majority (89%). Ninety-five percent of enrolled students had an intellectual disability and/or autism. The majority of students had more than one reported disability, and 26% had three or more disabilities.

Among the 104 students not identified as having an intellectual disability, the most common disabilities were autism (52 students), specific learning disability (13 students), speech or language impairment (12 students), and traumatic brain injury (10 students).¹ As noted by Folk, Yamamoto, and Stodden (2012), it can be challenging for TPSIDs to identify

⁴ Omits data reported at the aggregate level

or document students’ disabilities due to factors such as parents’ reluctance to label their children and schools’ use of alternative classifications.

TABLE 4. MOST COMMON STUDENT DISABILITIES, 2012–2013

	Number	Percent	Percent by school type	
			2-year	4-year
Intellectual disability	749	89%	94%	85%
Autism	210	25%	27%	24%
Other health impairment	135	16%	14%	18%
Specific learning disability	126	15%	18%	12%
Speech or language impairment	121	14%		
Developmental delay	117	14%	9%	19%

PREVIOUS EDUCATIONAL SETTING

When asked to describe students’ previous educational setting, respondents indicated that the majority of students had been partially included in general education while in high school (Table 5). Partial inclusion ranged from being in a segregated classroom most of the time and taking one or two general education classes, such as physical education or art, to being included in general education most of the time.

One fifth of the students had not been included in any general education classes in their previous setting, demonstrating that a substantial portion of students with ID remain completely segregated in their high school.

TABLE 5. EDUCATIONAL SETTING WHILE IN HIGH SCHOOL

	Number	Percent
Fully included in general education curriculum in general education classes	128	16%
Spent part of their time in general education and part in special education	462	55%
Not included in general education curriculum or classes/only in special education classes (e.g., life skills)	180	21%
Don't know	49	6%
Other*	19	2%

*“Other” responses include: home-schooled, private school

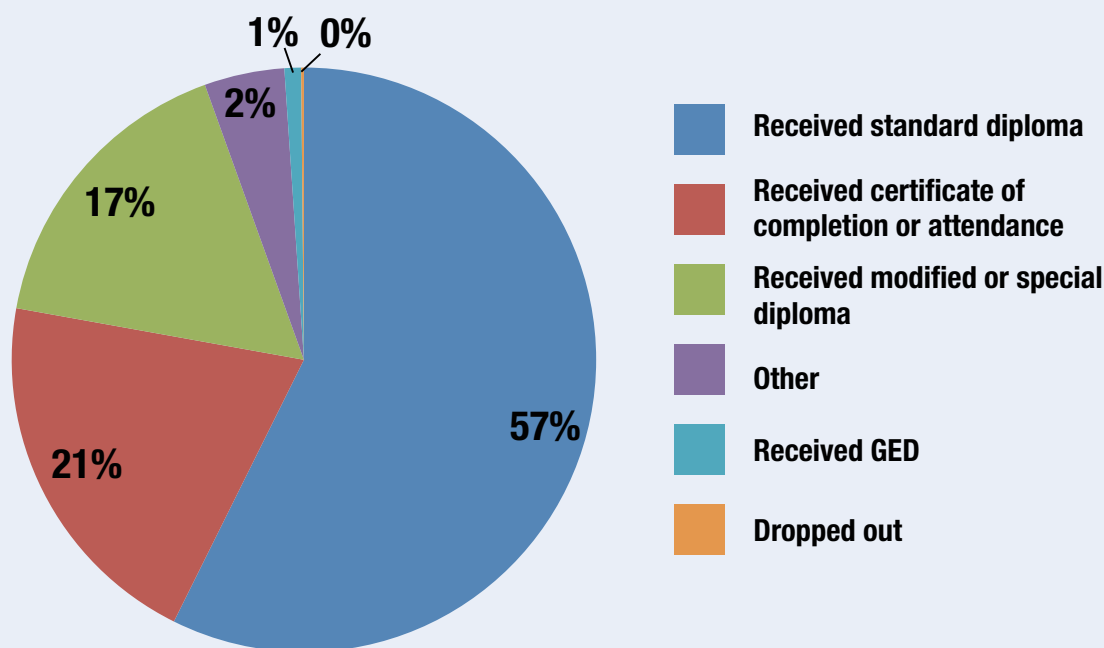
STUDENT STATUS

Just under a quarter of students (22%) were dually enrolled, i.e., receiving special education transition services from a public school system while attending the TPSID program. Students at two-year IHEs were much less likely to be dually enrolled than those at four-year IHEs (10% vs. 32%).

Of the remaining 78% of adult students i.e., who were no longer in high school, most received a standard diploma (Figure 2). Various types of diplomas and certificates are used as evidence that a student has completed secondary education. Graduation requirements and diploma options vary from state to state and district to district. Some of these diplomas and certificates are just for students receiving special education services. Some states only use a standard diploma available to all students, including students with disabilities (e.g., New Jersey, Ohio, South Carolina, and Texas). Some states have

tests that students must pass to earn a diploma, while others do not (Urbina, 2010; Thurlow et al., 2008; Johnson, Thurlow, & Stout, 2007). As a result, the data on the number of students who received a standard diploma should be interpreted with caution.

FIGURE 2: STATUS OF STUDENTS NO LONGER IN HIGH SCHOOL, 2012–2013 (N=639)



STUDENT CHARACTERISTIC TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

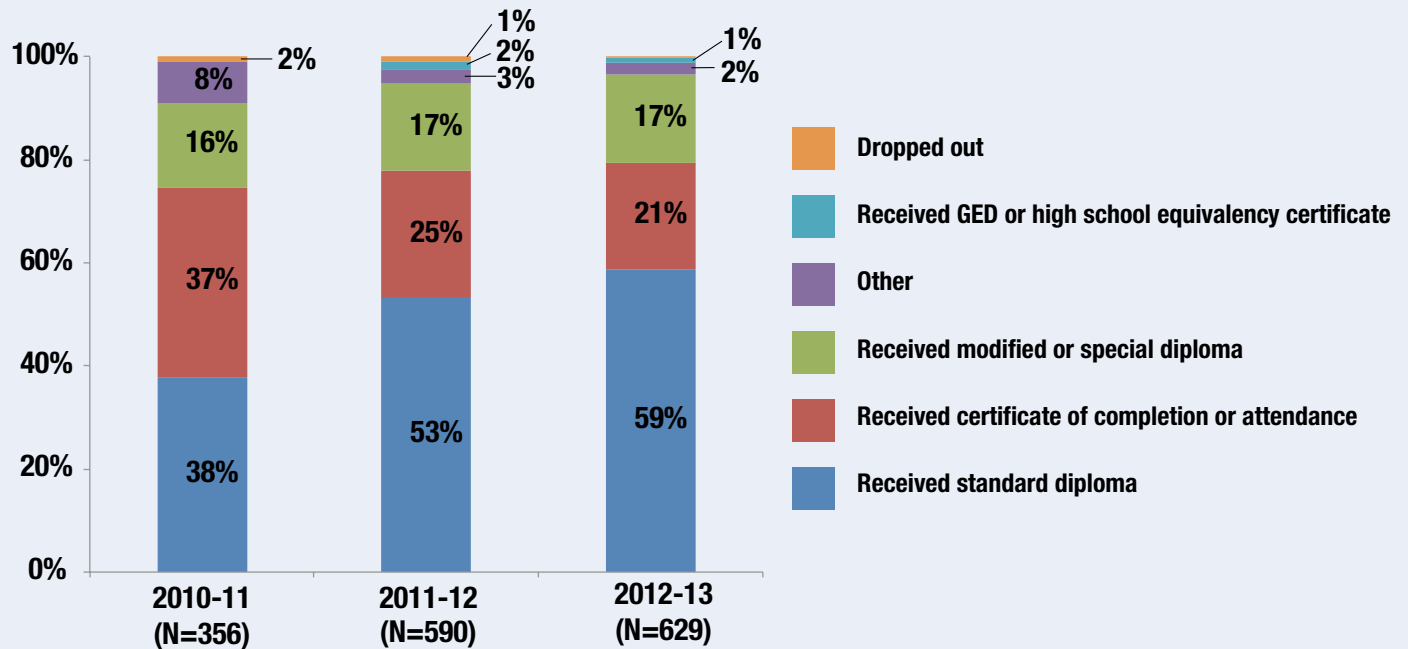
Over the three years that TPSID programs have operated, student profiles have remained fairly consistent. Just under one quarter of the students were dually enrolled in each year: 21% in Year One, 24% in Year Two, and 22% in Year Three. The majority of students have been between the ages of 18 and 25 in each year, but each year has also shown a wide age range across all students served. The split between male and female students has been about 60% male and 40% female in each year. The racial and ethnic makeup has also been similar across each of the three years.

One attribute that has changed over the three-year period is the type of secondary credential held by those students who have completed their secondary education. There has been an increase in the percentage of students who received a standard diploma when graduating from high school. As Figure 3 shows, this group increased from 38% of students who were not dually enrolled in 2010–2011 to 59% of students who were not dually enrolled in 2012–2013.

As shown in Figure 3, the percentage of students with a certificate of completion or attendance as their secondary credential has decreased each year. This change could be indicative of an increase in standard diploma attainment across the sending schools that feed into the TPSIDs. This increase may also be due to changes in state graduation/diploma policies where more students with disabilities are receiving standard diplomas in lieu of certificates of attendance. It could also reflect the increasingly stringent admissions processes or intake criteria used by the IHEs that host the TPSID programs.

There is no federal requirement that students with ID who attend TPSIDs must have (or must not have) a standard diploma. But if this change reflects that fewer students who have more significant disabilities are being served in the TPSIDs, then it may not be a positive trend.

FIGURE 3: SECONDARY CREDENTIALS HELD, 2010–2011 THROUGH 2012–2013*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

ACADEMIC ACCESS

Colleges and universities serving students with intellectual disabilities offer varying levels of inclusive academic access. Some IHEs offer access to a wide array of inclusive or typical college courses. Other IHEs limit the access of students with ID to a smaller subset of what their college peers can access (Grigal, Hart, & Weir, 2012). Some colleges *only* offer access to specialized courses that are attended *only* by students with disabilities; therefore, the students with intellectual disabilities are segregated instructionally from their college peers.

This continuum of access to inclusive courses is not surprising, given that many of the programs that exist throughout the United States were implemented prior to the passage of the Higher Education Opportunities Act. This legislation provided the first federal guidance regarding the provision of higher education to individuals with intellectual disability.

To differentiate between these two types of academic courses in TPSID programs, we use the term “academically inclusive courses” to reflect college classes that are a part of the typical college course catalog and are available to all students in the college. The manner in which students enroll in this type of course can include taking the course for credit, enrolling as a non-credit student, auditing the course, or informally sitting in on a course.

The term “academically specialized courses” is used to reflect courses that have been designed for, and are only attended by, students with intellectual disabilities in the TPSIDs.

The TPSID programs offer both academically inclusive courses and academically specialized courses to students. The subject matter addressed in the academically inclusive coursework ranged widely, as is seen in the box below.

Examples of Academically Inclusive Courses Taken by Students in 2012–2013

Business/Communication/Public Speaking

- » Critical Reasoning Skills I
- » Business Ethics
- » Acting Fundamentals

Horticulture and Other Plant Sciences

- » Advanced Landscape Design
- » Sustainable Greenhouse Production
- » Farm Management I & II

Literature, Design, and the Arts

- » Fiction Writing
- » World Music Culture
- » Intro and Advanced Digital Media

History, Social Sciences, Education

- » World History 1500-present
- » Child Development
- » Educational Psychology

University of Vermont

Stirling has a passion for filmmaking and screenwriting and hopes to have her own film production company some day. As a University of Vermont student through Think College Vermont, her academic coursework last year included Written Expression, Introduction to Poetry, Introduction to Acting, and Film Studies.

In addition to her coursework, Stirling participated in two vocational internships. The first was at the local CBS television station, WCAX. The second was at ORCA Media Services, the local cable-access television station. During her internship at ORCA, Stirling often co-hosted a show called *Weekly Photo Challenges*. These internships gave her practical, hands-on experience and the opportunity to meet and work with others in her field of interest.

In Stirling's words, "During my internship at ORCA Media, I learned new techniques on camerawork, editing, and making my own short video. I learned that teamwork is important at ORCA. My internship allowed me to network with real filmmakers and I find that to be totally cool. This internship helped me develop a whole new perspective for networking and asking hard questions about filmmaking."

After completing her certificate program in December 2013, Stirling secured two part-time jobs using her skills in video production. She is now working as the dissemination assistant for Think College Vermont at the University of Vermont. In this role, Stirling produces and edits videos, coordinates social networking through Facebook, Twitter, and YouTube, and helps with marketing and recruitment.

Stirling is working on the Life Histories project, a collaboration between Green Mountain Self-Advocates and the University of Vermont Center on Disability and Community Inclusion. Life Histories are stories of people with disabilities told through speech, writing, art, or video. Stirling's role with Green Mountain Self-Advocates also includes education and outreach regarding disabilities and advocacy.



COURSES ATTENDED

In 2012–2013, we collected data on 733 students enrolled in a total of 5,584 courses. This is an average of 8 courses per student taking courses per year.¹ Students at two-year IHEs took an average of seven courses, while those at four-year IHEs took an average of nine courses a year.

A majority of course enrollments (58%) were in academically specialized courses. The remaining 42% were in academically inclusive courses. A higher proportion of enrollments were in academically inclusive courses at two-year IHEs than at four-year IHEs (49% vs. 37%).

Figure 4 shows the enrollment methods used by students accessing inclusive and specialized courses in Year Three. A majority of students in inclusive courses were enrolled for standard IHE credit (53%). In most specialized courses (83%), students earned credit that could only be used towards the TPSID credential.

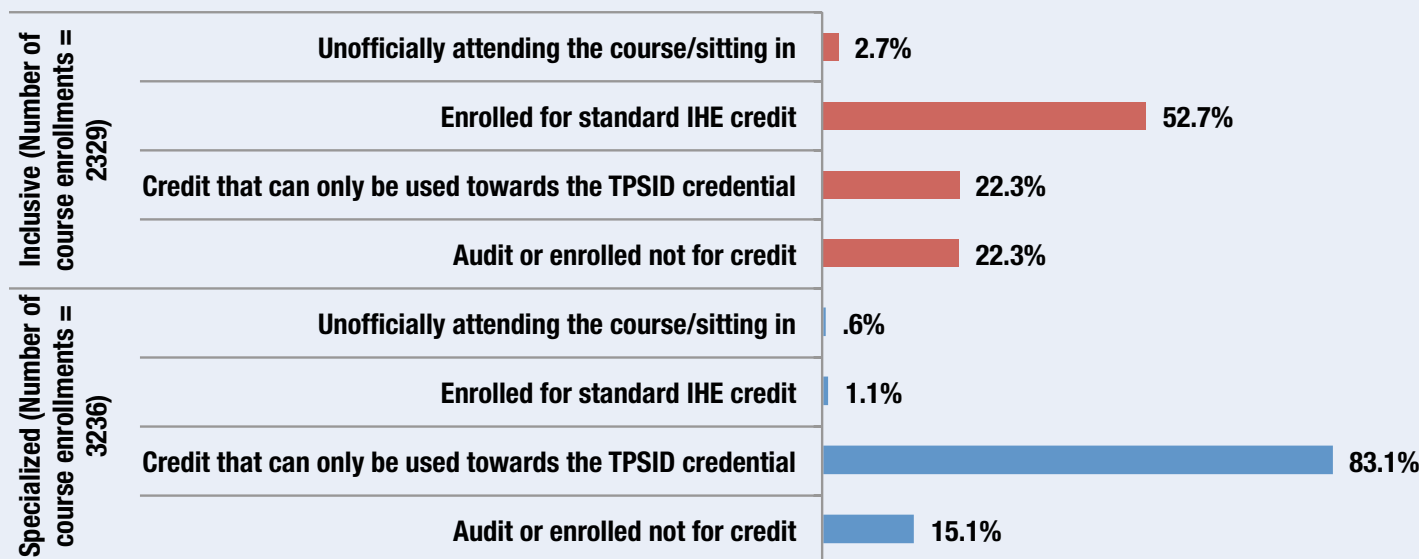
Given that the TPSID grants were provided to institutions of higher education to enable them to create or expand high-quality, *inclusive* programs for students with intellectual disabilities, it is concerning that the majority of college coursework being accessed remains academically specialized and not academically inclusive. There are TPSID programs that offer predominantly, or in some cases, completely separate curriculum to their students with intellectual disabilities.

All TPSIDs were charged with providing individual supports and services for the academic and social inclusion of students with intellectual disabilities in academic courses, extracurricular activities, and other aspects of the IHE's regular postsecondary program. It will be imperative that any future federal initiatives directed at expanding or improving higher

⁵ Some students did not take any courses because they were in a stage of their program where the focus was not on academics, but rather on employment and career development. Therefore, course enrollment data were not reported for some students.

education programs for people with intellectual disabilities provide clear and unequivocal guidance regarding the inclusive expectations of funded programs.

FIGURE 4: ENROLLMENT METHOD BY INCLUSIVE AND SPECIALIZED COURSE ENROLLMENT STATUS, 2012–2013



At the 2013 project directors meeting, participants in the TPSID focus groups identified a number of barriers to enrollment in a full range of courses, as well as strategies to address those barriers and facilitate academic inclusion. Barriers to academic access were often related to students' status on campus. For example, students in one program had trouble accessing the courses they desired because they were not matriculating students, and only full-time matriculating students were allowed to register first.

"I mean the biggest problem we face is the fact that matriculating students get the first seats in the class and then there's nothing left for our students. Then you're begging professors to let them in. It's just been a mess for some of the more popular GE [general education] classes that we require students to take."

At another program, students didn't pay tuition and therefore didn't have a bursar account, leading to the need to request permission from each instructor to enroll in classes. In some cases, finding appropriate classes is another challenge. A TPSID program at a small liberal arts college reported, "It's a small university so we have lots of these broad general classes. I don't know if they're getting something out of them because it's lecture-based and so we're missing those hands-on classes."

Program staff described multiple means of involvement in both the course selection process and the students' registration in selected courses. In one program, TPSID staff assisted students in selecting courses by reviewing the course catalog to identify courses that aligned with the students' career goals and then presenting that shorter list to the student. In other programs, course selection was limited to courses without prerequisites. Program course requirements vary from having course selection "pretty much dictated by what the students are interested in and what their career considerations are" to having a curriculum that includes a set number of required courses and electives.

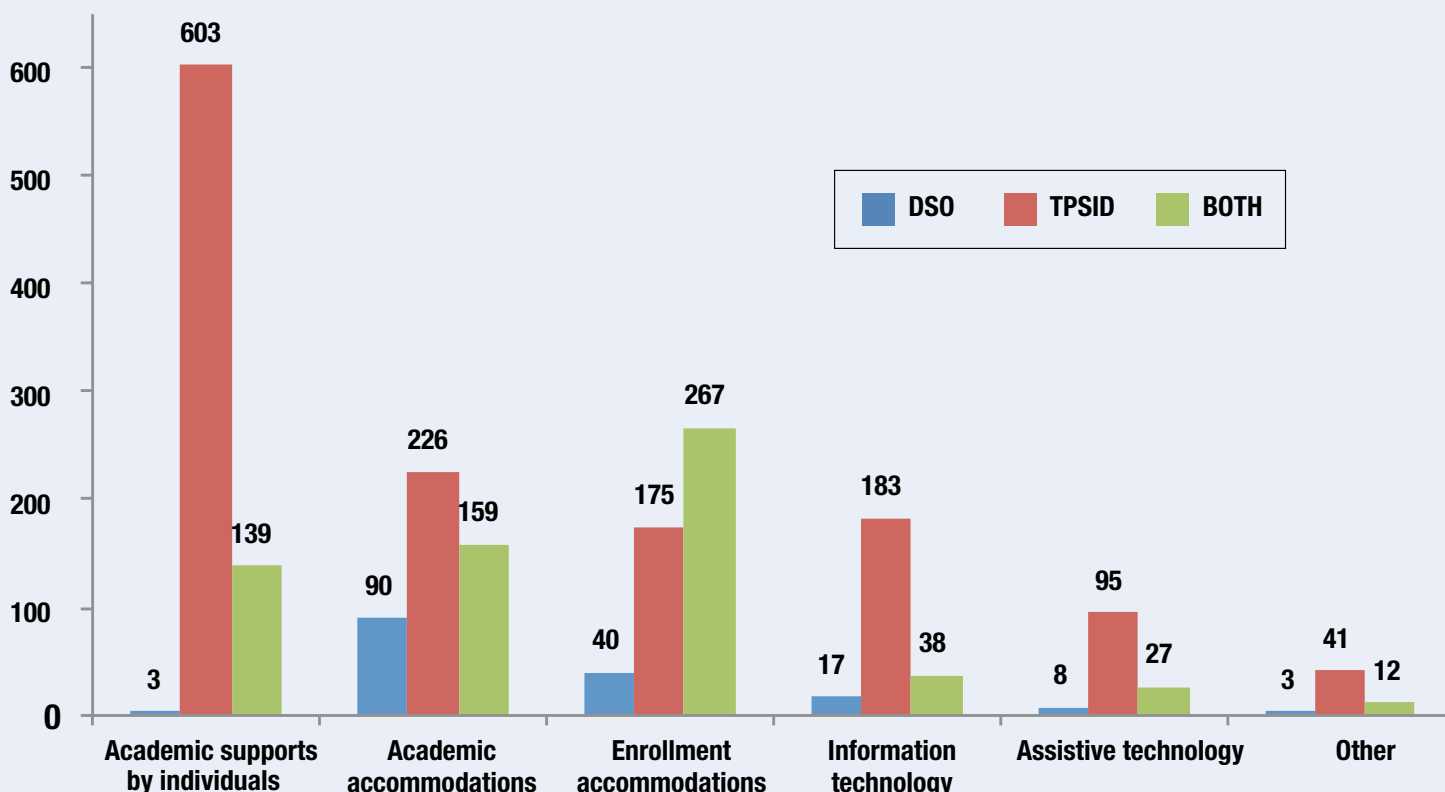
In some programs, TPSID students use the same registration process as any other student. Other programs use various strategies to overcome registration barriers such as the students' not having full matriculated status. These strategies may include meeting with faculty individually to request registration in their classes, working with the disability services office (DSO) to access priority registration, and working to build a rapport with the registrar and faculty to ensure students in the TPSID program have access to the entire college catalog.

ACCOMMODATIONS

An important component to academic access for students with disabilities is receiving necessary accommodations. As can be seen in Figure 5, most accommodations were provided by program staff rather than the disability services office.

The most common accommodations were academic supports provided by individuals such as note-takers and readers. Also common were enrollment accommodations, such as modified course loads, substitutes for required courses, and priority registration, as well as academic accommodations, such as access to professors' notes, advance access to materials, and alternative test formats. Information technology and assistive technology were used less frequently as accommodations.

FIGURE 5: ACCOMMODATIONS RECEIVED BY TPSID STUDENTS, 2012–2013 (N=821)*



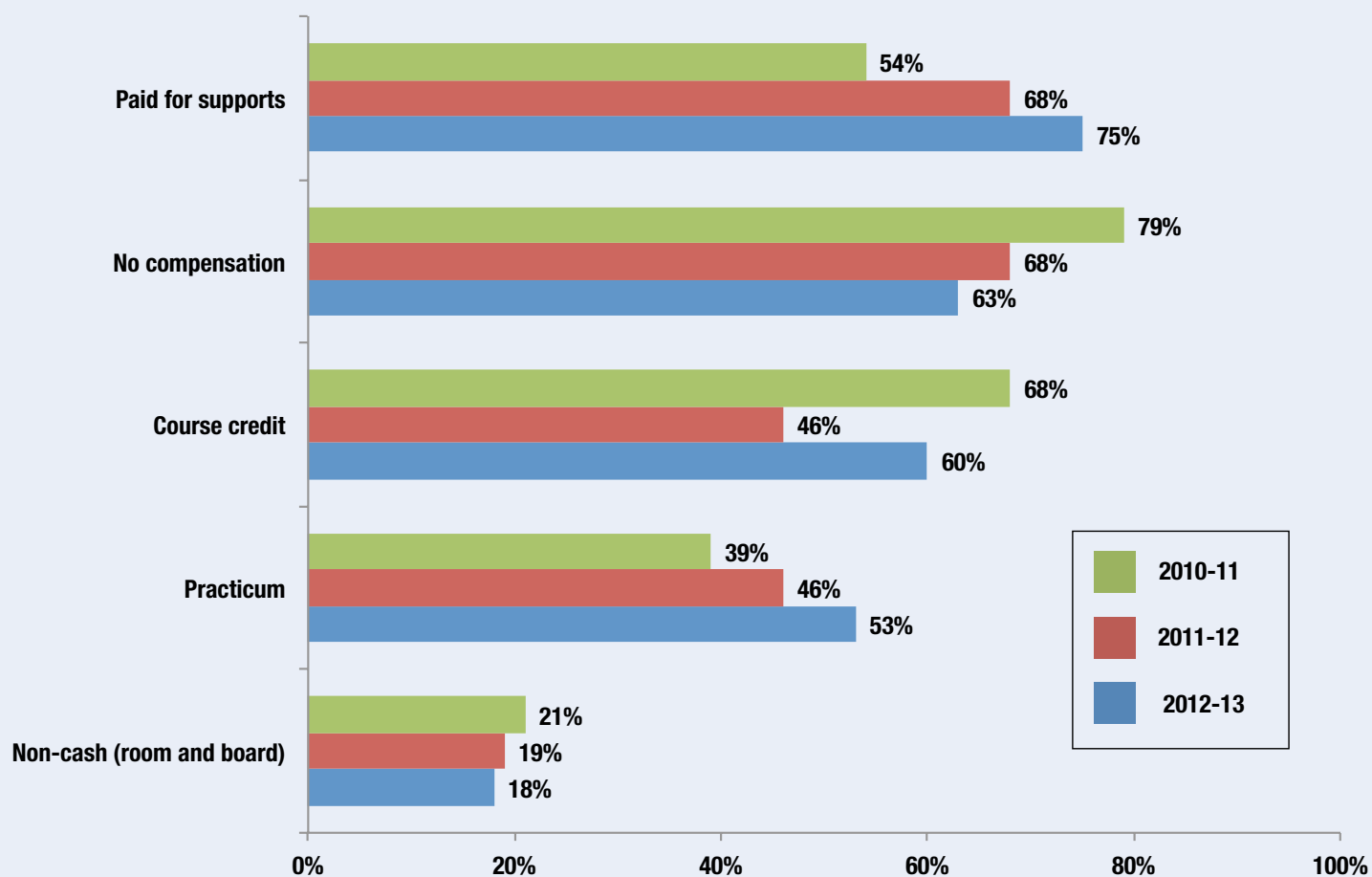
*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

ACADEMIC SUPPORTS FROM PEER MENTORS

A majority (84%) of TPSID programs use peer mentors to provide academic supports to students in the programs. These peer mentors are selected and trained by the program staff.

As Figure 6 shows, peer mentors in some cases receive academic credit, others are paid, and others are either volunteering or earning service-learning hours. There has been an increase in the number of programs that pay mentors or align mentoring with a required practicum. The number of peer mentors receiving no compensation is decreasing.

FIGURE 6: PEER MENTOR COMPENSATION



Some programs see the peer mentors as an extension of program staff, while other programs have various peer mentor roles (social, academic, employment). However, the most common role for mentors is providing academic or social supports.

The most frequent programs of study of peer mentors in the TPSIDs are liberal arts and social science majors, or education and rehabilitation majors. Less frequent but still present are peer mentors focusing on business, sciences, or engineering. Some programs solicit peer mentors from the college or university at large. Others wait until a student is enrolled in a course; then they seek a peer mentor who is also enrolled in the course.

“Originally we had natural supports who were not enrolled in the classroom that were going into the classroom. But I’ve seen greater success when there is a mutually invested student ... who’s there to succeed for themselves and they’re taking better notes. They see it as opportunity when they’re studying ... to better retain information.”

“Recruiting from within has been a strategy that has been very successful for our students’ success.”

Recruiting class peers to serve as mentors can be difficult if the course content is vocationally specific and not academic. Program personnel from another TPSID elaborated on the difficulty of finding peer mentors in career education programs:

“...There’s been a big push for inclusive vocational career tech programs. And one of the issues that they’ve run into is getting a mentor ... from within the class itself. Which if you’re in a gen ed class it’s not a big deal. But if you’re in a vocational class, a career tech class, those students are in there learning the same stuff and the focus is on those hands-on skills that they need to learn. So to have a mentor for that group is challenging. So that means bringing in an outside mentor. But when you bring in an outside mentor, you’ve got to bring in somebody who knows the business. Because I can’t go in and mentor you in the air conditioning class.”

FACULTY OUTREACH

Several TPSIDs in the focus groups talked about the importance of outreach to faculty as a means of ensuring academic access. Staff from one TPSID indicated that their program sends a letter to the faculty member after a TPSID student registers for the class, explaining the program and the supports available. Other programs conducted outreach to faculty before students in the TPSID program registered for courses.

One unique approach to engaging with faculty was shared during the focus groups. This program reaches out to faculty and asks them to conduct presentations of their research to the program.

“[A] student group on campus... has been organizing these events and they invite professors to come and present their work to students.... [It’s] almost like a speed-dating thing so we have all of these rooms set up, and these professors set up and students come in and hear about their research. Which is the way for us to kind of stimulate the students, but the main purpose is for the professors to see students and know what they’re interested in.”

Another program maintains a list of courses students have taken on the program website, as a way to help alleviate faculty concern by showing faculty the range of courses students have accessed.

TPSID programs have used various other mechanisms for ongoing education and support of faculty members in areas of universal design for learning and how to accommodate students with intellectual disabilities. Some examples include:

- Program provides faculty development in UDL, paid for by TPSID funds but offered by the disability services office.
- Program has a faculty ambassador who is offered a course reduction in order to be available to offer support to other faculty related to having students from the TPSID program in their classes.
- TPSID staff work with the faculty to review the syllabus and determine appropriate modifications, and/or to manage any extra work associated with those modifications.

CREDENTIALS

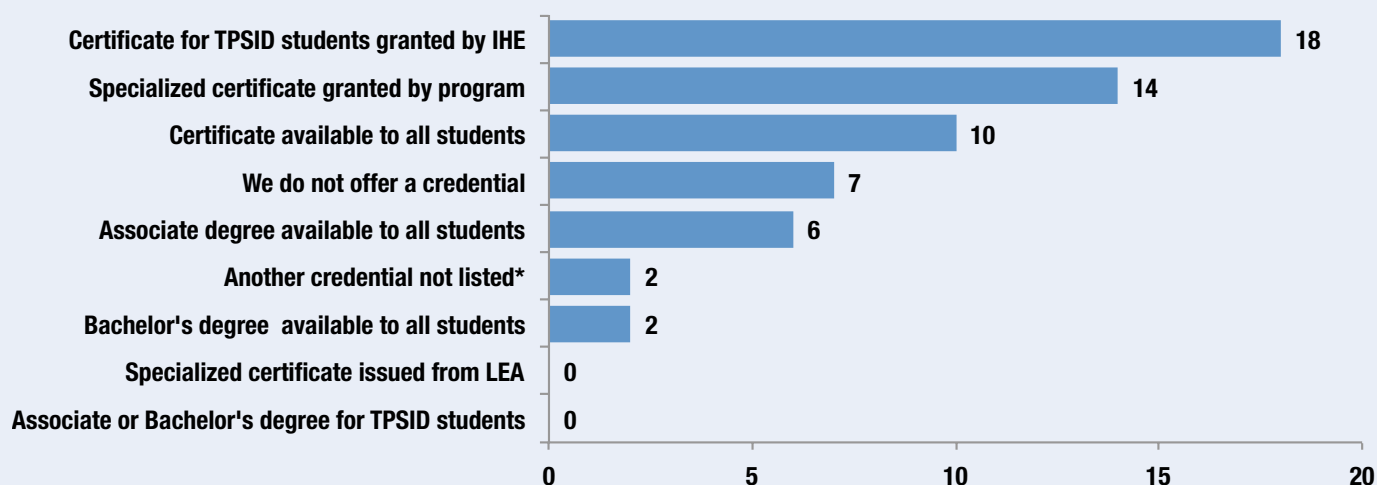
Each TPSID is required to create and offer a meaningful credential for students with intellectual disabilities upon completion of the program. In Year Three, most TPSIDs (38 out of 44) offered some type of credential (Figure 7). Credentials were certificates or degrees available to all students or only to students in the TPSID program.

Credentials were granted by the IHE, by the TPSID program, or by a partnering local education agency (LEA). The most common credentials available were certificates, and the most prevalent type of certificates issued were those granted by the IHE only to students in the TPSID. It was more common for TPSIDs to offer specialized credentials specifically for students with intellectual disabilities than to offer credentials available to all college students.

Two-year IHEs were more likely to offer an associate’s degree (33% vs. 3%) or a certificate available to all students (47% vs. 10%). The two IHEs that offered bachelor’s degrees were four-year IHEs. Four-year IHEs were more likely to offer a specialized certificate granted by the TPSID (41% vs. 13%).

A majority of students attending TPSIDs (71%) were seeking a credential in 2012–2013. Another 4% were not seeking the credential, and 23% were enrolled in programs not offering a credential. Students who were in their second or third year were slightly more likely to be seeking a credential (76% vs. 68%). Dually enrolled students were less likely to be seeking a credential (57% vs. 76%).

FIGURE 7: CREDENTIALS AVAILABLE TO STUDENTS ATTENDING TPSIDS, 2012–2013 (N=44 SITES)



*"Career Readiness Credential (WorkKeys)" and "specialized certificate available to both TPSID and non-TPSID students."

ACADEMIC ACCESS TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

Access to inclusive courses is critical to providing a meaningful postsecondary experience for students. The percentage of course enrollments in inclusive courses increased by 12% between Years One and Two, from 32% to 44%, and then decreased slightly in Year Three to 42%. Despite slight increases over time toward more inclusive enrollments, the majority of courses taken by students in TPSID programs are specialized rather than inclusive, and the associated credits earned are not widely recognized by the host IHE. It appears that access to inclusive college courses remains a challenge for grantees.

To address the need for greater access to inclusive courses, the National Coordinating Center (NCC) has created a Special Interest Group (SIG) on the topic of inclusion to facilitate communication among the grantees about effective strategies. The SIG also creates a forum for discussing and addressing challenges related to inclusive course access.

Upon request, the NCC has provided onsite training and technical assistance to a number of TPSIDs on strategies that promote greater access to inclusive courses. Training has covered topics such as Universal Design for Learning and the role of tablet technology in creating greater access and success in courses.

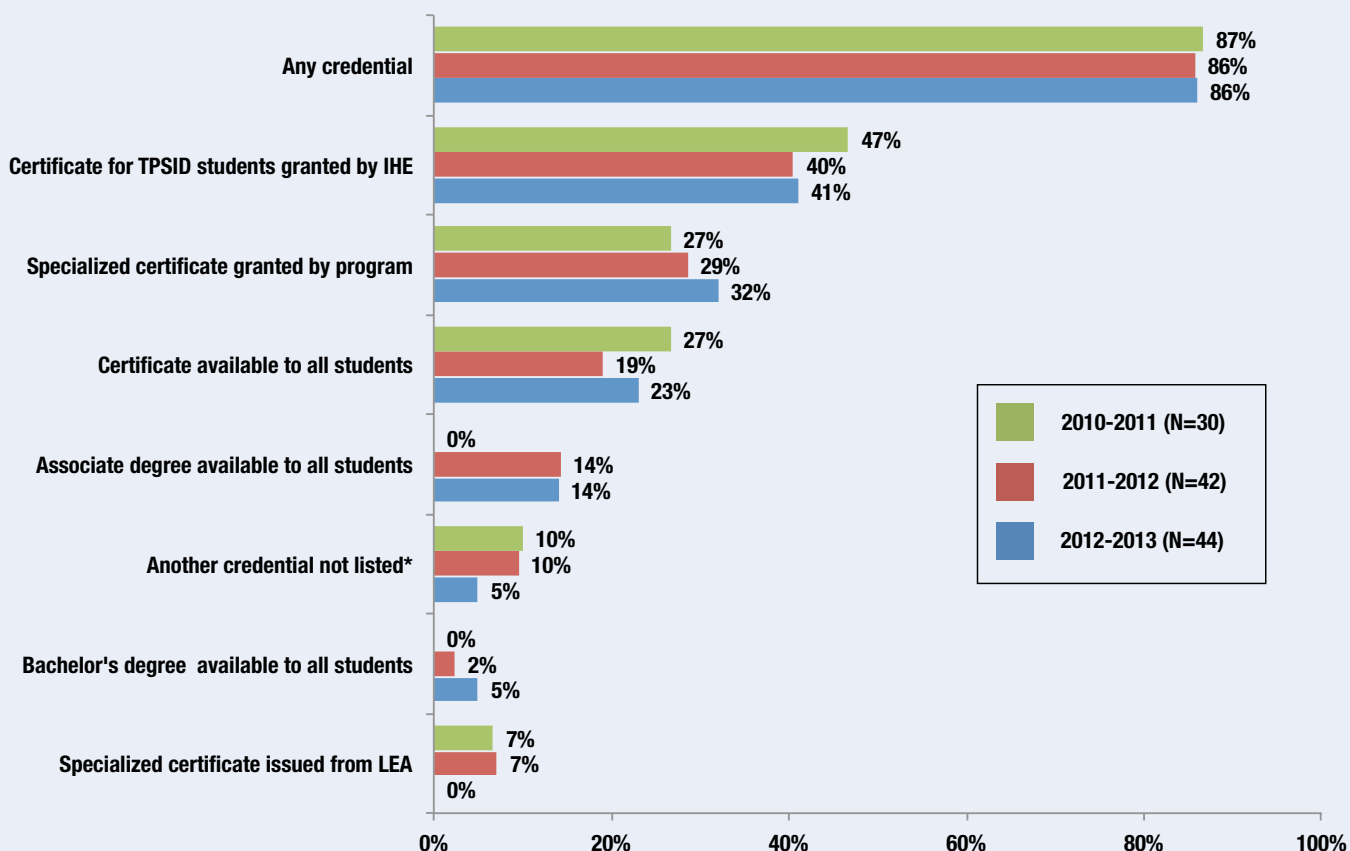
Finally, the NCC has also developed an online module on Universal Design for Learning in Higher Education that is available on the Think College website.

Three years of data show an increase in the percentage of course enrollments that were for some type of credit, whether it was standard IHE credit that could be used towards a certificate or degree, or credit that could only be used towards a TPSID credential. Sixty-one percent of enrollments in Year One awarded some type of course credit, while 81% of enrollments were for credit in Year Three. TPSIDs should continue to pursue credit-bearing course opportunities for their students to ensure they are on a path to earning a credential that will be meaningful in the job market.

There has been little variation in the types of credentials available to students attending a TPSID over the three years of the project. Overall, the proportion of TPSIDs offering a credential has been steady, ranging from 86% to 87%. While most students do have access to some sort of credential, Figure 8 shows there are still some sites that do not award any sort of credential to their students.

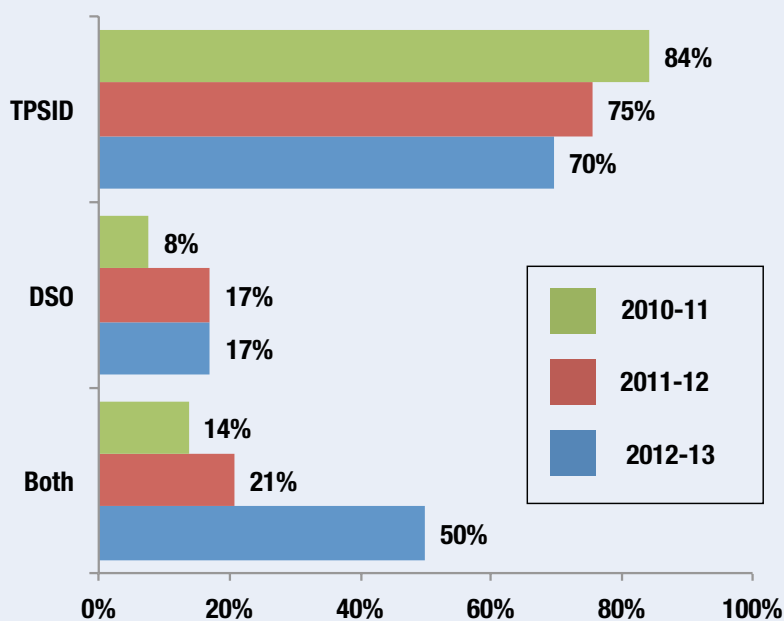
As in Years One and Two, credentials designed specifically for students attending the TPSID are the most common. The NCC conducted outreach to the TPSIDs regarding their training needs related to credential development. In February 2013, the NCC hosted a webinar that focused on the process of planning for and developing a credential. The NCC has also created a research to practice brief and a Credential Action Planning Tool that can be used to guide credential implementation and evaluation. These are available on www.thinkcollege.net.

FIGURE 8: TRENDS IN CREDENTIALS AVAILABLE TO STUDENTS, 2010–2011 THROUGH 2012–2013 (NUMBER OF PROGRAMS SERVING STUDENTS IN PARENTHESES)



The percentage of students who received academic accommodations from the DSO and from both the DSO and the TPSID more than doubled between Years One and Three, reflecting an increased level of partnership and engagement with the DSO by the TPSID programs (Figure 9). The percentage of students who received accommodations that were provided solely by the TPSID program also increased between Years One and Three, but not as drastically as the other categories. If the TPSID programs continue to support greater access to inclusive courses, it is likely that students will require increased supports from the DSO.

FIGURE 9: TRENDS IN ACCOMMODATIONS PROVIDED TO STUDENTS, 2010–2011 THROUGH 2012–2013



CAREER DEVELOPMENT AND EMPLOYMENT

A primary goal of the TPSID program is to facilitate career development and the supports necessary for students to seek and sustain integrated competitive employment. The benefits of integrated competitive employment include higher wages, access to benefits, greater independence and economic self-sufficiency, greater integration with people without disabilities in the workplace and the community, more opportunities for choice and self-determination, and expanded career options and increased job satisfaction (Wehman & Scott, 2013).

Despite years of investment in special education, the poor outcome choices afforded to people with ID have prevented any substantial change in their transition and adult life outcomes (Grigal & Hart, 2013). Youth with ID have the lowest rates of education, work, or preparation for work after high school of all disability groups (Migliore, Butterworth, & Hart, 2009). In 2011, 81% of people with intellectual and developmental disabilities were being served in facility-based and non-work settings (Butterworth et al., 2013). Low expectations and little to no access to further education limits potential for real jobs and real wages.

In 2011, employment rates for transition-age individuals (ages 16–21) were 18%, less than half the employment rate for people without disabilities (Butterworth et al., 2013). This gap becomes worse as people with ID age, with only 32% of adults ages 20–30 having employment, compared to 74% of people without disabilities in the same age range (Sulewski, Zalewska, Butterworth, & Migliore, 2013).

The TPSID programs address career development and employment via a variety of activities, including providing access to job coaches/developers; offering internships, service learning opportunities, and paid work experiences; and connecting with service providers to sustain employment. Each year, TPSIDs report the paid employment experiences and other career development activities in which students participate. Other career development activities are unpaid but contribute to future employment, e.g., unpaid internships, volunteering, etc.

In Year Three, 73% of students participated in career development activities, including paid employment, other career development, or both (Table 6). Twenty-seven percent did not participate in any career development activities in Year Three. During focus groups held at the project directors meeting, participants explained that a focus on career development often comes later in a student's attendance at a program. This partially explains why some students did not participate in career development activities during the year.

TABLE 6. CAREER DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES AMONG TPSID STUDENTS, 2012–2013 (N=821)*

	Count	Percent
Paid employment only	90	11%
Other career development only	316	38%
Paid employment and other career development	196	24%
No career development activities	219	27%
Total	821	100%

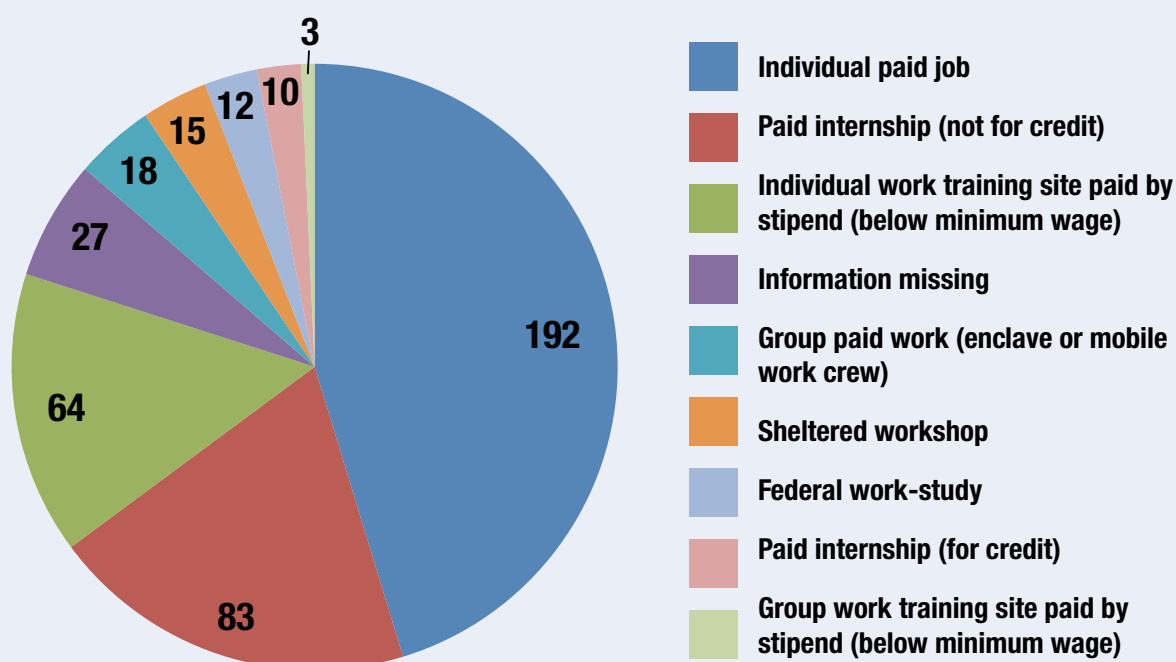
*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

STUDENT PAID EMPLOYMENT

Of the 838 students who attended TPSID programs in 2012–2013, 298 (36%) held a total of 424 paid jobs. Some students have held the same job for multiple years while also attending a TPSID program. Thirty-five of these jobs (9%) were those that the student also worked in during Year One, and 134 (32%) were jobs the student worked in during Year Two. One hundred twenty-seven of the students with paid jobs had two or more paid jobs in Year Three. Forty-two percent of students employed in Year Three had never held a paid job prior to entering the TPSID.

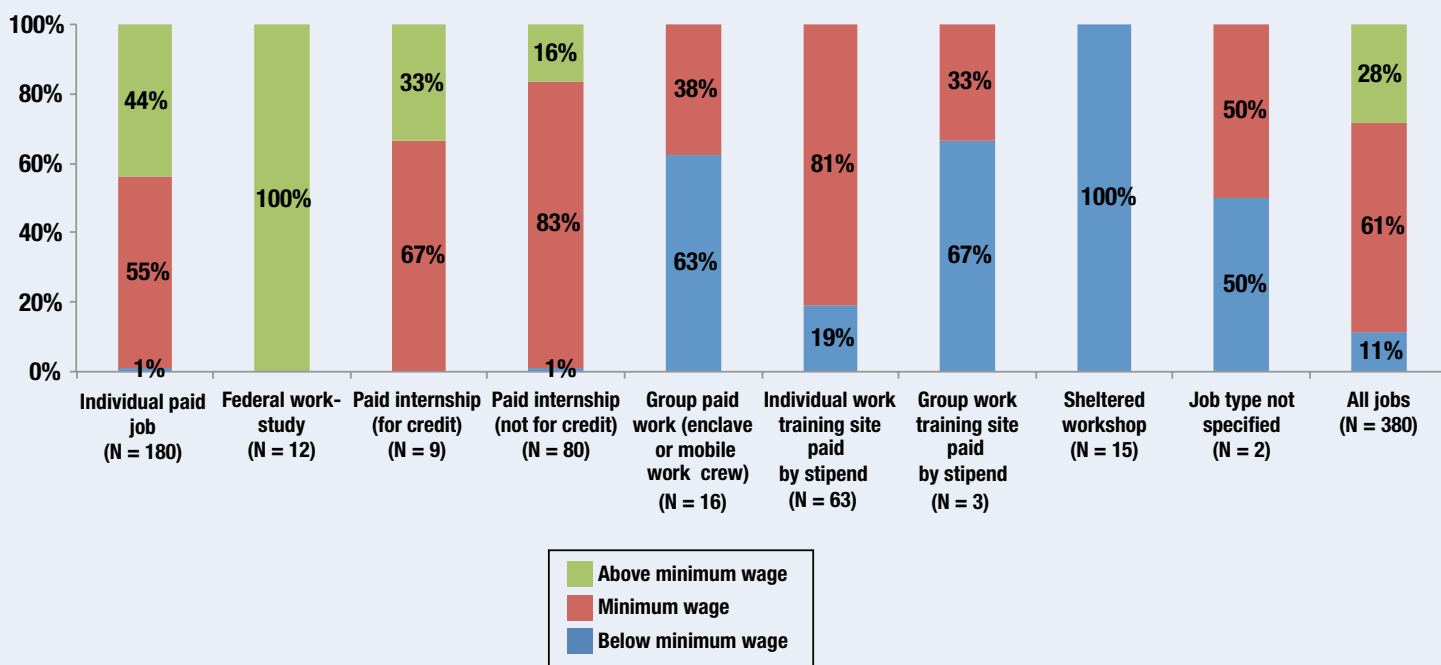
Employment First initiatives around the country are emphasizing the importance of integrated competitive employment as the first choice and goal for people with ID (Niemiec, Lavin, & Owens, 2009). It is encouraging that in the third year of the program, individual paid jobs accounted for 192 of the paid jobs held by students (45%), and paid internships (credit and non-credit) accounted for 22% (see Figure 10).

FIGURE 10: PAID JOBS HELD BY STUDENTS ATTENDING TPSIDS, 2012–2013 (N=424 JOBS)



Eighty-two percent of jobs paid at or above minimum wage, 10% paid less than minimum wage, and wage status was unknown for the remaining 8% of jobs. As reflected in Figure 11, 99% of individual paid jobs reported paying students at or above minimum wage. All 15 jobs in sheltered workshops paid less than minimum wage. The majority of students (73%) worked between five and 20 hours per week at their job.

FIGURE 11: WAGE DISTRIBUTION BY JOB TYPE, 2012–2013 (N=380 JOBS)*



*Jobs with missing wage and job setting information are omitted from this chart. Omits data reported at the aggregate level.

Students in the TPSID programs have the opportunity to address both academic and employment goals while in higher education. In the third year of this program, 36% of these students were in paid employment while simultaneously accessing college courses. This employment rate is double the national employment average for transition-age youth.

Clearly, we are seeing data on employment trending in a positive direction. But it is still a concern that some students in TPSID programs are in sheltered work and group work training sites. To address these concerns, the TPSID programs where these practices are still occurring have hired a customized employment specialist to work with employers in the region to create integrated employment opportunities. In addition, a national customized employment trainer has been working with the staff to improve outcomes.

Monroe Community College

Branden always knew he wanted to go to college. He followed that dream and in 2013 completed the inclusive postsecondary program at Monroe Community College (MCC).

At MCC, Branden took classes, served as a committee member of the Student Events and Governance Association, and spoke at conferences. These experiences helped him become more independent and a stronger self-advocate on campus and in the workplace.

As part of his college experience, Branden worked at two daycare centers and a flower shop as an unpaid intern. Brandon's college courses and associated internships allowed him to develop skills that made him an attractive candidate for positions in childcare.

Branden currently works 20–32 hours per week at minimum wage in childcare at the YMCA in Rochester, NY. His advice for other students with disabilities who are just starting college is straightforward: "Stay positive and work hard to achieve your goals." Branden adds, "You can accomplish whatever you want to be in life."



JOB SUPPORTS

For each reported paid job, respondents were asked to identify which job supports students used. Students received supports at two thirds of all jobs. Natural supports and job coaching were the most commonly provided supports (see Figure 12). In the 141 instances where a student received job coaching at their job, the percentage of time the job coach was present varied (see Table 7).

FIGURE 12: PERCENT AND TYPE OF JOB SUPPORTS USED BY STUDENTS IN 2012–2013 (N=424 JOBS)

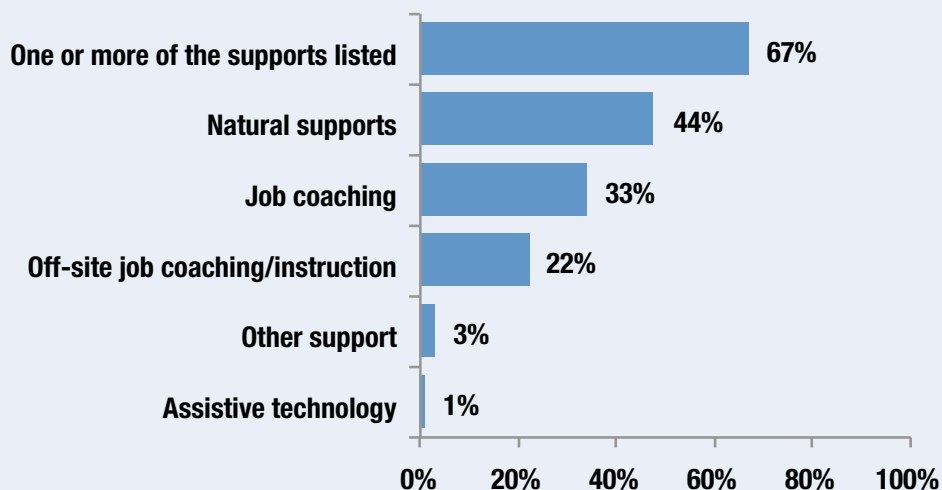


TABLE 7. PERCENTAGE OF TIME THAT JOB COACH WAS PRESENT WHILE STUDENT WAS WORKING (N=141 JOBS WHERE COACHING WAS PROVIDED)*

	Count	Percent
0–25% of the time	52	37%
26–50% of the time	22	16%
51–75% of the time	10	7%
76–100% of the time	54	38%
No response	3	2%
Total*	141	100%

*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

Examples of paid jobs held by students, 2012–2013

- » Fitness center lifeguard
- » Aquarium exhibit guide intern
- » VFW special events staff
- » Clothing store associate
- » Auto body shop mechanic
- » Healthcare facility marketing intern
- » College library work study
- » Admission office intern

BARRIERS TO PAID EMPLOYMENT

Program staff shared insights during the focus groups into some of the individual and structural challenges they face in seeking paid employment for students. One challenge was lack of preparation and career assessment prior to students entering their college program.

Student status at the IHE was another challenge. At some of the IHEs, on-campus student jobs are not available to TPSID students if they are considered “non-matriculated students” by the host IHE. In other instances, community-based jobs near campus can be challenging if the campus is in a location that is not safe.

In some cases, the challenges are internal. Lack of staff trained in state-of-the-art customized and integrated employment practices are a problem reported by some TPSID staff. Additionally, some focus group participants mentioned lack of knowledge about best practices that lead to employment. For example, instead of providing only needed minimal supports and then fading job coach support, undertrained job coaches have performed the work for a student on the job.

The NCC has provided access to online and in-person training related to employment strategies for TPSID staff. Employment and job development were focal topics at the 2013 TPSID project directors meeting. Additionally, the NCC has developed an online learning module on job development and marketing (see www.thinkcollege.net/think-college-learn). NCC has also published a research-to-practice brief on innovative job development practices (Dwyre & Deschamps, 2013), and has included a wide array of research, as well as field-based publications, in its online resource library (www.thinkcollege.net/resources-database).

Highline Community College

Lawrence came to Highline Community College's ACHIEVE Program for two reasons: to get a job and to learn to read. At first shy and resistant to change, Lawrence grew from his experiences in his academic courses. He realized that his efforts and struggles were an investment in himself, and were worth the time and the work.

Lawrence took a combination of reading, writing, and career development courses in his two years at Highline, earning an award for academic achievement from the college as well as being highlighted in the campus newspaper. He also completed a three-month paid internship at Starbucks, where he was able to apply the skills he learned.

After he earned his certificate, Lowe's Home Improvement hired Lawrence. He impressed the store manager during his job interview, where he gave flawless answers and described his previous work experience.

Lawrence is now employed at Lowe's as a part-time facility services associate. He works 16–25 hours per week at a starting wage of \$11.79 per hour, more than he has ever earned!

Lawrence has access to benefits and an employee discount, and the team at Lowe's is excited to have him on board. His supervisors have already recognized some opportunities for Lawrence to grow, such as learning to use the store Zamboni.



STRATEGIES FOR BETTER EMPLOYMENT OUTCOMES

Focus group participants discussed a number of strategies and practices that could potentially improve employment outcomes for students. These included efforts towards relationship building and structural changes within the IHE, as well as improvements to employment services and supports delivery.

Participants talked about the value of building relationships on campus so that they can be aware of potential employment opportunities. In some cases, this included establishing a team of key college staff who work together toward the goal of employment. One participant stated, “We have a team that’s made up of people from the head of residential life, the head of academic affairs, the head of financial aid, etc.” Having this group of individuals from diverse perspectives working together means that “they’re constantly thinking where there might be employment opportunities on campus.”

In terms of structural change, another participant talked about working with IHE human resources to make students in the TPSID eligible for student employment on campus. Typically, these jobs would only be available to fully matriculated students. Aside from working on structural changes with external IHE departments, TPSIDs can also focus on internal changes, particularly, as participants suggested, having an explicit employment goals for the TPSID program. Some programs, e.g., Highline Community College and the University of Delaware, have become community rehabilitation providers (CRPs) so they can offer employment services directly to students.

Focus group participants also had a number of suggestions to better serve and support students as they search for and retain employment. This included using peer mentors as job coaches for students working in community-based jobs. More than half of TPSID programs (52%) reported using peer mentors to support students in employment. However, these data did not specify what role the mentors played when supporting students. If peer mentors are used as job coaches, TPSIDs should ensure they are properly trained to act in that capacity.

Virginia Commonwealth University

Diagnosed with autism as well as an intellectual disability, Eddie came to the ACE-IT in College program at Virginia Commonwealth University (VCU) with a 4th-grade reading level and a 3rd-grade math level. He was accepted as one of the very first ACE-IT students for the fall semester of 2011.

Admitted as a non-degree-seeking student, Eddie enrolled in two courses. Matched with two college-age education coaches, he learned to navigate the campus, use the VCU email system, and access Blackboard for coursework--all during the first week of classes. This strong beginning set the stage for his 30-month program.

Due to his love of sports, Eddie applied, interviewed, and was hired as a student worker at the Cary Street Gym at VCU. He continued to excel in his coursework as well as his campus job. By mid-semester, he had advocated for a promotion to the facilities maintenance department, where he helped maintain and repair gymnasium equipment.

Eddie’s peers would joke with him about being a rabid fan of the Dallas Cowboys and always being on time for work. He continued to work in this position until graduation, missing perfect attendance by only one day to attend a funeral.

Eddie’s last requirement at VCU consisted of an independent study that focused on internships in the community. Eddie completed two job shadows at a

Honda automotive repair and West Engineering to further explore his career interests in small machinery. He also completed two community internships.

These internships strengthened Eddie’s computer and technology skills. At his first internship, the Virginia Holocaust Museum, he used Excel to enter data into a spreadsheet, catalogued books, and entered CD data into a computer database to create a self-search library. His second internship was at a privately owned orthotics and prosthetics facility in Richmond. The director of human resources noticed that Eddie was proficient with entering data, and suggested that he add that skill to his resume.

Eddie recently landed a job with Amazon as a fulfillment center specialist, earning \$11.50 an hour, working 40 hours per week, and receiving health insurance benefits. He and his family recently met with a Community Work Incentives Coordinator, and are now waiting for Eddie to come off of the Social Security rolls.



Another suggestion was to look at job developing from a business perspective, rather than a human services one. As one participant stated:

“We all too often go in and ask if you just give, you’re just doing the right thing for the community, and business doesn’t want to hear about doing the right thing for their community. They want to know how you’re going to improve their bottom line and what’s in it for them. And the reality is a good job developer will go in and analyze that business and figure out what they’re missing, and carve out a position that meets the skills that gives them something that makes them money. We are doing what’s right, but the bottom line is for a business it’s not about a shiny happy community, it’s about a dollar.”

OTHER CAREER DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES

In addition to paid employment, students participate in other career development activities to prepare for the workforce (Figure 13). Over half of the students enrolled in Year Three (62%) participated in these activities. The most common activities were volunteering and/or community service (30%) and unpaid internships for credit (24%).

Many more students participated in career development than in paid employment. This is not entirely surprising since, as reported by focus group participants, a program requirement or expectation for volunteer hours or another non-work career development activity can limit the amount of time a student is available for paid work, as can required coursework. One focus group participant reported successfully partnering with the state VR agency to have VR pay to support students in unpaid internships on campus.

One hundred thirty-seven students participated in service learning opportunities in Year Three. Given that one of the primary outcomes TPSIDs are charged with is to help students achieve integrated competitive employment, the finding that 27% of students are not engaged in any career development activities, paid or unpaid, demonstrates a need for continued expansion of both career development and employment activities in the TPSID programs.

FIGURE 13: OTHER CAREER DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCES IN 2012–2013 (N=838 STUDENTS)



Employment and career outcomes by number of years attending TPSID program

Analysis of Year Three data showed differences in career development participation and outcomes based on how many years the student had been attending the TPSID program. Figure 14 splits the 821 students into categories for students in their first, second, and third year of TPSID attendance.

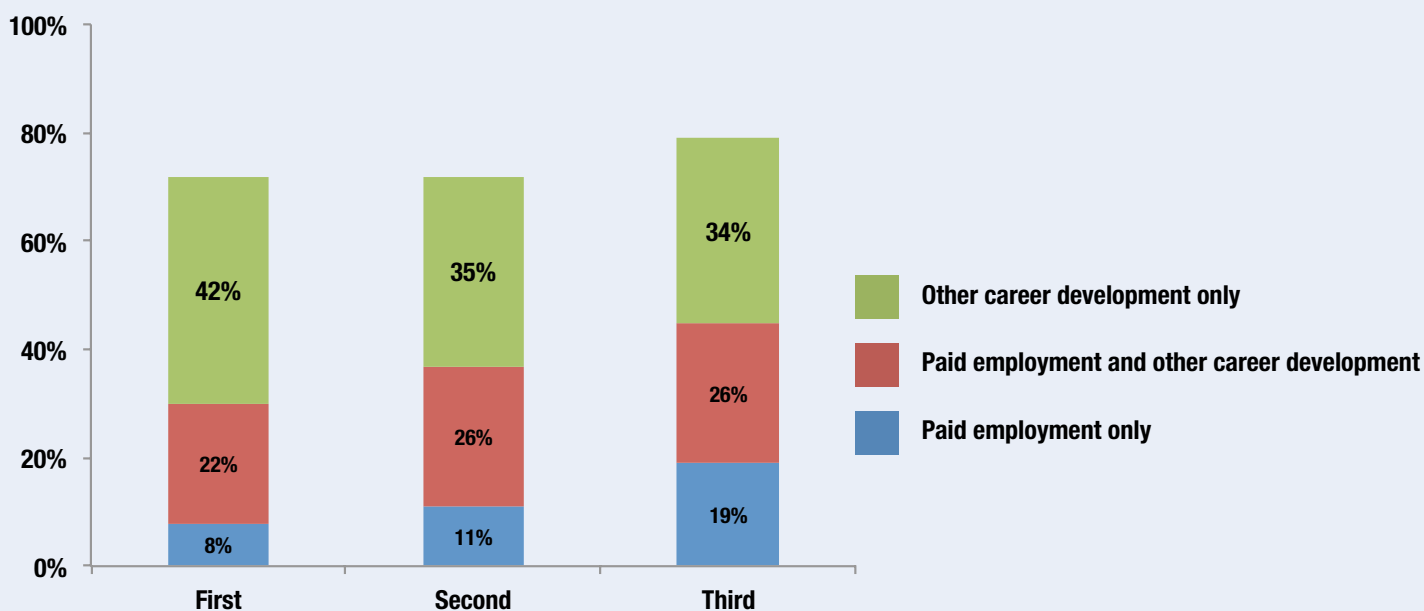
The longer a student has attended a program, the more likely they are to be employed. In Year Three, 30% of students in their first year were employed, compared to 37% of students in their second year and 45% of students in their third year. We also see fewer students in their third year of attendance who are not participating in any career development, compared to students in their first year.

As mentioned previously, focus group participants explained that career development activities often come later in a student’s attendance at a program. Participants stated that at some programs, the focus of the first year, or if it is a four-year program, sometimes the first two years, is on academics and campus life. Knowing this, it is not surprising to see increases in career outcomes as students enter the later years of their program. Jobs are not prioritized, and may even be actively discouraged as students focus on acclimating to college and their academic program.

Other participants emphasized this point even more strongly: “We don’t like them [students] working for pay while they’re going full-time to school because we believe in the process of college. And so we don’t want them working. We build in their job and employment within the context of their academic [program].”

The inconsistency in expectations and practices in terms of emphasis and timing of career development and employment is another example of how the programs that were awarded TPSID grants have various interpretations of their purpose. If future model demonstrations are sought or awarded, grantees would benefit from more specific guidance about expectations around student engagement in career development and employment activities.

FIGURE 14: CAREER DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES AMONG STUDENTS BY YEAR IN PROGRAM, 2012–2013 (N=821)*

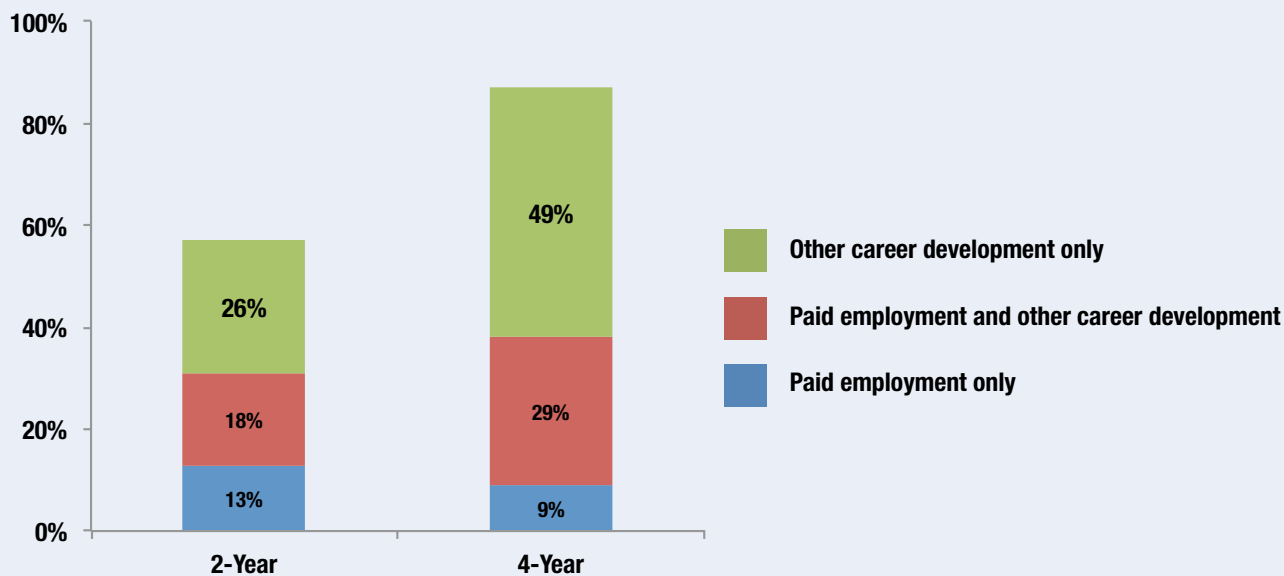


*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

Employment and career outcomes for students at two-year and four-year institutions

Differences were observed in participation in career development activities based on whether the student attended a program at a two-year or four-year IHE. Students at four-year IHEs were more likely to participate in both paid employment and other career development activities. Figure 15 illustrates that most students at four-year IHEs were participating in career development activities (88%), while just over half of the students at two-year IHEs (57%) participated in career development. Thirty-one percent of students at two-year IHEs had paid work, compared with 38% of students at four-year IHEs.

FIGURE 15: CAREER DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES BY TYPE OF INSTITUTION, 2012–2013 (N=821)*

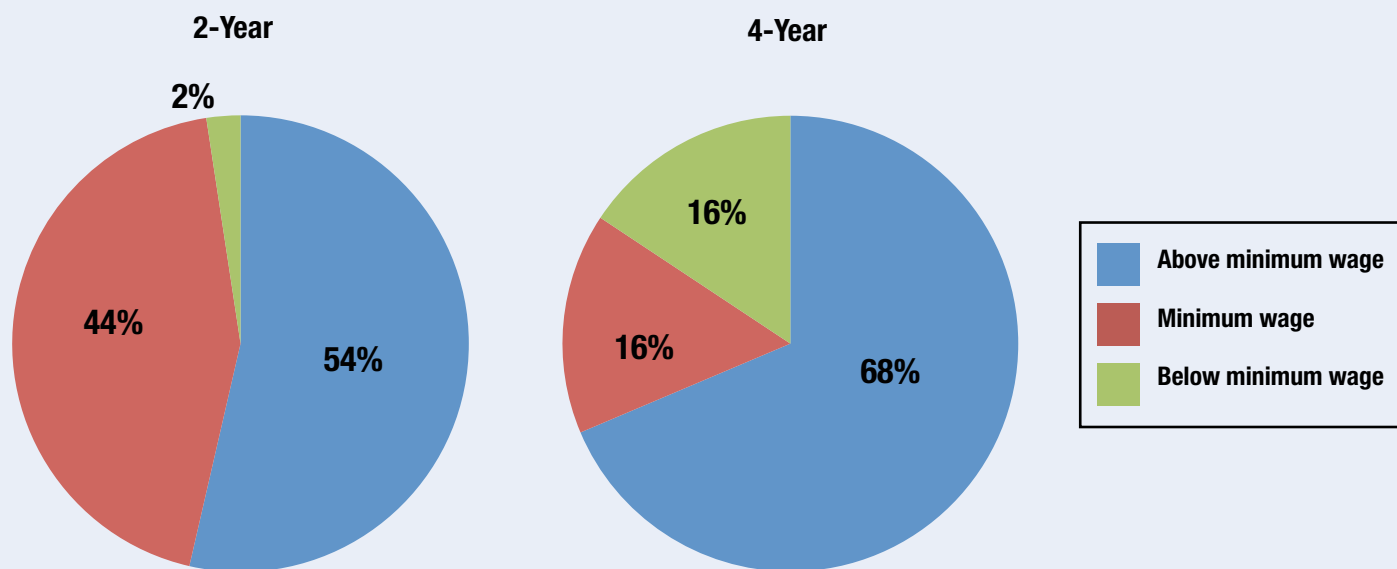


*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

In Year Three, students enrolled in programs at two-year IHEs were nearly twice as likely to hold individual paid jobs as students at four-year IHEs. Sixty-nine percent of jobs held by students at two-year IHEs were individual paid jobs, compared to 38% of jobs held by students at four-year IHEs. The percentage of jobs held by students at two-year and four-year institutions that were paid internships were similar (27% and 24%).

Over 30% of jobs held by students enrolled in programs at four-year IHEs were in settings that typically pay below minimum wage, e.g., individual and group work training sites paid by stipend and sheltered workshop jobs. Figure 16 illustrates that jobs held by students at two-year IHEs were much more likely to pay above minimum wage than jobs held by students at four-year IHEs.

FIGURE 16: WAGE DISTRIBUTION BY INSTITUTION TYPE, 2012–2013 (N=380 JOBS)*

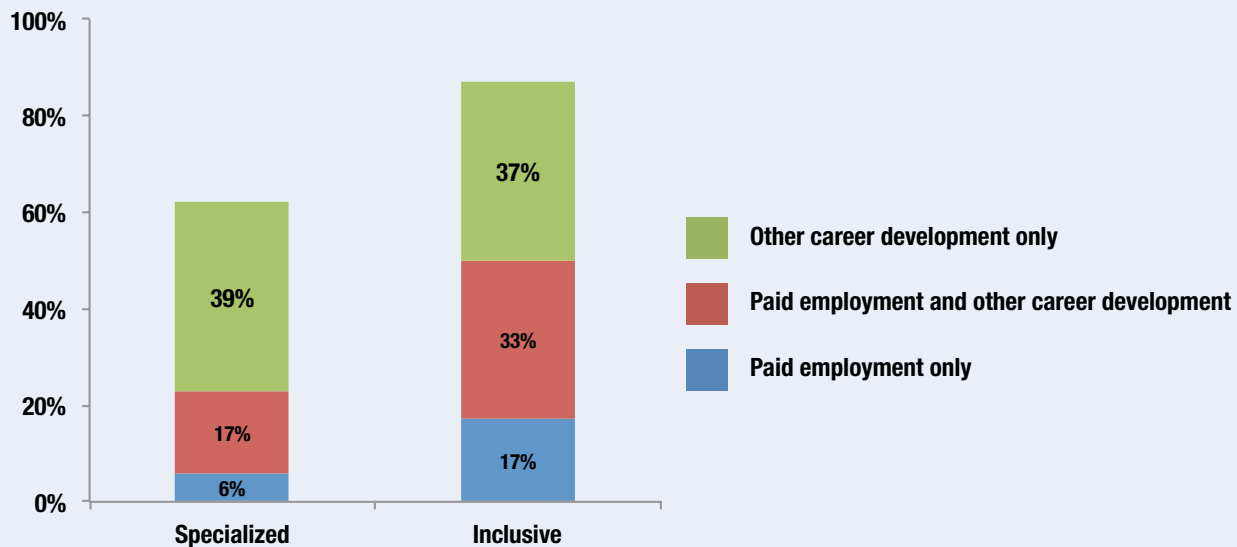


*Jobs records that are missing wage and job setting information are omitted from this chart. Chart also omits data reported at the aggregate level.

Employment and career outcomes for students at academically inclusive and specialized programs

Students who attended programs in which they had greater access to inclusive coursework were more likely to participate in both paid employment and other career development activities than students who attended programs that offered primarily specialized courses. As shown in Figure 17, most students enrolled in academically inclusive programs were participating in career development (87%). The percentage of students from academically specialized programs who participated in career development was over 20% lower (62%). Fifty-four percent of students at academically inclusive programs had a paid job in Year Three. This is the highest percentage of students employed across all subgroups examined.

FIGURE 17: CAREER DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES AMONG TPSID STUDENTS BY INCLUSIVE AND SPECIALIZED PROGRAM STATUS, 2012–2013 (N=801)*



*Only includes students from programs for which we could determine academically inclusive or specialized status. Omits data reported at the aggregate level.

Paid internships were much more common among students in academically inclusive programs. Thirty-seven percent of jobs held by students in academically inclusive programs were paid internships, compared to 13% of jobs held by students in academically specialized programs. Students in academically inclusive programs were more likely to hold jobs that paid above minimum wage than students in academically specialized programs (38% versus 24%). Students in academically inclusive programs were half as likely to earn below minimum wage as students in academically specialized programs (8% versus 19%).

Employment and career outcomes and program partners

Programs that partnered with Community Rehabilitation Providers (CRPs) and state intellectual and developmental disability (IDD) services agencies showed better career development outcomes than programs that did not partner with these organizations. This is not surprising, since IDD agencies coordinate services and supports, including employment services, for adults with ID and CRPs, and are the primary source of employment supports for people with ID (Domin & Butterworth, 2014).

At programs that partner with CRPs, 32% of students in Year Three had a paid job, and 84% were participating in other career activities. This is the highest percentage of students participating in other career activities reported across all subgroups examined. At programs that partnered with state IDD services agencies, 45% of students in Year Three had a paid job and 77% participated in other career development activities.

Only 34 of the 300 students who attended programs that partnered with state IDD agencies did not participate in any career development activities, and most of these students, 23 of the 34, were in their first year of program attendance. TPSID programs that are not already partnering with CRPs and state IDD agencies should work to partner with these organizations.

While programs that partner with VR programs are not statistically different from programs that do not partner with VR programs in terms of career development outcomes, VR programs may want to note the potential benefits of postsecondary education for their clients who have ID. Analysis of administrative data from the VR system showed youth with intellectual disability who participated in higher education were 26% more likely to exit their vocational rehabilitation program with employment and earned a 73% higher weekly income (Migliore & Butterworth, 2008).

CAREER DEVELOPMENT TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

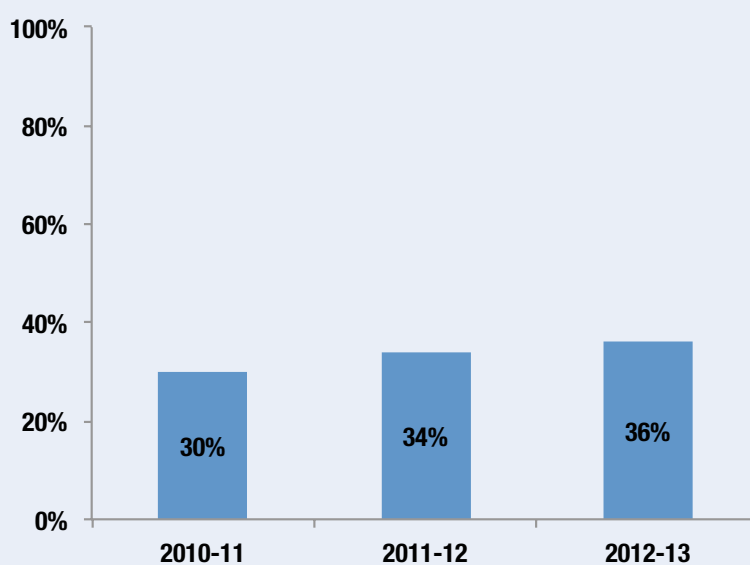
Analysis of three years of career development data shows some promising trends for students. Both the percentage of students working in at least one paid job and the percentage of students participating in other career development activities have increased each year since the TPSID program began (see Figures 18 and 19). Participation in paid employment increased 6% between Years One and Three, and participation in other career development activities increased 10%.

Additionally, students who participate in other career development are participating in more types of activities. Students in Year One participated in 1.29 other career development activities on average, compared with 1.60 per student in Year Two and 1.67 per student in Year Three. Participating in more activities means a broader range of experiences that will be applicable to paid jobs.

Other trends indicate areas where employment outcomes need to improve. Over 10% of paid jobs in Year Three paid below minimum wage. While this is an improvement over Year One, when the rate was more than 20%, students in these programs should not be receiving less than minimum wage in any job.

Students also are working fewer hours per week on average. In Year Three, students worked 10 hours per week or fewer at 59% of paid jobs, compared to 56% in Year Two and 47% in Year One.

FIGURE 18: PERCENTAGE OF STUDENTS WITH PAID EMPLOYMENT, TPSID PROGRAM YEARS ONE THROUGH THREE

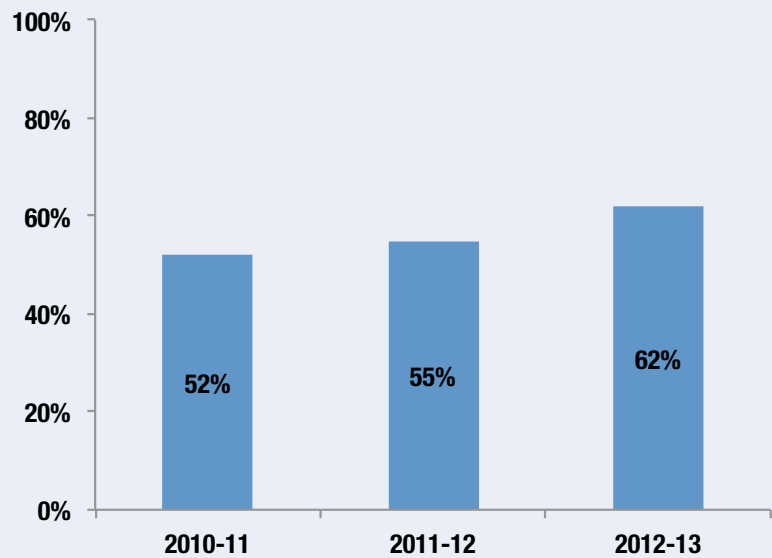


The lower number of hours per week is not necessarily a negative outcome. It is unclear what the appropriate number of hours per week at a paid job is for a student attending a TPSID program and balancing employment with their course of study. During focus groups, some participants said they purposely limited paid work hours to between 6 and 10 hours per week to be sure that adequate time was available for students to focus on their academic responsibilities.

The presence of job supports at paid positions has also decreased in each year of the TPSID program. Job supports were present at 76% of paid jobs held by students in Year

One, 72% of paid jobs in Year Two, and 67% of paid jobs in Year Three. Like the average hours per week, it is difficult to determine whether this trend is a negative or positive one. If the need for supports is stable but they are provided at fewer jobs, the observed trend is negative. Alternatively, if students are being placed in jobs that are a good fit and thus require fewer supports, the trend is positive.

FIGURE 19: PERCENTAGE OF STUDENTS IN OTHER CAREER DEVELOPMENT, TPSID PROGRAM YEARS ONE THROUGH THREE



SELF-DETERMINATION

College and university campuses provide learning and living environments that offer opportunities for growth in self-efficacy and self-determination (Grigal, Weir, Hart, & Opsal, 2013). All TPSIDs require that students actively engage in the learning process, and this experience can lead to both success and failure, both of which can be instructive for the student.

To facilitate the development of self-determination in students with intellectual disabilities, the TPSID programs focused on student involvement in the establishment of personal goals through use of person-centered planning, academic advising, and a stated process for family involvement. While some addressed self-determination in additional ways, the following common measures reflect what was done at most of the TPSID sites.

PLANNING AND ADVISING

Person-centered planning.

According to Orentlicher, “One method to ensure the facilitation of self-determination is the use of person-centered planning which provides a flexible yet structured approach to obtain the student’s perspectives about ‘his or her interests, preferences, and desired lifestyle ... and outline an action plan to achieve desired goals’” (as cited in Fleming-Castaldy & Horning, 2013). The TPSIDs were required to use some type of person-centered planning (PCP) in the development of the course of study for each student to ensure student involvement in and control of academic and career goals.

In Year Three of the program, 98% of TPSIDs (all but one) reported using PCP with students. Over half of TPSID programs reported using a combination of PCP models, 14% percent were using PATH (Planning Alternative Tomorrows with Hope), and 16% were not using a specific PCP model.

Focus group data revealed a rather broad interpretation of what PCP is. Some participants mentioned PATH specifically, while others seem to use a general focus on gearing supports and services to what a person states they want to do and refer to that approach as PCP. Some reported that academic advising and PCP are the same thing, and others felt that these two processes are complementary. Still others felt that academic advising and PCP can be at cross-purposes if there isn’t good communication between those facilitating the two processes.

“I want to say that the path, and the person-centered planning is sort of like the glue that holds everything together and also serves as a spring board for the advisor, whether it be the academic advisor, or the career advisor to make some suggestions. To have some place to start with the student.”

Another challenge related to implementing PCP was that many parents, students, and educators didn’t know what it was.

Student Advising.

The role of academic advisors in college is to assist students to develop their course of study, establish a schedule, and achieve their academic goals. For students on a traditional college pathway toward a degree, academic advising is geared toward credit accumulation, monitoring GPA, and advancing toward a desired degree. The role of the academic advisor in TPSIDs is somewhat different. The advisor must assist the student to achieve goals related to the person-centered plan and attainment of the desired credential.

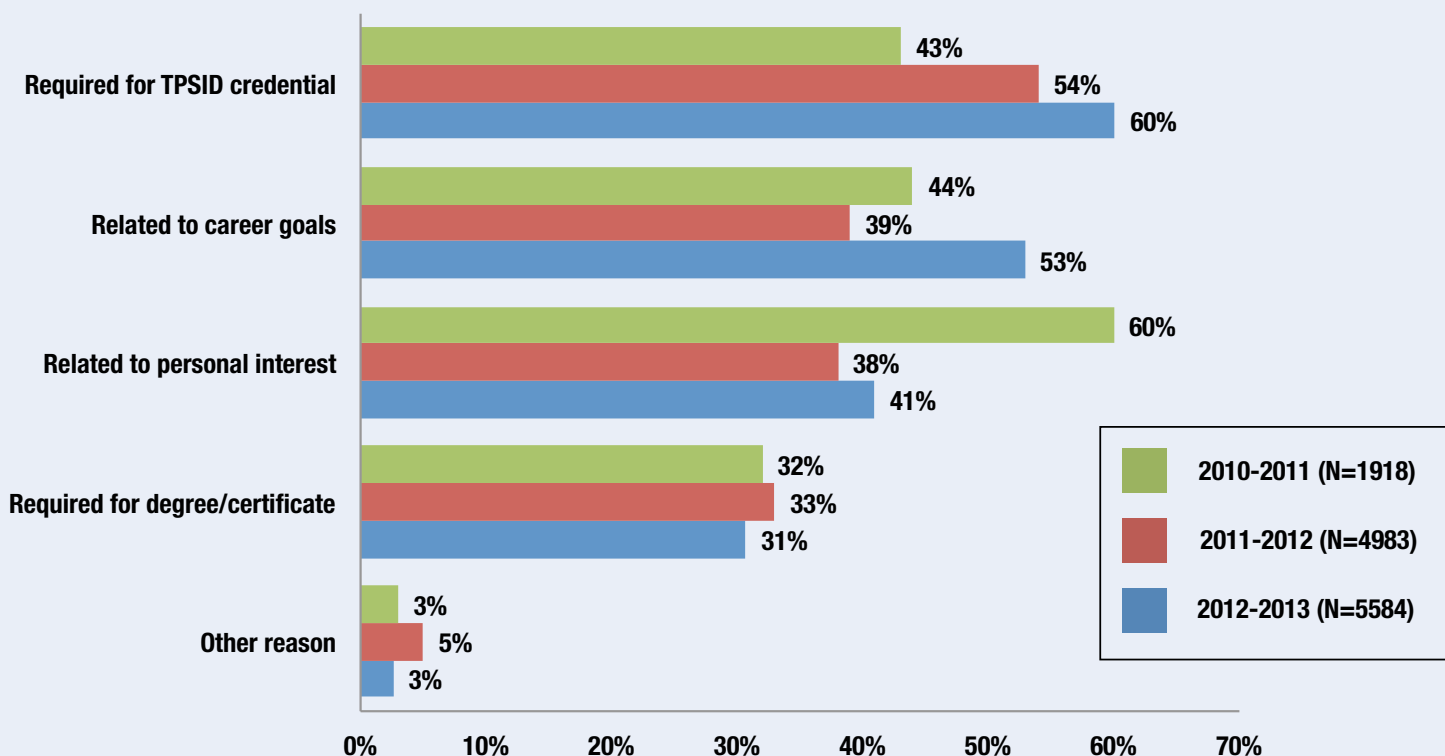
Fifty-two percent of TPSIDs reported using the existing academic advising system. This is comparable to the level of usage found in a national survey of postsecondary programs that served students with ID, which found that 47% of respondents used existing academic advising structures (Grigal et al., 2012).

Thirty-six percent of TPSIDs reported using an additional advising process that was provided internally by the TPSIDs, with 16% using existing academic advising processes exclusively. Forty-eight percent (N=21) used only a separate advising system specially designed for TPSID students.

Enrollment Motivation.

As shown in Figure 20, the most common motivations for course enrollment were that the course was required for the TPSID credential (60% of course enrollments), related to the student's career goals (53%) or personal interests (41%), or required for a degree or certificate (31%).

FIGURE 20: PERCENTAGE OF COURSE ENROLLMENTS BY REASON FOR ENROLLMENT*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

SELF-DETERMINATION TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

Three years of data show that person-centered planning is a standard practice at TPSID programs, with fewer than 10% of programs opting *not* to use PCP in any of the first three years of the project. There has also been very little variation in the types of academic advising used with students. In each year, just under half of the programs used a separate advising system for TPSID students. All other campuses provided at least some access to the existing academic advising office used by other students.

Student motivations for enrolling in particular courses have shifted over time. Year Three saw more students taking courses because they were related to their career goals (53% of enrollments) than in Year One (44%) and Year Two (39%). The percentage of course enrollments that were based upon requirements for a TPSID credential also increased each year. These increases may indicate a greater focus on career development and credential attainment by the TPSID programs.

Focus group participants discussed the different approaches that TPSIDs use in helping students with course selection. There didn't appear to be a single, best strategy. Some staff select college courses from the catalog that align with the stated career goals

of the student, and present a list of course to the student to help with decision making. Others help students choose courses based on interests and career considerations.

Some staff shared that they struggle to see available offerings that align with students' expressed interests. Another TPSID stated that if vocational rehabilitation is covering the cost of tuition, then selected courses have to have career relevance, which sometimes is a challenge.

Some programs aim for a curriculum that includes a set number of required courses and electives. One challenge often faced when trying to provide students with their first choice of classes is that selected courses have prerequisites that either the student hasn't taken, or has no interest in taking.

FAMILY OUTREACH AND INVOLVEMENT

Marketing and Recruitment

Informing the families of potential students about the availability of the TPSID program is a vital aspect of sustainability. Too often, families of transition-age youth with ID are not given sufficient information about available PSE options from transition professionals (Martinez, Conroy, & Cerreto, 2012). Goals related to college or any kind of postsecondary learning are often not included in a student's IEP or transition plan (Grigal et al., 2011; Migliore & Domin, 2011; Papay et al., 2011), and students are not supported to seek access to alternative pathways to college.

A survey of 108 family members of transition-age students with intellectual disabilities conducted by Griffin, McMillan, and Hodapp (2010) revealed that parents have limited knowledge of transition plans and PSE options. The survey also indicated that educators' and parents' post-school expectations for students may not align, and more effective communication is needed. The authors concluded that educators should offer more information about PSE options, even to families of students with lower academic skills.

TPSIDs have developed a variety of strategies to connect with families of prospective students. Out of 44 sites operating in Year Three, more than 50% engaged in the following outreach activities: distributed TPSID marketing materials, presented to local schools (public, private, charter), operated a TPSID website, participated in transition fairs, offered tours of the IHE, presented at parent advocacy and support groups, and included information about the TPSID in general IHE marketing materials.

Information Shared with Students' Families

Sharing information in a postsecondary environment about a student's progress must comply with a variety of legal privacy guidelines. For example, all programs at IHEs must comply with the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA). FERPA gives students 18 years of age or older, or students of any age if enrolled in any postsecondary educational institution, the right of privacy regarding grades, enrollment, and billing information, unless the school has specific permission from the student to share that specific type of information.

TPSIDs shared various kinds of information with family members of attending students. This included general information about the IHE, transition information, and some student-specific information. More than 55% of TPSIDs offered students' families information about IHE-related issues.

In Year Three, TPSIDs offered information to family members about:

- Available social activities (77%)
- The IHE code of conduct (77%)
- Disability-related services available at the IHE (73%)
- FERPA (66%)
- Non-disability-related services (64%)
- Financial aid (59%)
- Disability laws that impact higher education and how they differ from IDEA (57%)

Most programs also shared student-specific information with families. This included information about academics, social and career development, and independent living.

Other transition information was also shared with families, including:

- Information on person-centered planning (84%)
- Connections to agencies/service providers (93%)
- Employer/workplace expectations (59%)

Focus group participants discussed the roles of parents in student's lives while students attend TPSID programs. Some thought that parents can be a valuable resource because they are advocates, can assist with employment networking, have community ties, and encourage high expectations in students. Some expressed the need to provide parents with support during this difficult time as their child transitions into a young adult with more independence.

Parents have also presented some obstacles for TPSID program administrators. Many administrators commented that some parents don't understand that independence and competitive employment are goals of college programs:

"We have families who never have heard of any of the services. They don't know about VR, they don't know about waivers, they don't know about outside case management for our community service system. They just don't know any of that stuff and so they're not connected to any of those services. And because of budget cuts they are sitting on waiting lists for years and years. And so that's been a big challenge for us of not having those community partners to be able to support them in finding jobs and using waivers and other things to pay."

In addition to helping parents acclimate to the expectations for campus independence and adult systems navigation, TPSID staff also must help them understand the differences between services and supports that are provided as entitlements and those that are accessed based upon eligibility. These processes differ from those used in secondary education, as is the process for getting information about their child from the IHE.

Parents whose children are dually enrolled in the IHE can continue to participate in educational planning via the IEP process. But parents of students who are attending the TPSID program as adults (and who are no longer receiving special education services) have more limitations about what they can freely access about their adult child's college program. The Family and Education Privacy Right Act guidelines that all IHEs must abide by limits access to certain forms student information unless the student signs a waiver. Therefore, parents may have significantly less information about their child's academic progress than they would have had during their child's K-12 education.

Helping parents understand the policies and procedures that guide their involvement in a higher education setting is an important part of intake and orientation activities, as well as ongoing communications.

CAMPUS MEMBERSHIP

A college experience is more than simply taking classes. Much of what students learn during their time happens outside of the classroom, and this holds true for students in TPSID programs.

The TPSIDs facilitate campus membership, providing access to and supports for campus facilities and technology, as well as for participation in existing social organizations. Engaging students in campus activities may also change the nature of their social networks, making students less reliant on family connections and increasing their peer contacts (Eisenman, Farley-Ripple, Culnane, & Freedman, 2014).

SOCIAL LIFE

Facilitating the development of social networks is key to providing a well-rounded college experience for students with ID. A literature review by Test et al. (2009) showed a strong association between greater social competence, increased postsecondary educational participation, and improved employment outcomes after leaving high school. Folk, Yamamoto, and Stodden reported that in interviews of TPSID students in Hawaii, “opportunity for social interaction presented by participation in postsecondary education was a prevalent theme.”

In addition, possessing greater social skills may be associated with increased self-determination (Carter, Trainor, Owens, Swedeen, & Sun, 2010). Eisenman et al. (2014) suggest that social networks may impact future employment. Supporting students to access existing social organizations, supporting use of technology for social communication, and engaging students without disabilities as natural supports for social activities help provide a well-rounded, authentic college experience.

Keuka College

Robert was the first student with an intellectual disability to live on the Keuka College campus as part of the D.R.I.V.E. (Diversity, Responsibility, Inclusion, Vision, and Experiential Learning) Program. During his time at Keuka, Robert contributed to the community and gained self-confidence.

In addition to recruiting college students to become peer mentors for the D.R.I.V.E. Program, Robert worked with Keuka staff to create a video that chronicles his life as a student with an intellectual disability. He often shared his experiences with others in the community and spoke about increasing options for students with disabilities.

Robert served as a member of the student senate, dance team, and D.R.I.V.E. steering committee. He also played a role in managing the college basketball team.

“It made me a new man,” says Robert. “I learned a lot in the classroom and on campus with mentors.” Robert looks forward to continuing his employment at Keuka, where he will use his skills across a number of departments on campus.

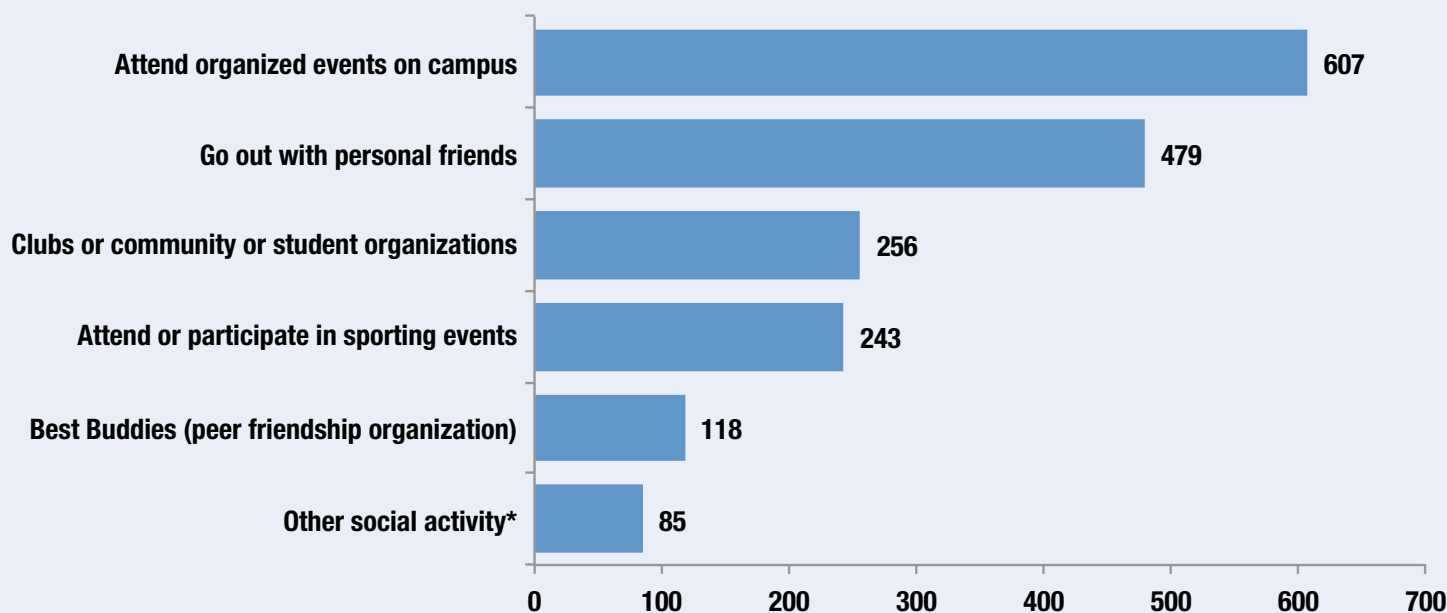


In 2012–2013, students participated in numerous social activities, including attending events on campus, going out with friends, and attending or participating in sporting events (see Figure 21). The majority of students participated in a variety of activities. Overall, 8.9% of students were reported as not having participated in any social activities. Seventeen of forty-three sites reported one or more students who did not participate in social activities in Year Three. The percentage of students at these programs who had no reported social activities ranged from 1.9% to 43.4%, with 15.7% being the average number of students at these campuses.

Caution should be used in interpreting lack of participation in a negative light. Given that all of the TPSIDs were required to use person-centered planning to guide students’ programs of study, it is possible that some students chose not to participate in campus-based activities or organizations. Not all college students want to join campus clubs and organizations, and the students in the TPSID programs should not be coerced to join in activities in which they do not want to participate.

However, if programs had large percentages of students that did not engage in any activities, this may indicate that greater efforts could be made by the program staff to facilitate opportunities for student involvement.

FIGURE 21: STUDENTS’ SOCIAL PARTICIPATION, 2012–2013 (N=821)*

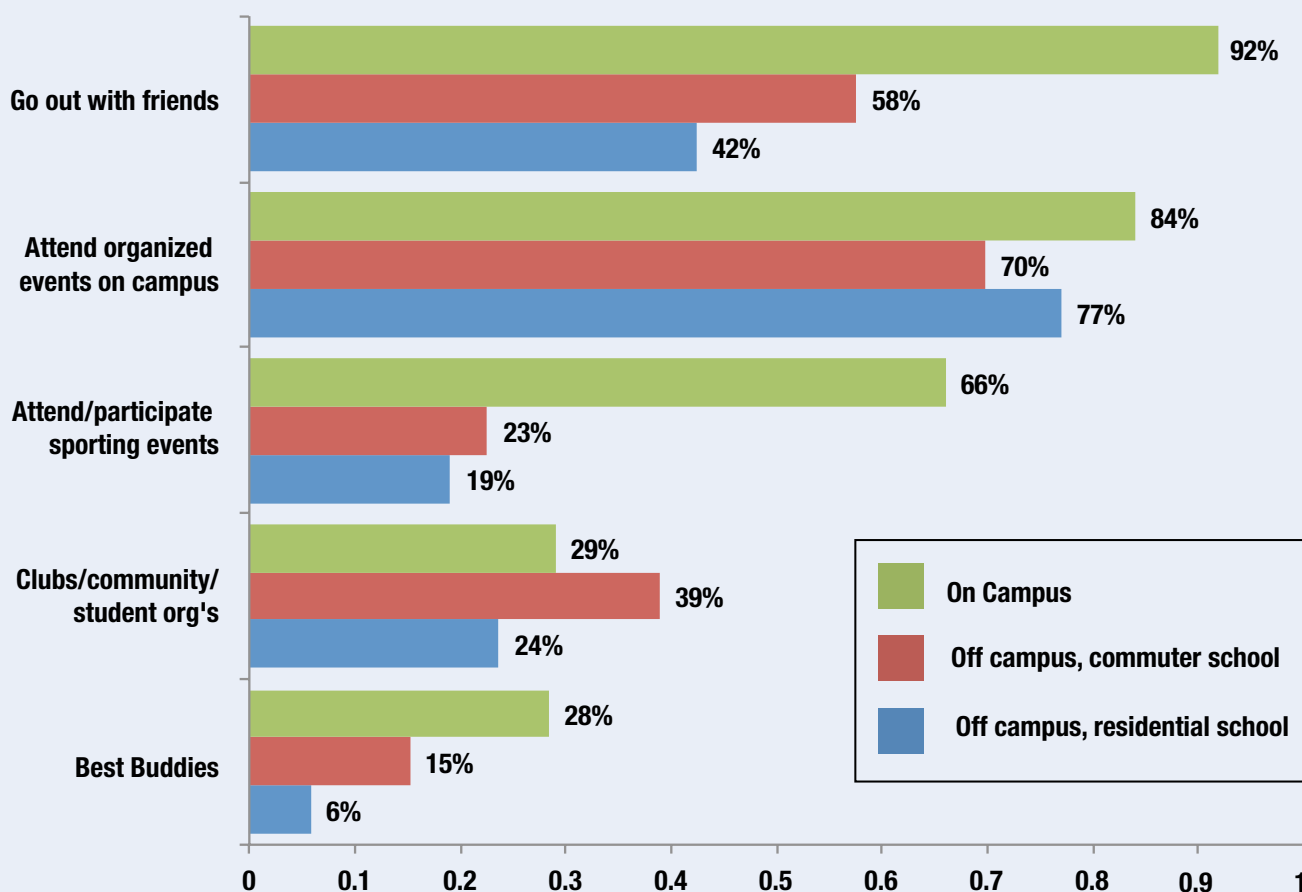


*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

As indicated in Figure 22, students who lived in TPSID or IHE housing generally had higher levels of participation in social activities. One exception was students who lived off-campus and attending commuter schools. These students had a higher participation in clubs and community organizations, which may reflect that students not living on campus are more likely to be participating in community organizations outside of the IHE.

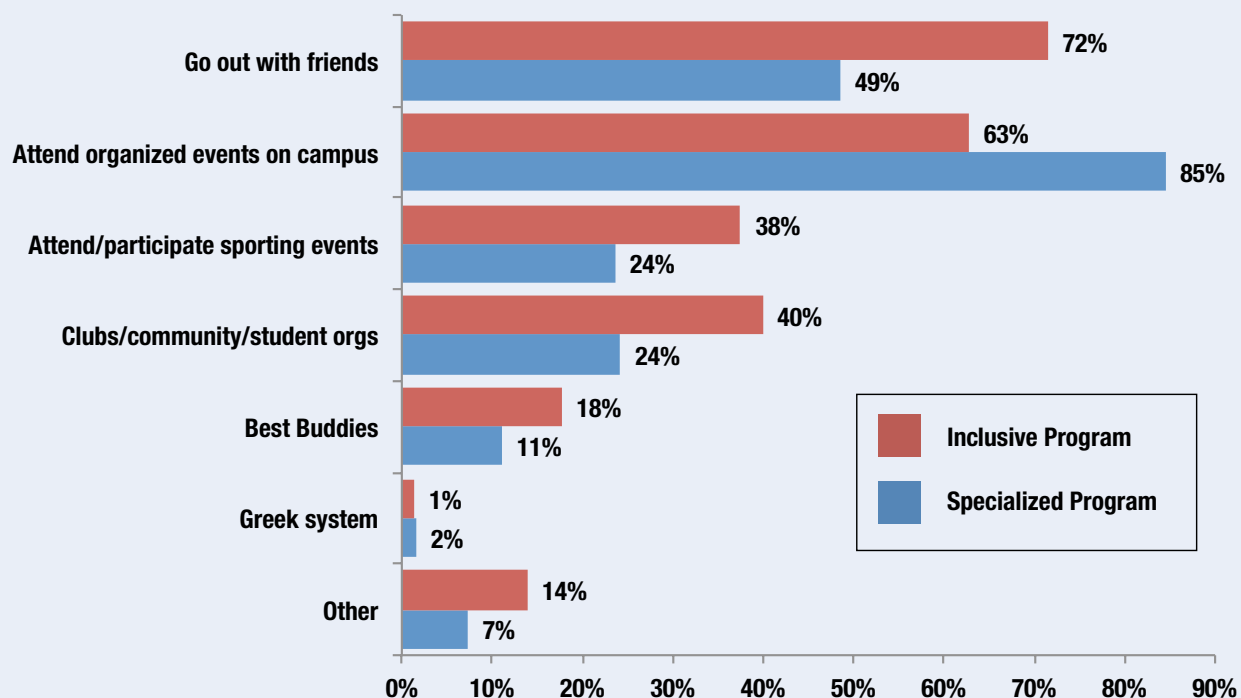
Among those living off campus, students attending IHEs that offer housing were more likely to attend organized events on campus, perhaps because more events are offered at residential IHEs. Those attending commuter schools were more likely to go out with friends, attend or participate in sporting events, participate in clubs or community organizations, and participate in Best Buddies–type programs.

FIGURE 22: PARTICIPATION IN SOCIAL ACTIVITIES BY LIVING SITUATION



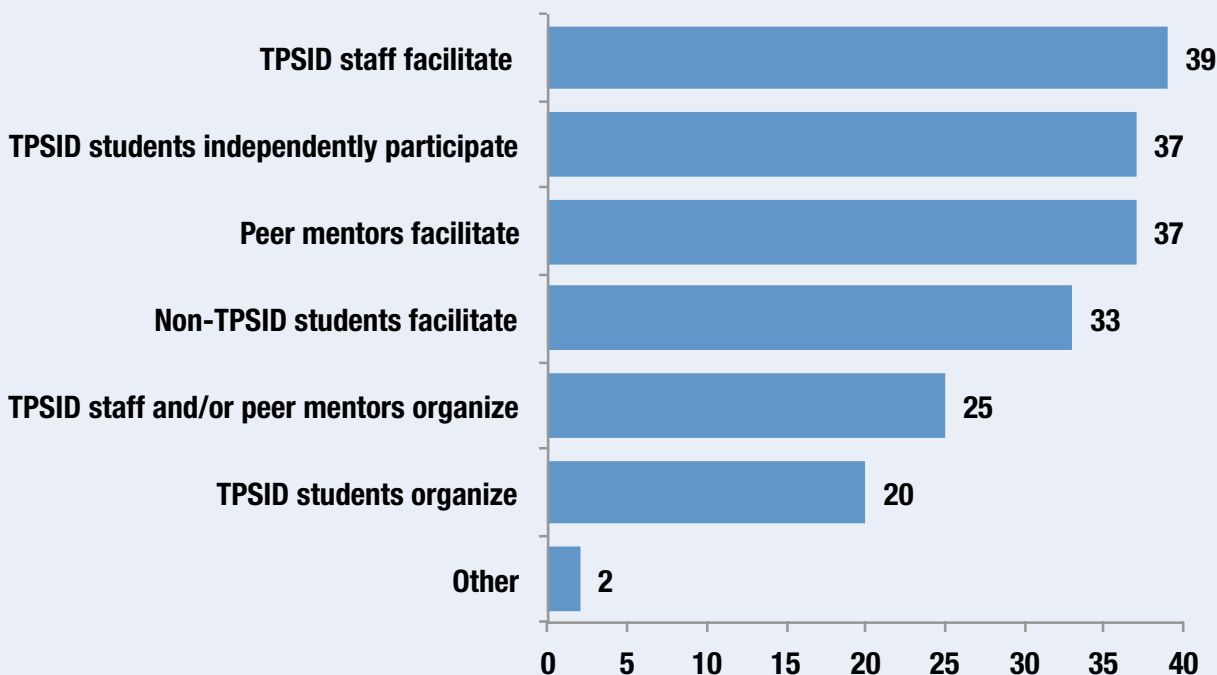
As shown in Figure 23, students in academically inclusive programs were more likely to participate in every type of social activity except organized events on campus.

FIGURE 23: PARTICIPATION IN SOCIAL ACTIVITIES BY TYPE OF PROGRAM



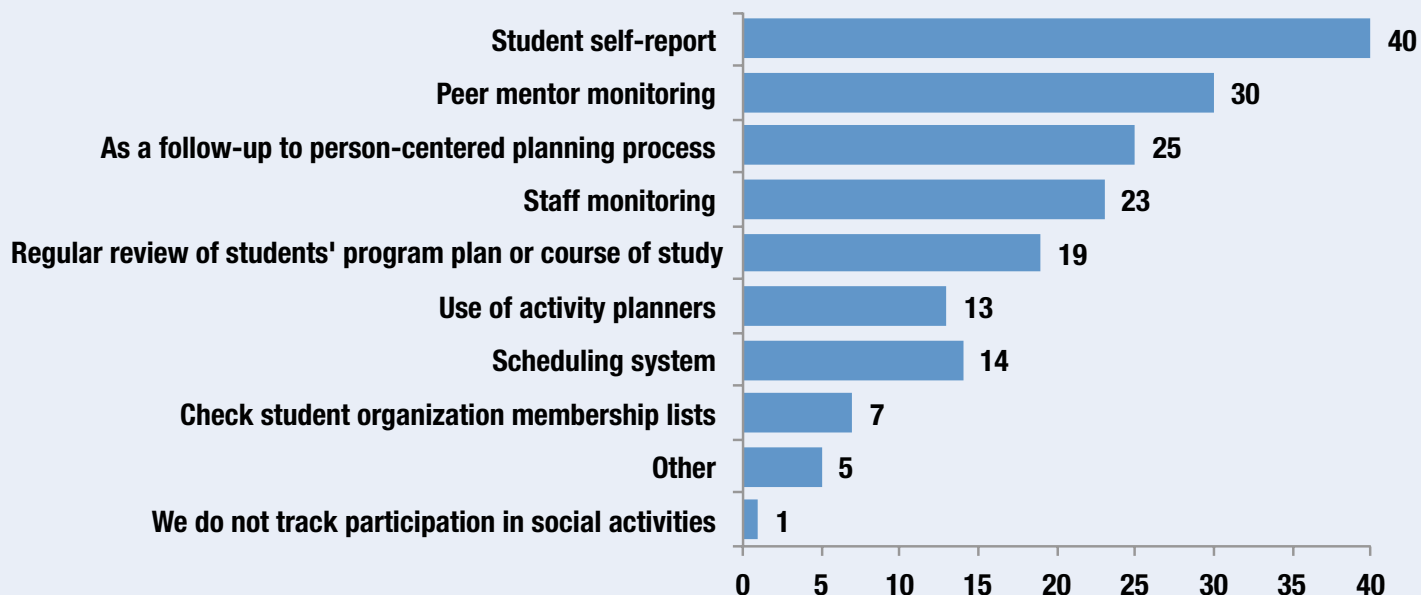
In 2012–2013, every TPSID reported facilitating or supporting student participation in campus social activities. A variety of approaches were used to facilitate social participation, with the most common being facilitation by TPSID staff, independent participation, and facilitation by peer mentors, and the least common being events organized by students, staff, and/or peer mentors associated with the TPSID (see Figure 24).

FIGURE 24: STRATEGIES USED TO SUPPORT PARTICIPATION IN SOCIAL ACTIVITIES, 2012–2013 (N=44 SITES)



Almost all TPSIDs had mechanisms to track social activities students were participating in on campus (Figure 25). The most frequently used mechanism was student self-report, followed by peer mentor monitoring.

FIGURE 25: STRATEGIES USED TO TRACK PARTICIPATION IN SOCIAL ACTIVITIES, 2012–2013 (N=44 SITES)



FOCUS GROUP FINDINGS ON SOCIAL PARTICIPATION

Strategies to support social participation

When focus group participants were asked about strategies to support campus membership, several mentioned the use of paid and/or volunteer peer mentors. Another common tactic was offering various opportunities to learn about and discuss social issues. In some programs exploring social issues was done in a more formal arrangement as part of summer orientation and/or ongoing seminars offered throughout the year to discuss social issues on campus. Others offered more informal support groups or drop-in support services. Support groups could include other students in the TPSID program, peer mentors, and/or staff.

Some TPSIDs described supporting students' social lives by teaching them to plan their own activities. For example, one program was teaching students to use social media to get friends together. Another TPSID worked on helping students identify the resources on campus and learn how to use them so they could be less reliant on the program coordinator.

Natural supports also played a role in facilitating campus membership. One focus group participant described how, at their commuter campus, "for our guys and ladies [the day] starts on the bus, like the city bus. And what we've found is a lot ... people who work at the college happen to ride the same bus. We've been able to encourage our folks [students] to talk to them. We're getting some nice natural supports maybe with a little unnatural prompting. But it's been nice and really almost better than the peer supports in terms of the organic nature of it."

The level of independence students are offered on campus may be related to their perceived (rather than actual) competence. Focus group discussions revealed that some programs create strict schedules that offer students little opportunity for making choices in their daily activities, which can impede the development of self-determined behavior.

One participant shared frustration with this limitation:

"I wish I could say ... that we were moving towards the spectrum of inclusion, but in reality a lot of our sites are doing a pendulum swing. And it really has to do a lot with the misperception of competence and capability of our students. And also safety and liability, misperceptions of safety and liability. And what we're finding is we gravitate them towards ideas of inclusion and having students out on campus. But we find that they [the program] routinize every single detail of their [the student's] day so that it's scheduled. And students aren't really driven to have any independence. They've created all of these specialized topics and clubs and courses that are impeding a student's ability to get on the campus and experience what's there."

Certain activities are particularly effective at creating connections

Focus group participants noted that certain types of activities create more connections than others. For example, they reported encouraging students to join clubs in order to meet other students with similar interests. Said one participant, "Some of the best relationships and friendships really have come out of students who are in ... clubs doing activities and things they like doing together like cooking club or anime club or ... engineering club or whatever."

There is a struggle to balance independence and safety

One theme that emerged from the focus groups was the challenge of promoting independence and campus participation given some of the inherent risks of college life, such as drinking and sexual behavior.

Focus group participants shared the perspective that when TPSID students engage in risky behavior, it can be detrimental on two levels. First, they run a personal risk both of harm to themselves and of getting in trouble for violations of the school's code of conduct. Second, such behaviors can pose a threat to the TPSID program itself, in that the campus may be less supportive of the whole program if students are getting into trouble.

This level of scrutiny of students in the TPSID program reflects the relative newness both of the programs themselves and of the idea of access to college for students with intellectual disabilities. As one focus group participant put it, “we find ourselves walking a pretty fine line between promoting self-determination and inclusion and at the same time trying to help students realize ‘you could be putting yourself at risk’. And the most difficult part about it is not that they’re only putting themselves at risk, but they’re putting the program at risk.

RESIDENTIAL LIFE AND ACCESS

TPSIDs are encouraged to provide access to college campus resources for students such as inclusive courses, when possible, independent living arrangements. Living in an integrated setting contributes to a myriad of positive outcomes for college students enhancing both their academic performance and their personal and social development (de Araujo & Murray, 2010).

For TPSID programs, providing campus living brings up several challenges. These include supporting students’ self-determination, addressing parents’ concerns, and dealing with the interpersonal and sexual issues that inevitably arise on a college campus but may be exacerbated by delayed social development of students with ID (Latham, Carson, & Hendrickson, 2013):

“Our first year students live on campus, and second year they all live in the community. One of the prevailing themes of those who leave, who are in the second year ... is that they all say is that “we’re tired of the drama that occurs.” And a lot of it’s just dorm drama. You know those relationships literally change every week sometimes. We know that 18 percent of our graduates marry, so that’s good. So you know they might meet their spouse in the program but also I think it’s just developmentally these guys are going through all kind of different experiences, you know, as far as relationships goes. And then our students in the second year, I think really start mellowing out. And I think they like being in the community. They’re more involved in the community. And in their words, they’re away from the drama.”

In their initial applications for TPSID funding, 11 of the 27 grantees (40%) indicated on-campus housing would be available to TPSID students, and eight indicated they were working with their IHE administration to provide TPSID students access to on-campus housing. In 2012–2013, half of TPSIDs (50%) were at IHEs that did not provide housing to any students. Of those that did offer housing, 14 provided students in the TPSID access to that housing, and eight did not.

The majority (62%) of students lived with family. This is not atypical for young adults regardless of disability. A recent Pew research study found that 53% of young adults between the ages of 18 and 24 live with their parents. The remaining students were fairly evenly divided among residences provided by the IHE or TPSID (19%) and other residences not provided by the IHE or TPSID (17%).

Creating residential experiences presents a challenge for many of the host IHEs. Some of these challenges relate to logistics, such as finding space on campus or locating off campus apartments that have access to transportation. Other challenges relate to issues of supervision, safety, and liability. These topics were prevalent in the focus group discussions.

Most of the 162 students living in TPSID- or IHE-provided housing lived in residence halls or off-campus apartments where most residents were other students attending the college (Figure 26). Just under half of those living off-campus (but not with their families) lived independently, with another quarter in supervised living settings (Figure 27).

FIGURE 26: TPSID- OR IHE-PROVIDED LIVING SITUATIONS, 2012–2013

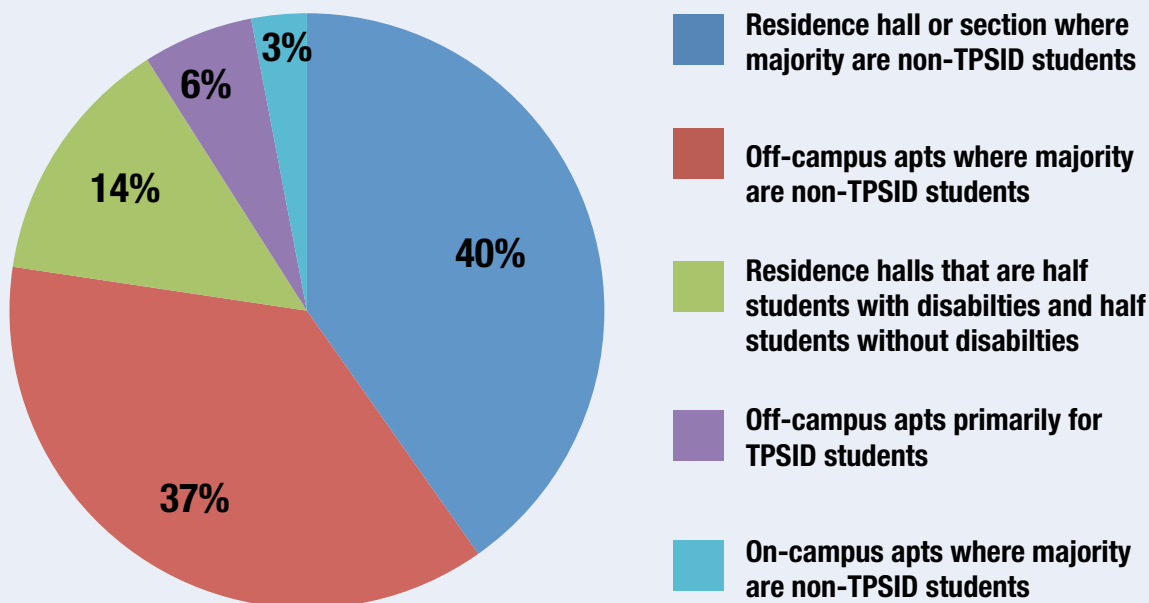
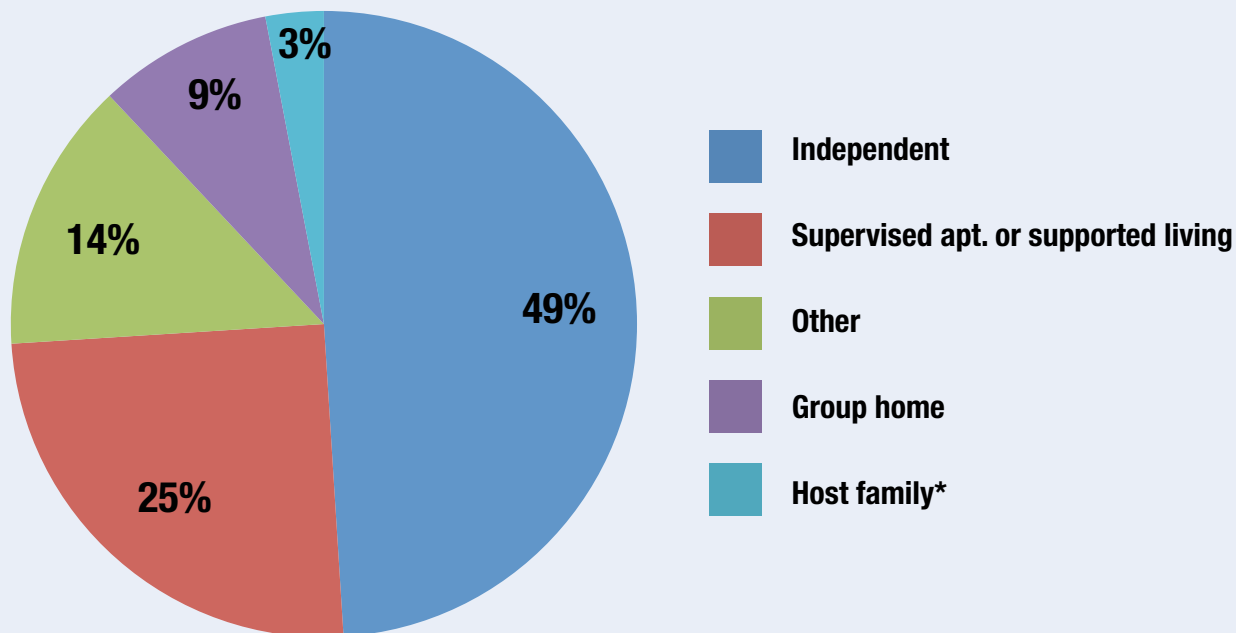


FIGURE 27: NON-IHE-AFFILIATED LIVING SITUATIONS, 2012–2013



Most students not living with family (85%) received some sort of residential supports, most typically from intermittent or on-call staff (51%), a residential assistant or advisor (40%), continuous staff support (25%), and/or a roommate/suitemate who received compensation (16%). Eighteen percent did not receive any residential supports.

TRANSPORTATION TO CLASS AND CAMPUS

Students who lived on campus got to class by walking, driving, bicycling, and/or by taking the campus bus. Students not living on campus most frequently relied on friends or family members for transportation. Public transportation, para-transit, and taxis were common transportation modes for both groups (Table 8). Few students relied on TPSID staff, IDD agency transportation, or local education agency transportation.

TABLE 8. TRANSPORTATION TYPE AND PERCENTAGE OF USE TO GET TO AND FROM CAMPUS, 2012–2013

	STUDENTS LIVING IN IHE OR TPSID HOUSING (N = 162)	STUDENTS LIVING ELSEWHERE (N = 646)
EXISTING TRANSPORTATION OPTIONS		
Drives self / walks / rides bike	90%	31%
Friend or family member	9%	54%
Public transportation or para-transit or taxi	39%	37%
IHE transportation (campus bus)	39%	7%
Transportation provided by IDD agency	1%	7%
PROGRAM-SPECIFIC TRANSPORTATION OPTIONS		
LEA-provided transport	0%	10%
TPSID staff	4%	14%
We do not know how this student gets to campus	0%	2%
This student does not go to campus	0%	1%
Other	1%	2%

CAMPUS MEMBERSHIP TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

Students attending TPSID programs have shown themselves to be very socially active in each of the three years data has been collected. Over 90% of students were reported to be participating in some type of social activity in each of the first three years of the TPSID program, and many students participated in many types of social activities each year.

Year Three was the first year in which attending organized events on campus was the most frequently selected social activity for students, surpassing going out with friends, which had previously been the top category in Years 1 and 2. This shows greater engagement with the campus community and formalized social events at the institution.

In all three years, TPSID staff has played a role in supporting social participation at most of the campuses. Many campuses have also consistently relied on peer mentors, other students, and students in the TPSID themselves to facilitate social participation.

In each year, fewer than half of the campuses with TPSID programs have been residential campuses; that is, most IHEs where TPSIDs are located are “commuter schools.” Among those that did have campus housing, the majority offered housing to students attending the TPSID. The percentage increased from 52% in Year One to 67% in Year Two, and decreased slightly to 64% in Year Three.

Student engagement research has made it clear that a residential postsecondary experience leads to positive outcomes. Results from a recent National Survey of Student Engagement affirm the value of residential living, as on-campus residents were more likely to bond with other students, engage in campus events, and experience greater gains in learning and development (NSSE, 2011). TPSID programs on residential campuses that do not provide students with access to campus housing should consider how they might create these experiences in the future.

While the majority of students attending TPSIDs have lived with family, the percentage of students who live in TPSID- or IHE-affiliated housing has increased each year: 13% in Year One, 16% in Year Two, and 20% in Year Three. Most of these students live in inclusive campus housing, meaning that they lived in the same residences as other college students without disabilities.

Initiating residential access can take a great deal of time within the university setting. Some of the issues that must be addressed are concerns from administration, and sometimes from family members, about student safety and risk, as well as management of staff and level of supervision during non-academic hours. However, the potential benefits are large enough to make this time investment worthwhile.

STUDENT EXIT OUTCOMES

A total of 297 students exited their TPSID program in Year Three. Figure 28 summarizes the reasons for exit.

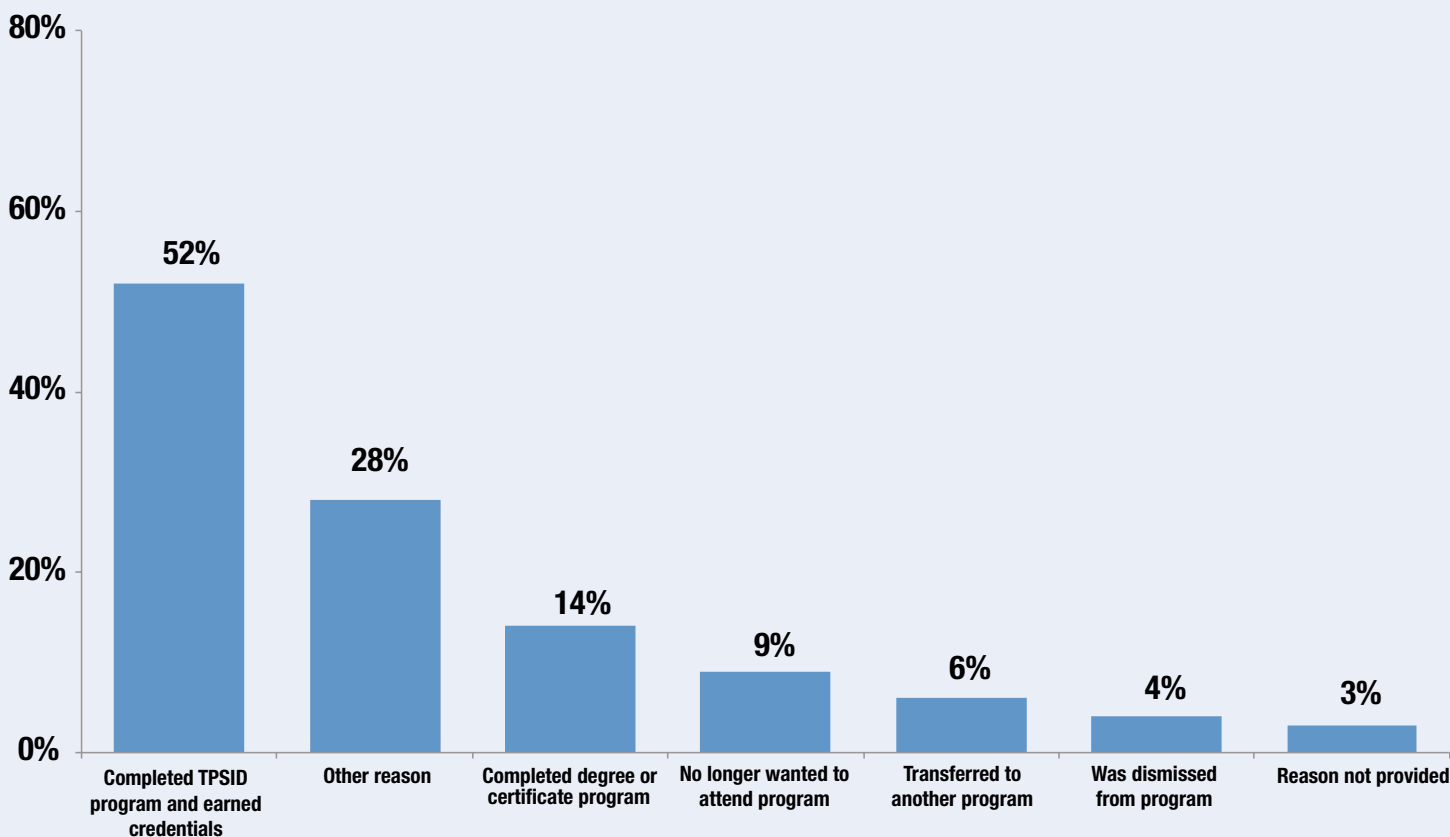
The most common reason for exit was having completed the program and earned a credential (52%). Of these, forty students exited with a degree or certificate. Twenty-five students exited because they no longer wanted to attend the program. Sixteen students left the TPSID and transferred to a general postsecondary program to continue their education. Eleven of these students transferred to programs at two-year IHEs, four students transferred to programs at four-year IHEs, and one student transferred to a program at a vocational or technical school.

Most of these students were not employed when they exited their TPSID program. This likely indicates a continued focus on academic pursuits, rather than a failure to achieve a career outcome.

These findings also point to a need for the credentials that students receive when exiting these programs to be recognized by other IHEs when students move on to further higher education or transfer between institutions. According to the Community College Research Center, up to 40% of community college students enroll in multiple institutions within a six-year period. As the credentialing process continues to evolve, programs will need to work collectively on developing credentials that have meaning outside of the institution that awarded them. In that way, students will be empowered and encouraged to continue their higher education beyond the TPSID program.

Twenty eight percent of students listed “Other” as their reason for program exit. Other reasons included completing a program that did not offer a credential, not having the financial resources to continue attending, health problems that prevented further attendance, and not being able to continue due to lack of academic progress.

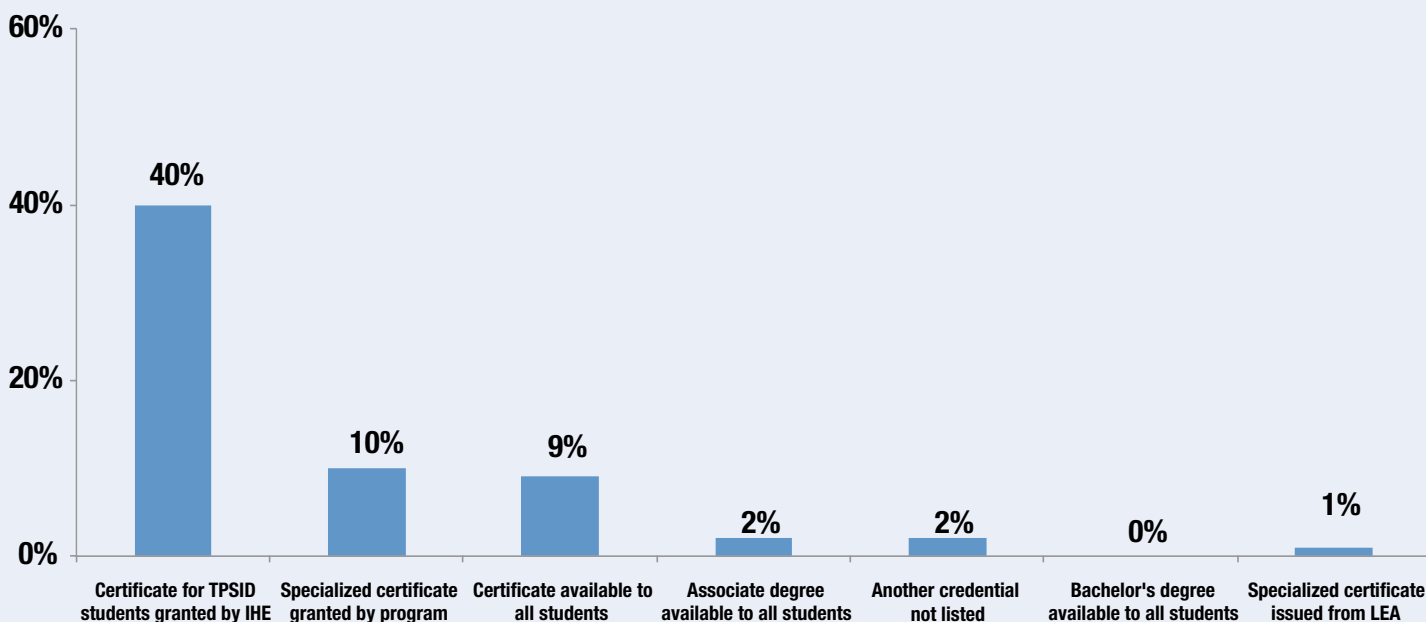
FIGURE 28: REASONS FOR STUDENT EXIT FROM TPSID PROGRAMS, 2012–2013 (N=297 EXITING STUDENTS)



CREDENTIALS EARNED BY STUDENTS

Overall, 60% of the students who exited earned one or more credentials before exiting. Figure 29 shows the percentage of students who earned each type of credential. In Year Three, a certificate granted by the IHE that is only available to students attending the TPSID program was the most common credential earned, followed by a certificate or exit document for TPSID students awarded by the TPSID (not the IHE), and a certificate available to all students. National averages for credential attainment for typical students who begin a postsecondary program are just over 40% (Lumina Foundation, 2014).

FIGURE 29: CREDENTIALS EARNED, 2012–2013 (N=297 EXITING STUDENTS)



Credentials earned by students exiting programs at two-year and four-year institutions

Students who exited programs at two-year IHEs were slightly more likely to have earned a credential than students who exited programs at four-year IHEs (63% versus 56%). A certificate specifically for students in the TPSID program granted by the IHE was the most common credential at both two-year and four-year IHEs. Forty-five percent of students exiting two-year IHEs earned this credential, compared to 35% of students exiting programs at four-year IHEs.

Certificates available to all students were more common among students exiting two-year IHEs (15%) compared to students exiting four-year IHEs (just 2%). Certificates or other exit documents granted by the TPSID, not the IHE, were more common among students exiting four-year IHEs (15%) compared to students exiting two-year IHEs (6%).

There is currently no standard credential awarded by TPSIDs, and in fact, it is doubtful that there ever will be. However, those programs that provide students with a path to attain credentials or certificates already recognized by the IHE may have advantages. Programs that offer credentials that are only recognized by the TPSID program and are not officially granted by the IHE may have limited meaning to both employers and to future IHEs, similar to the limitations seen by students who exit high school with certificates of attendance. Clarifying the expected courses of study, connecting these to recognized skills or labor market standards, and ensuring credential options are recognized both within and outside of the IHE should be the focus of future efforts around credentialing.

Credentials earned by students who had a majority of enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year of attendance

In Year Three, students who exited and had a majority of their enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year were more likely to have earned a credential (71%) than their counterparts for whom no more than 50% of course enrollments were inclusive (60%). Nineteen students were reported as not having enrolled in any courses in their final year, and only two of these students exited with a credential.

Students who had a majority of their course enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year were also more likely to have earned a credential available to all students at the IHE, as opposed to a credential that was limited to students attending the TPSID. Twenty-four percent earned a certificate available to all students. Students who had a majority of their course enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year earned a certificate or exit document granted by the TPSID program, not the IHE, and only available to students attending the TPSID program (24% of exiting students), a certificate available only to students attending the TPSID program and granted by the IHE (26%), and associate degrees (5%). All other credentials were earned by fewer than 5% of students who had a majority of their enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year.

Fifty-five percent of students for whom less than 50% of their course enrollments were inclusive earned a certificate available only to students in the TPSID (whether granted by the program or the IHE). One of these students earned a certificate available to all students, one earned an associate degree, and five earned another credential not listed on the evaluation system form.

Credentials earned by students who had a majority of enrollments in credit-bearing courses in their final year of attendance

When students attended only courses for credit, whether it was for IHE credit or TPSID credit, their outcomes related to credential attainment were improved on several measures. These students were more likely to earn some type of credential. Also, 36% earned a certificate available to all students, compared to none of the students whose enrollments in their final year were comprised of no more than 50% of courses that awarded standard IHE credit.

Enrolling in credit-bearing courses in each year of attendance, not just their final year of attendance, also led to better exit outcomes. Seventy-three percent of students who had a majority of their enrollments in credit-bearing courses in each year of attendance earned a credential, compared to just 24% of students whose enrollments each year were comprised of no more than 50% of courses that awarded standard IHE credit.

Credentials earned by students who were dually enrolled in high school and a TPSID for the entirety of their program attendance

One fifth of the students who exited in Year Three were dually enrolled in high school and their TPSID the entire time they attended the program. These students were less likely to earn a credential before exiting than students who were enrolled as an adult student (i.e., no longer enrolled in high school) for part or all of the time they attended the TPSID (37% versus 67%). This may be because they earned an exit document from high school (e.g., diploma or certificate).

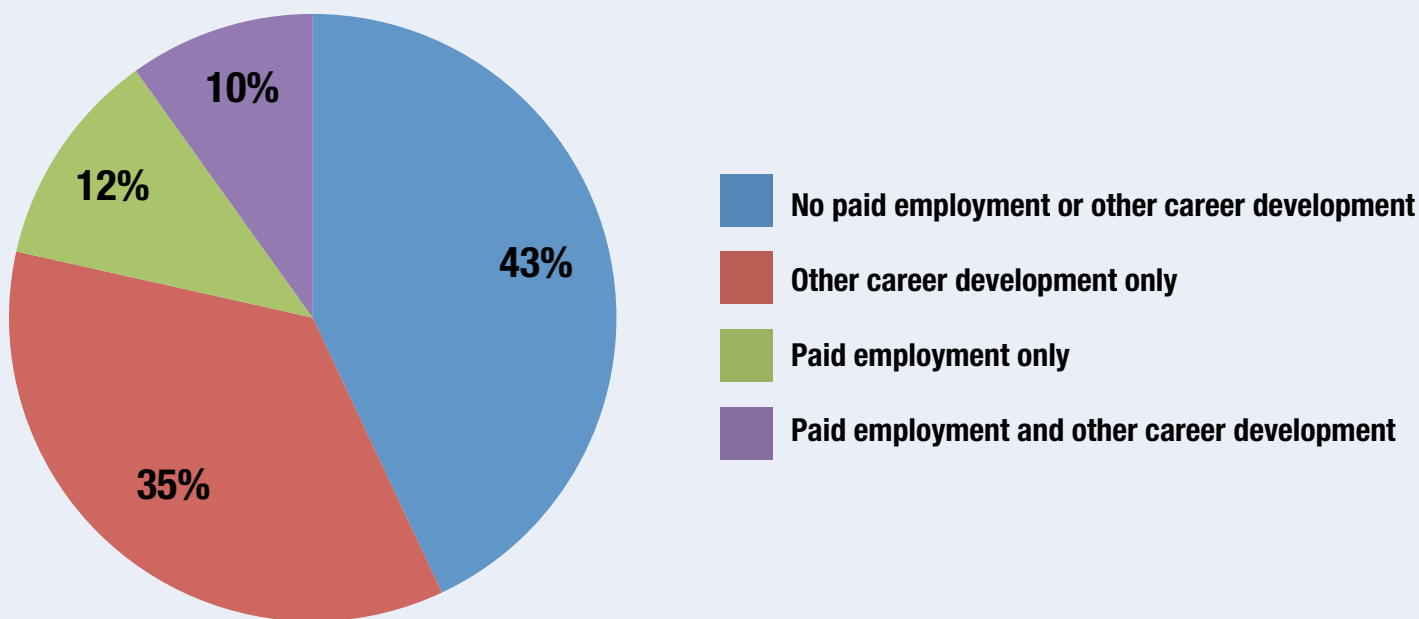
EMPLOYMENT AND CAREER OUTCOMES FOR STUDENTS WHO EXITED TPSID PROGRAMS IN YEAR THREE

Over half of the students who exited in Year Three (57%) were reported as having a paid job, participating in unpaid career development activities, or doing both at the time they exited (see Figure 30). Sixty-five students were working in a paid job, and 133 participated in some sort of unpaid career development activities. Twenty-nine students were both employed for pay and participating in unpaid career development activities when they exited their program.

These data reflect the student's employment status on the day of exit, and do not account for students who gained jobs soon after exiting the program. During focus groups discussions, TPSIDs mentioned that often, the jobs students get may not start immediately upon graduation. A review of records for students who exited in Year 3 revealed an additional 19 students started paid jobs within 4 months of exit. Seventeen of these 19 positions were individual paid jobs. Much like their college peers, engaging in the job search can take time. It will be very important to examine the follow-up data collected by the TPSIDs to ascertain the level of employment outcomes three to six months after leaving the TPSID.

Another issue is that many of the students attending the TPSIDs are out-of-state or out-of-region students. Therefore, they are likely to be seeking jobs in the home location. This factor also may impact the immediacy of their being employed at exit.

FIGURE 30: EMPLOYMENT AND CAREER DEVELOPMENT STATUS OF STUDENTS WHO EXITED IN YEAR THREE (N=293 EXITING STUDENTS)*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

Paid jobs held by students after program exit

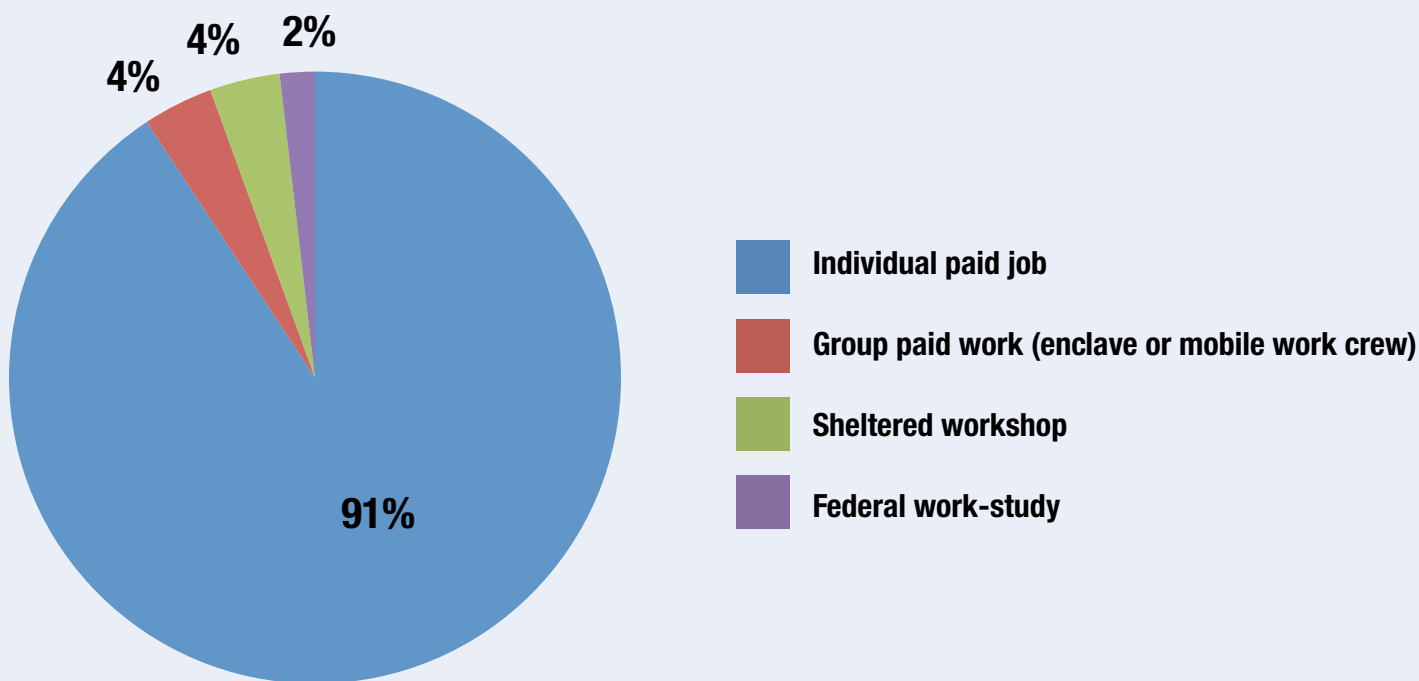
- » Animal food preparer at a zoo
- » Customer service associate at a travel organization
- » Mailroom assistant at an office solutions provider
- » Receptionist at a non-profit organization
- » Help desk staff at a college
- » Clerk at a local library
- » Oil change attendant at a garage
- » Waiter at a restaurant

Most students employed at exit were in individual paid jobs (Figure 31). A very small percentage of individuals (4%) are still working at sheltered workshops when they leave their program. One focus group participant mentioned that this is the result of parental expectations being too low.

TPSID programs must convey to students and families that the intended outcome of these programs is to prepare students either to continue their higher education, or to hold a competitive job in an integrated setting. If the student or their family does not desire either of these outcomes, they likely should not pursue this course of study. One suggestion to address this issue was to have a contract with the family that clearly outlines the goals of the program.

On average, students with paid employment at exit worked 17 hours per week and earned \$8.15 per hour.

FIGURE 31: PAID JOBS HELD BY STUDENTS WHO EXITED A TPSID PROGRAM, 2012–2013 (N=54 JOBS)*



*Excludes jobs where job type was not reported. Categories sum to more than 100% due to rounding error.

Employment and career outcomes for students exiting programs at two-year and four-year IHEs

In Year Three, students who exited programs at two-year IHEs had similar employment rates to students who exited programs at four-year IHEs (21% and 22% respectively). However, students from two-year IHEs were much less likely to be participating in other career development activities at exit (35%, versus 58% of students exiting programs at four-year IHEs).

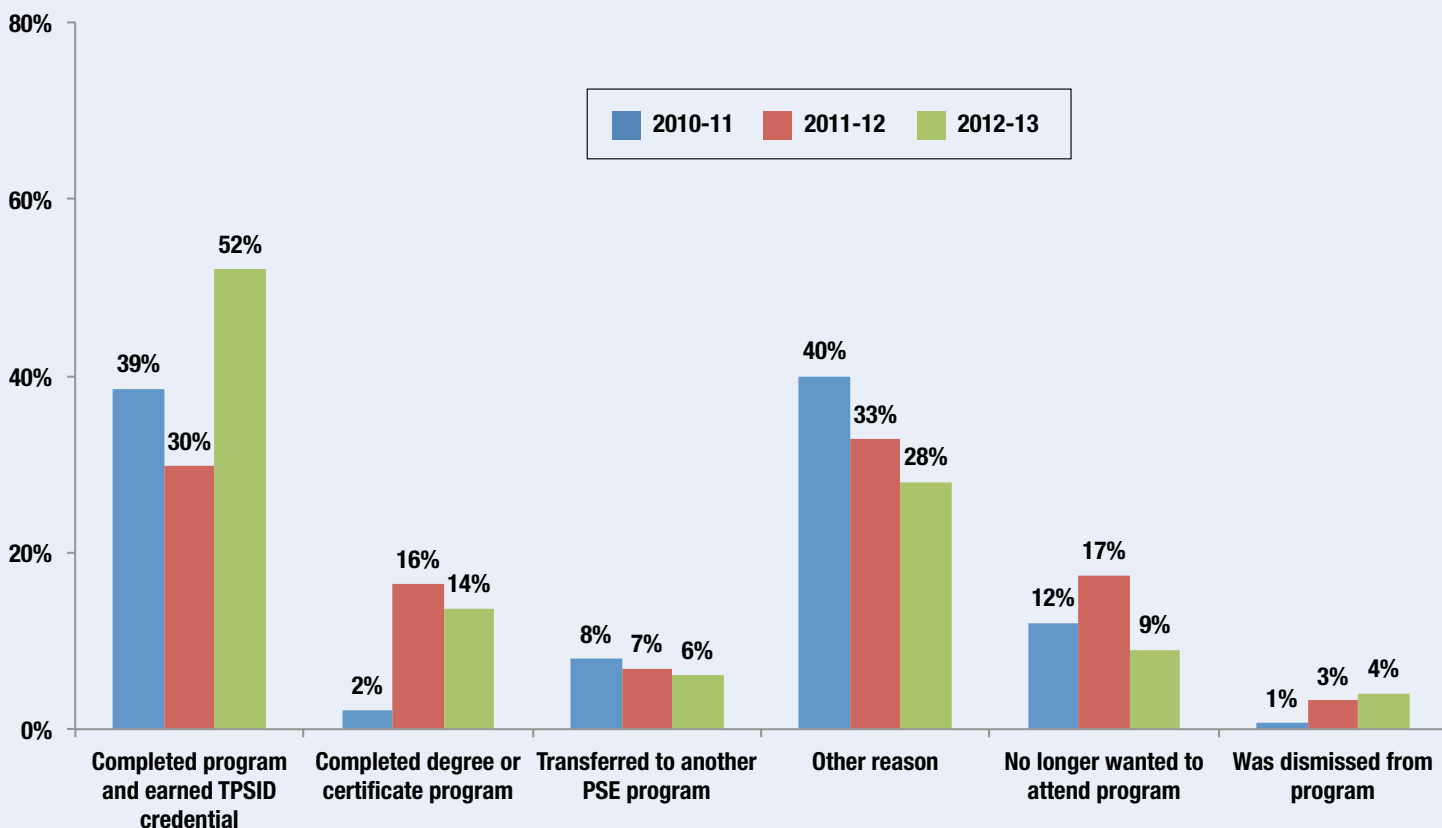
STUDENT EXIT TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

Looking at three years of student exit data, we can see positive trends related to students' reasons for exiting the TPSID program (Figure 32) and student paid employment and career development status at exit (Figure 34). Figure 32 reflects that Year Three was the first year in which over half of the exiting students (52%) exited because they completed their program and earned a credential. Additionally, Year Three brought the highest percentage (60%) of students that earned a credential at exit.

There has also been a consistent year-to-year decrease in students reported as exiting for “other reasons,” meaning reasons that did not fit into one of the categories provided. This is positive for two reasons. First, it indicates that TPSIDs are able to gather enough information from students at the point of exit to be able to select one of the categories offered to them, rather than choosing the catch-all “other” category. Second, the other reasons for exiting often have to do with students exiting programs that do not offer a credential, or students not having the financial resources to continue in the program. Our hope is that these two reasons are becoming less common.

Another positive outcome is that the percentage of students who exited because they “no longer wanted to attend their program” decreased from 17% in Year Two to just 9% in Year Three.

FIGURE 32: REASONS FOR PROGRAM EXIT IN YEARS ONE THROUGH THREE*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

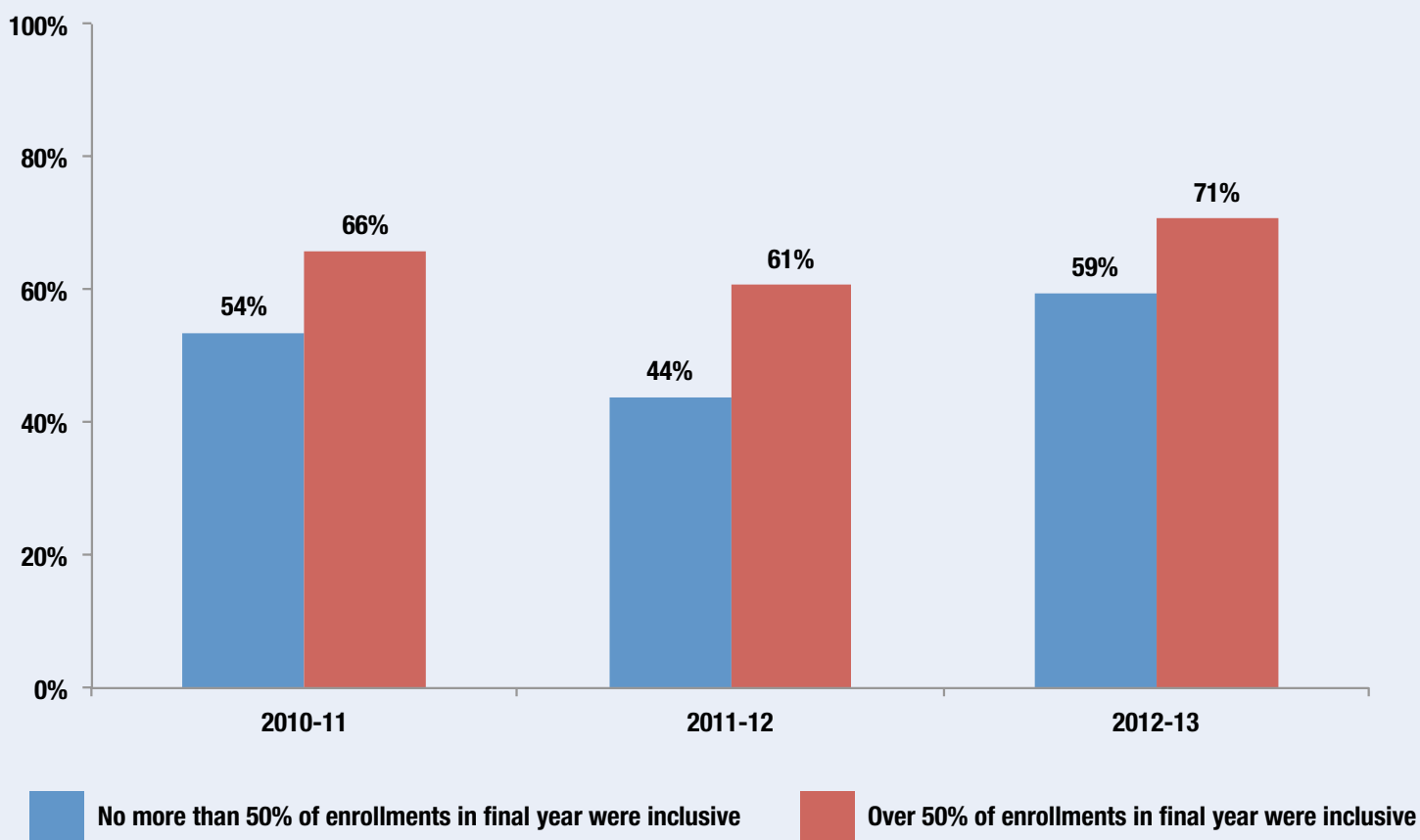
Trends for credentials earned by students exiting programs at two-year and four-year IHEs

A higher percentage of students exiting programs at two-year IHEs earned a credential than students exiting programs at four-year IHEs in each of the first three years of the TPSID program.

Trends for credentials earned by students who had a majority of enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year of attendance

In all three years of the TPSID program, students who had a majority of their enrollments in inclusive courses in their final year were more likely to have earned a credential before exiting than their counterparts who enrolled in no more than 50% inclusive courses in their final year (Figure 33). Inclusive courses are more likely to award credits, and courses that award credits are more likely to help meet the requirements for a postsecondary credential.

FIGURE 33: PERCENTAGE OF STUDENTS WHO EARNED A CREDENTIAL BY PERCENTAGE OF INCLUSIVE COURSES IN FINAL YEAR ATTENDING TPSID FOR YEARS 1 THROUGH 3*



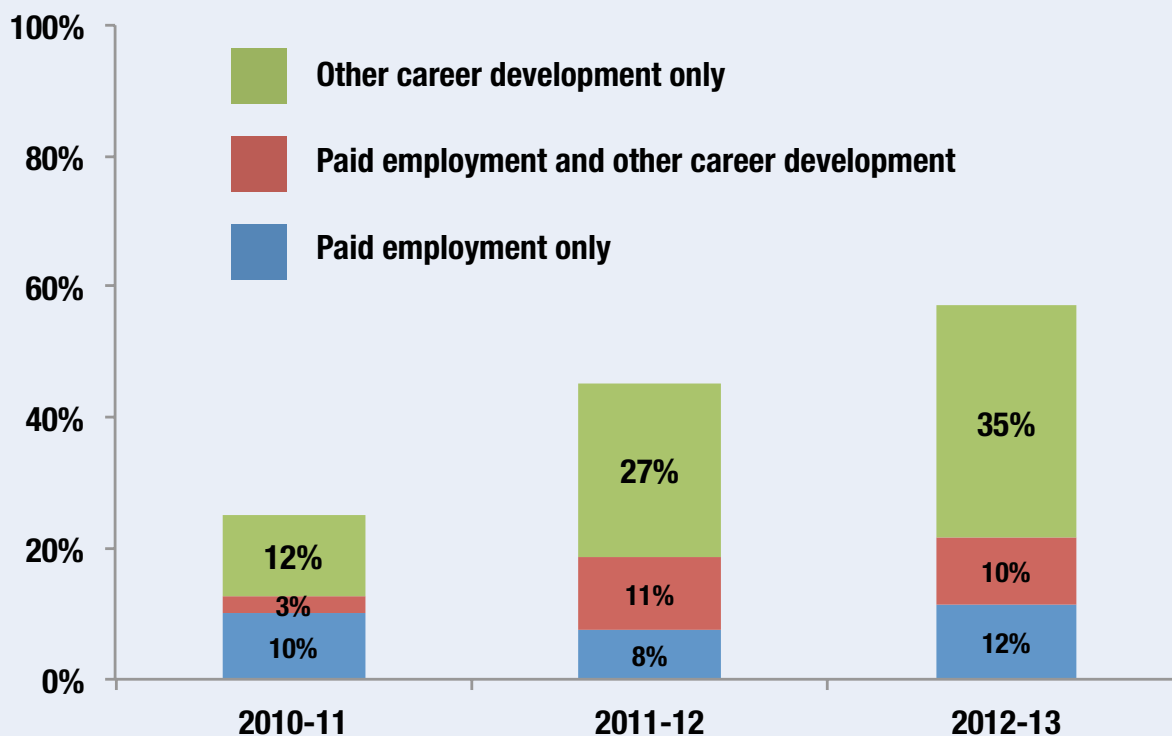
*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

Trends in employment and career outcomes for exiting students

Figure 34 shows that employment and career development outcomes for exiting students improved in each of the first three years of the TPSID program. Year Three is the first time the majority of the exiting students (57%) were involved in some sort of employment or career development at the point of exit. This is a notable improvement over Year One, when only 25% of exiting students were in paid employment or some sort of unpaid career development at the point of exit.

The percentage of students with a paid job at exit has increased each of the three years for which data has been reported, and has nearly doubled between Years One and Three (13% with a job at exit in Year One compared to 22% with a job at exit in Year Three). While we would like to see even greater percentages of students in paid employment at exit, the increase in both paid employment and unpaid career development at exit each year is promising. For those students who exit without a paid job, participating in unpaid career development can help their chances of gaining paid employment at some point after exit.

FIGURE 34: EMPLOYMENT AND CAREER DEVELOPMENT STATUS OF STUDENTS WHO EXITED IN YEARS ONE THROUGH THREE*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

Trends in employment and career outcomes for students exiting programs at two-year and four-year IHEs

Employment outcomes for students who exited programs at four-year IHEs have been relatively consistent over the first three years of the TPSID program. Twenty-four percent of students exited with employment in both Years One and Two, and 22% exited with employment in Year Three. Employment outcomes for students who exited programs at two-year schools have improved each year. Only 7% of students who exited programs at two-year schools exited with a job in Year One. This percentage increased to 16% in Year Two and 21% in Year Three.

Trends in employment and career outcomes for students who were dually enrolled in high school and their TPSID the entire time they attended

In each of the first three years of the TPSID program, students who were dually enrolled the entire time they attended their TPSID were more likely to exit their program with a paid job than students who were enrolled as an adult student for part or all of the time they attended the TPSID. The percentage of dually enrolled students who exited with a paid job grew each year, from 30% in Year One, to 31% in Year Two, and up to 37% in Year Three. This finding supports that premise that inclusive dual enrollment transition programs can be an effective strategy toward paid employment for transition-age youth.

TPSID EVALUATION ACTIVITIES

In addition to participating in the evaluation activities conducted by the NCC, each TPSID has its own internal mechanism for evaluating its programs. NCC has captured information about these evaluation strategies via our monthly cohort meetings and through the TPSID Program Evaluation Special Interest Group.

The evaluation tools being used by TPSIDs include:

- Assessment of students' academic progress
- Assessment of students' career interests and progress
- Goal Attainment Scaling to track students' progress on goals
- Assessments of students' self-determination levels
- Feedback forms for students, faculty, peer mentors, family members, TPSID staff, and employers of TPSID students
- Interviews and meetings with students, peer mentors, and staff

Of the 44 TPSID sites that were serving students in 2012–2013, 16 were already collecting follow-up data on students who exited the program, 24 responded that they were not yet collecting this data, three responded “no,” and one respondent did not know.

Of the 16 sites collecting follow-up data, eight were collecting data for one year after students exited the program, one was collecting data for two years, and seven were collecting data for three or more years after exit. Employment outcomes, living situation, and volunteer or community service activities were the most common areas of data collection (Table 9).

TABLE 9. TYPES OF FOLLOW-UP DATA COLLECTED BY TPSID PROGRAMS, 2012–2013 (N=16 TPSIDS)

TYPE OF DATA	NUMBER OF TPSIDS
Type of job	16
Hours worked per week	16
Living situation	15
Length of employment	14
Earnings	13
Volunteer or community service activities	11
Transfer to two- or four-year colleges and universities	9
Social or community involvement measures	9
Independent living measures	6
Self-determination measures	5
Quality of life measures	5
Postsecondary graduation rate	4

EVALUATION DATA COLLECTION TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

Follow-up data collection has increased during Year Three. During Years One and Two, only 23% of programs were collecting follow-up data on former students; in Year Three, this figure was 36%. This increase may be attributed to timing, as many of the programs during the first two years might have had very few, if any, exiting students to conduct follow up on.

Among TPSIDs collecting follow-up data, there have also been increases each year in the percentage of campuses that collect information on post-exit employment outcomes, such as type of job, earnings, and number of hours worked.

Given that the NCC is not currently allowed to gather information from TPSIDs at any point after students exit from the program (per the Office of Management and Budget), it will become especially important that the TPSIDs engage in collecting data on the students who exit the programs. One limitation of the TPSIDs doing this outside of the evaluation system offered by the NCC is that the data collected by each TPSID will not reflect common measures. Thus, it will not lend itself to aggregation or collective analysis.

ALIGNMENT WITH COLLEGE SYSTEMS AND PRACTICES

INTEGRATION WITH THE IHE

Aligning TPSID services with the systems and practices currently used at the IHE ensures that students have access to everything that other students receive, and also that the program is not duplicating or supplanting services and supports that already exist on campus.

Programs that create special policies and practices for students with ID for typical college interactions like admission, registration, and advising may perpetuate a feeling of separateness for both the staff and the students involved in the TPSID. Programs that use the existing college systems, including academic advising, registration, tutoring, and disabilities services, as well as offering access to typical courses, foster ownership for student success among IHE staff and departments that are not directly involved in the TPSID program.

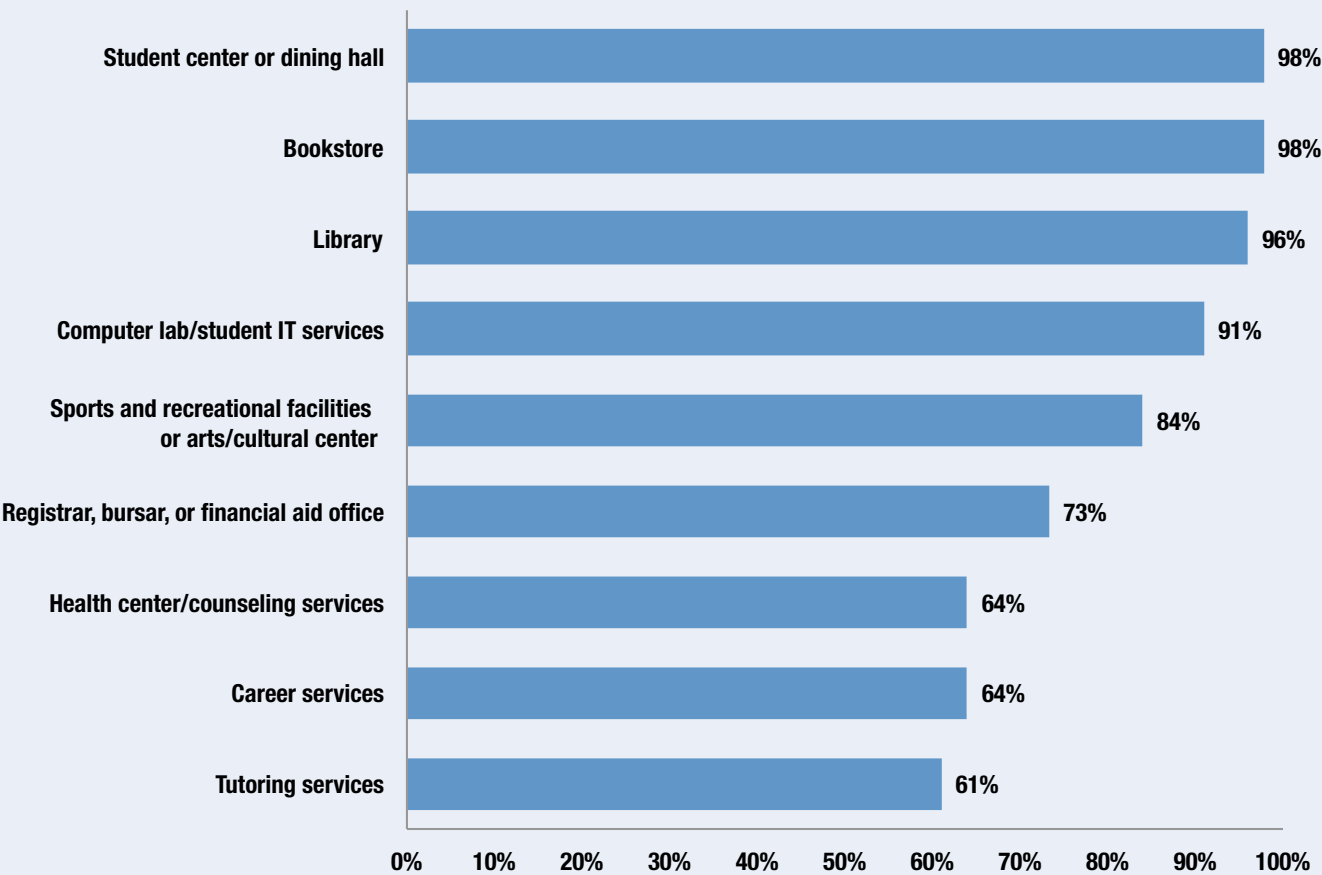
In Year Three, TPSID programs followed the academic calendar used by the IHE at 93% of the reporting TPSIDs (N=44). The majority (98%) indicated that they held students to the IHE’s code of conduct, and 91% issued students college or university ID cards. Eighty-four percent issued students a transcript. Almost two thirds of programs issued regular transcripts.

“Yeah, on our campus all of our students have college IDs. College IDs have been a mechanism for access.”

USE OF CAMPUS RESOURCES

In Year Three, 60% of TPSIDs stated that students accessed all campus resources that were listed as options in the data system. The most commonly accessed resources were the student center, dining hall, bookstore, and library (see Figure 35).

FIGURE 35: USE OF CAMPUS RESOURCES BY STUDENTS ENROLLED, 2012–2013



TRENDS IN ALIGNMENT WITH COLLEGE SYSTEMS AND PRACTICES ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

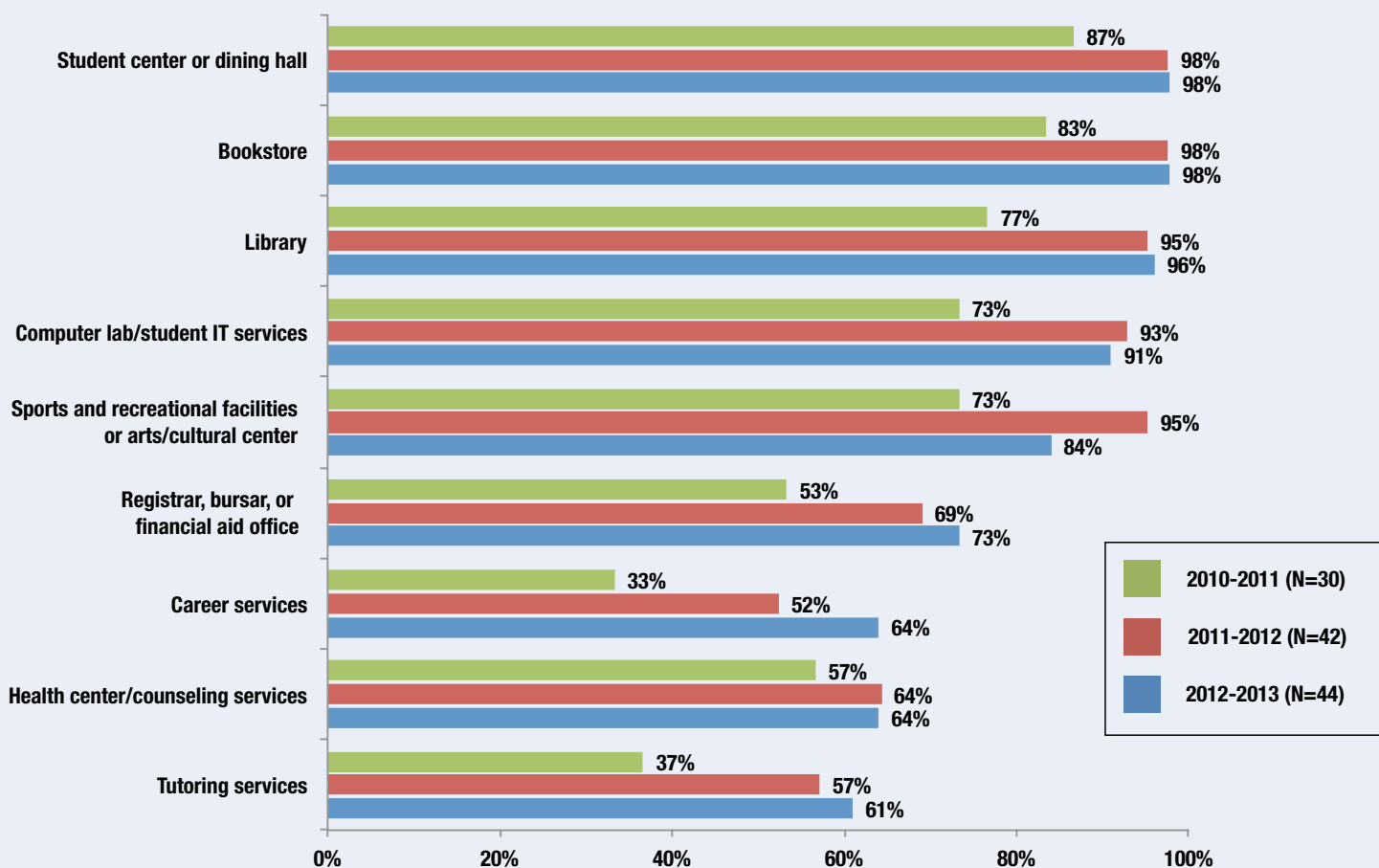
In each of the first three years of the TPSID program, over 90% of TPSIDs followed the academic calendar used by the IHE, issued campus ID cards to students, and held students to the institutional code of student conduct. In these respects, students attending TPSIDs have been provided with a college experience similar to that of other students.

The majority of students received a transcript for their academic work, either a typical university transcript or a separate transcript specifically for students attending the TPSID. However, there are still some programs (between 15 and 20% in each year) that did not offer any kind of transcript to students.

As Figure 36 reflects, students have consistently engaged with numerous campus resources over the first three years of the TPSID project. A promising finding is the consistent growth in the percentage of campuses at which students use career and tutoring services. Each of these grew from percentages in the thirties in Year One to over 60% of programs in Year Three.

Gaining access to these IHE resources will assist in the long-term sustainability of programs for students with ID. Through using these campus services, students will be better integrated into the IHE, and will have less of a need for these services to be provided by TPSID program staff.

FIGURE 36: USE OF CAMPUS RESOURCES BY STUDENTS ENROLLED, 2010–2011 THROUGH 2012–2013



College life can expose students to risks they may have been sheltered from, so it is important to ensure that they have formal orientation and some basic instruction about campus issues that may arise. Focus group participants discussed the importance of reviewing code of conduct policies and making sure that students understood them. Equally important is to then make sure that students are held accountable to those policies.

A TPSID staff member shared that their program created an easy-reading version of the code of conduct so that they could ensure students understood the expectations of the college.

“We had some issues and we sort of created our own rules and then we went to the university attorney and said what do you think about this? And he said to us, why don’t you use the rules that the other students use, which made a lot of sense, so we moved in that direction.”

Focus group data provided additional insight into obstacles faced by students at some TPSIDs when trying to access certain campus resources. One prevalent issue is that students who are not residing on campus or are not enrolled as matriculating students cannot use campus health services and counseling centers.

Often, the concern raised by those in these centers is that they do not have the expertise needed to work with students with ID. It is not possible for this evaluation to explore whether these claims reflect actual limitations, or whether citing lack of expertise is a more palatable way to deny services that the centers don’t want to offer this group of students due to liability concerns.

COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION

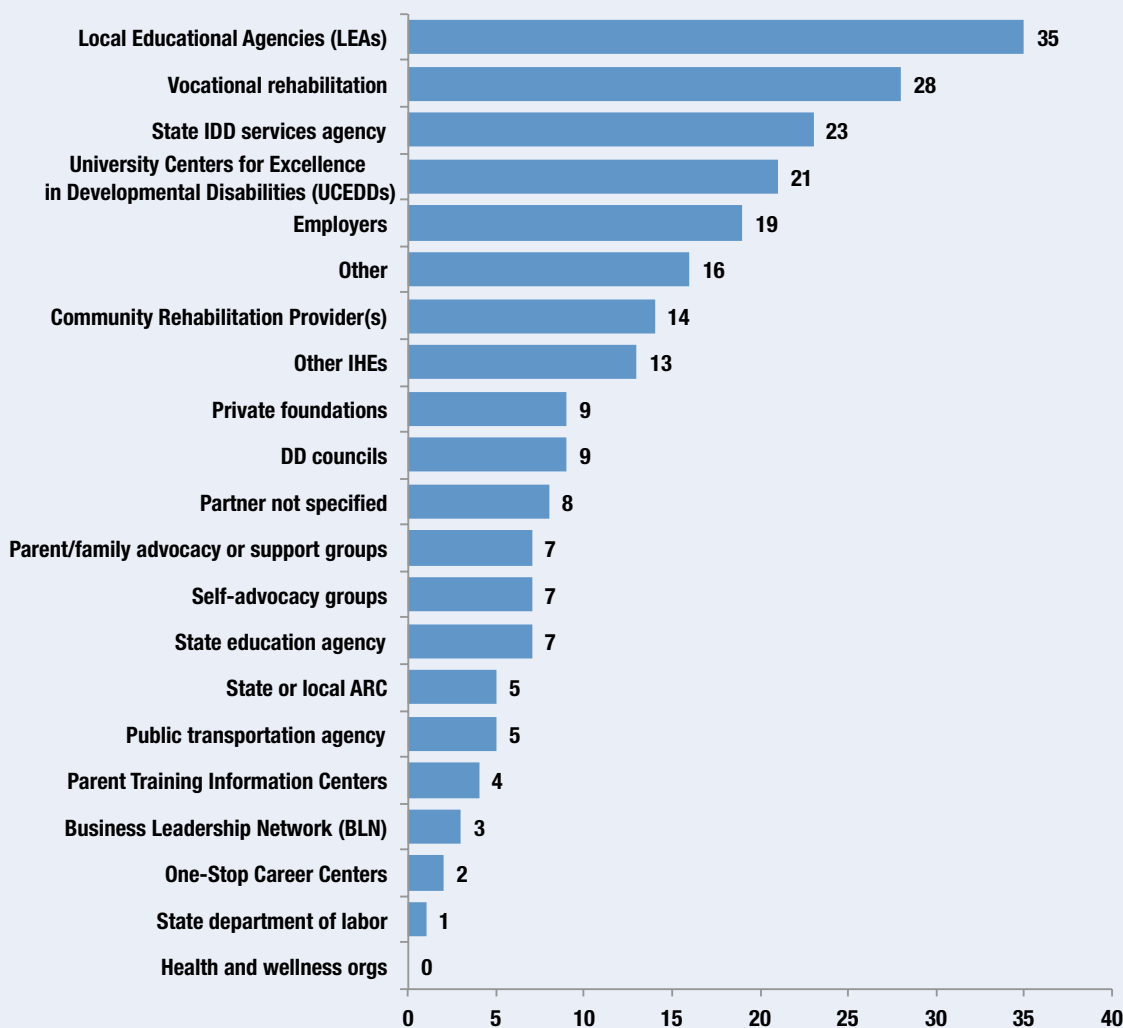
EXTERNAL PARTNERSHIPS

Partnerships with external organizations and collaboration with other entities and offices within an IHE are instrumental in helping sustain TPSID programs. External organizations have expertise on serving transition-age youth in numerous areas, and partnerships with these organizations strengthen individual TPSID programs and increase their chances of attaining successful outcomes for their students (Lindstrom, Flannery, Benz, Olszewski, & Slovic, 2009; GAO, 2012).

Strong external partnerships allow TPSID programs to take advantage of the knowledge, expertise, and practices of organizations whose focus is relevant to them and to their students (e.g., employment, residential services). Additionally, many students will continue to receive services and supports from external agencies after they exit the TPSID program. Therefore, ongoing collaboration supports student success both during and after the program.

In Year Three, the 44 participating program sites partnered with a total of 236 external organizations. As we can see in Figure 37, the most common external partnerships in Year Three were with local education agencies (LEAs), vocational rehabilitation (VR) agencies, and state IDD services agencies, with over half of the TPSID sites partnering with these organizations. Over half of these partners (54%) interacted with the TPSIDs at least monthly.

FIGURE 37: TPSID PARTNERSHIPS WITH EXTERNAL ORGANIZATIONS, 2012–2013 (N=44 SITES)



External partners played a variety of roles when working with TPSIDs. The three most common partner roles were participating in a project advisory committee (43% of partners), conducting recruitment or outreach (36%), and providing services directly to students (34%). The least common partnership roles were providing transportation, providing training to TPSID staff (14% of partnerships), providing instructional opportunities to students (13%), and providing transportation for TPSID students (13%). The most common partner roles of LEAs were conducting outreach and recruitment (71%), participating in the project advisory committee and participating in person-centered planning (49%), and providing direct services to students (37%).

More than half of VR agency partners provided career development and employment opportunities for students (57%) and participated in the project advisory committee (54%). Participation in the advisory committee can be very impactful. Yamamoto et al., 2013 found that VR's participation in an interagency teaming process, helped to catalyze the team's interest subsequent commitment to wider goals for sustainable inclusive PSE experiences.

The most common roles played by state IDD agencies were serving as a consultant and conducting recruitment and outreach (39% in each instance). Though not offered as a response in the evaluation system, some participants in the focus groups held at the project directors meeting said that they used person-centered planning (PCP) experts from the local University Centers for Excellence in Developmental Disabilities to coordinate and run PCP meetings.

Half of the VR agencies and 35% of the state IDD agencies partnering with TPSIDs provided direct services to students. During the focus groups, participants mentioned that using grant funds to provide services like job development and job coaching with program staff can become a barrier to partnering with adult services agencies like VR and state IDD agencies that also provide these services. When TPSID staff provide these services, it can be difficult to figure out how VR and IDD agencies fit in as partners.

Whenever possible, TPSIDs should use the opportunity to have these agencies provide these services to students. Partnering with these agencies may lead to additional positive outcomes, such as access to financial resources to help students pay for attendance.

Despite the potential benefits of working with VR agencies for provision of services directly to students, there are some instances where TPSIDs may need to provide services like job development and coaching in lieu of a VR agency. For instance, focus group participants shared some of the challenges associated with trying to work with a regional VR office located near the college a student was attending when the student planned to live and work in another region after finishing the program. In this instance, TPSID staff needed to address job development internally.

COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

The number of partnerships with external organizations has grown slightly each program year, with TPSIDs partnering with 4.93 organizations on average in Year One, 5.09 in Year Two, and 5.36 in Year Three. While the increase is slight, it is noteworthy, as partnerships are a key element for long-term program sustainability. Building relationships with partners can have a positive impact on program operational costs.

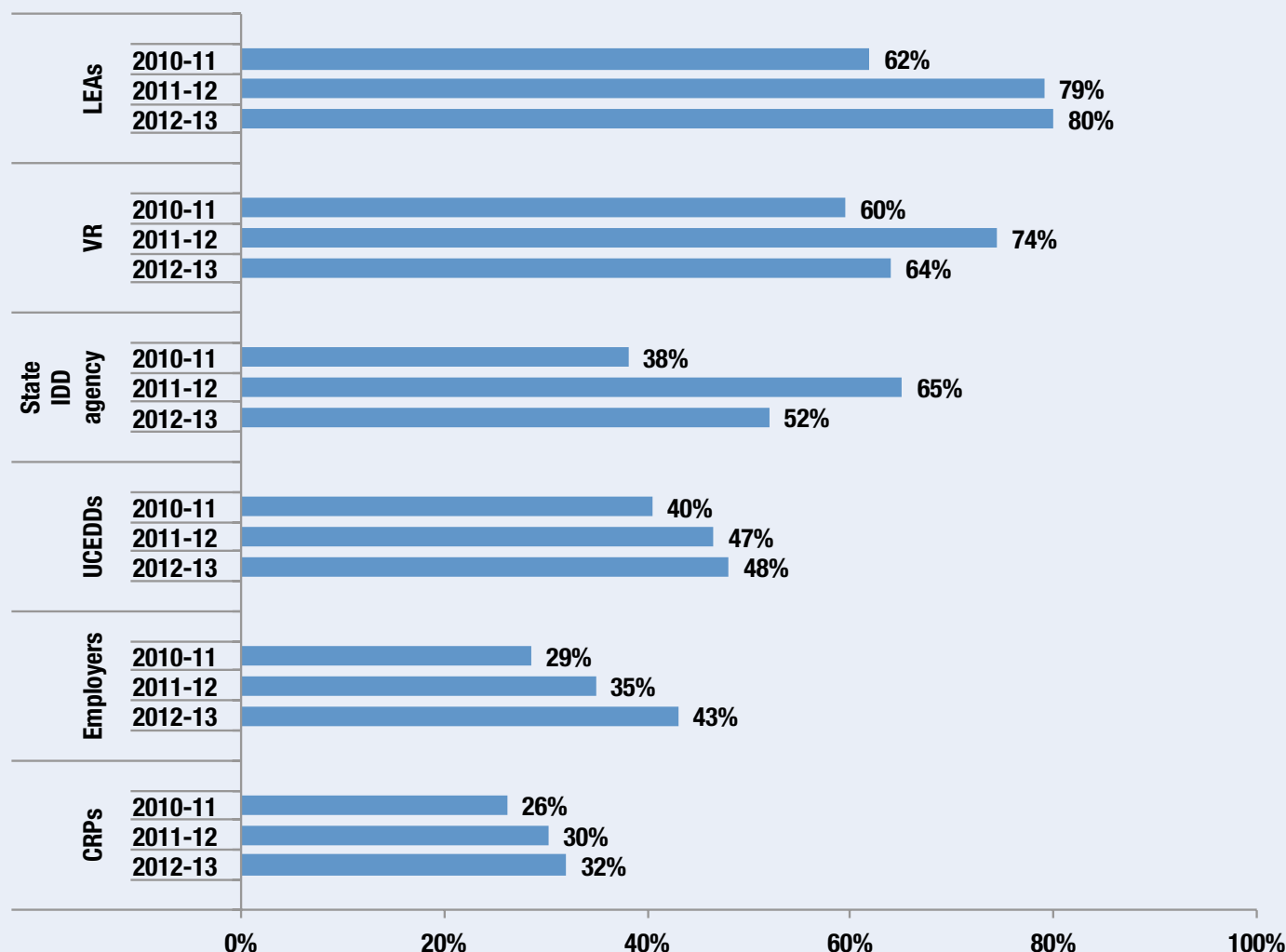
Figure 38 shows three-year trend in partnerships that were most common in the first three years of the TPSID program. To be included in this figure, the organization had to have partnered with at least 25% of all TPSIDs in one or more of the first three years of the TPSID program. For each of the partners displayed in this figure, there was a net increase in the percentage of TPSIDs partnering with that organization between Years One and Three.

Nearly 80% of TPSIDs have partnered with LEAs in each of the last two years. This is critical, as relationships with LEAs provide an opportunity to recruit students into a program.

Partnerships with state IDD and VR agencies increased between Years One and Two, but decreased between Years Two and Three. Because these agencies are involved in coordinating employment services and supports for individuals with IDD, TPSIDs should continue to build relationships with these organizations.

It is encouraging to see that the percentage of TPSIDs partnering with employers has increased each year.

FIGURE 38: TRENDS IN COMMON EXTERNAL PARTNERSHIPS WITH TPSID SITES ACROSS PROJECT YEARS



There are some organizations that TPSID programs rarely partner with. These include organizations that could have a positive impact on student outcomes, particularly in employment, such as business leadership networks, One-Stop Career Centers (American Job Centers), and state departments of labor. Given the focus on Employment First initiatives in many states, it would behoove the colleges and universities serving students with ID to engage in conversations with their state departments of labor and related service organizations to educate these stakeholders about the employment-related activities and outcomes of the TPSID programs.

STAFF TRAINING

TPSID staff coordinated and collaborated with offices internal and external to their IHE for purposes of professional development. In Year Three, staff from 37 of 44 TPSID sites (84%) participated in professional development from their IHE. Staff at more than half of the TPSIDs attended professional development on universal design for learning and software/IT training offered through their IHE. Staff participation in career services training offered by their IHE increased by over 10% between Years Two and Three, from 28% to 41%.

Thirty-six TPSID sites (82%) had staff that participated in professional development provided by an entity external to the IHE, and two thirds (68%) provided or facilitated professional development to other staff at their IHE in Year Three.

Professional development provided to TPSID staff (N = 44 sites)

- » Software/information technology training (N=26)
- » Universal Design for Learning (N=25)
- » Diversity training (N=16)
- » Leadership training (N=16)
- » Academic advising (N=15)
- » Career services (N=15)
- » Staff supervision training (N=11)
- » Project management (N=7)
- » Other topics (N=6)

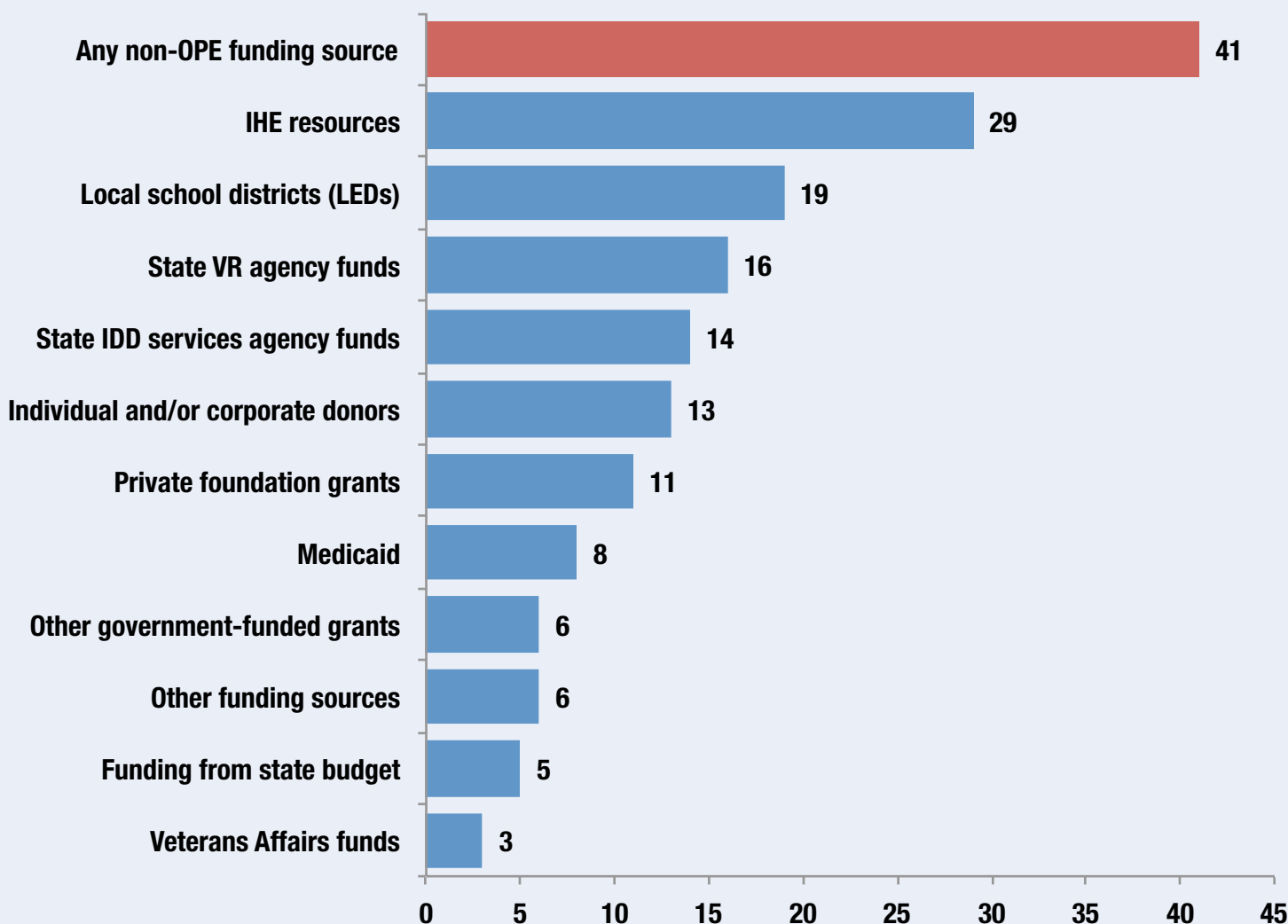
SUSTAINABILITY

The purpose of the TPSID model demonstration program was not only to create or expand high-quality, inclusive transition and postsecondary programs for students with intellectual disabilities, but to ensure that these programs would be sustained after the grant funding ends. Therefore, each grantee was expected to create plans to address sustainability of their model program. In most cases, plans for sustainability included exploring and engaging in funding mechanisms that were external to the grant funds.

FUNDING FROM NON-OPE SOURCES

In Year Three, 41 TPSID sites (93%) received financial support from other sources in addition to their Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE) grant funds. IHE resources were the most common non-OPE source of funds. These were used at 29 of the 44 sites. Sixteen TPSID sites received funds from state VR agencies, and 14 received financial support from state IDD services agencies. It is promising to see that TPSID sites also received funds from individual and corporate donors and from private foundations (Figure 39).

FIGURE 39: NON-OPE SOURCES OF PROGRAM FUNDING, 2012–2013 (N=44 SITES)



Partner contributions to TPSID funding

The involvement of partner organizations often went beyond funding. Many partner organizations contributed to program development and provided services directly to students, in addition to supporting the program fiscally. In Year Three, 14% of organizations that partnered with TPSIDs provided funds for student tuition, and 22% provided funds that could be used for other expenses. In 15 of the 28 instances where VR agencies partnered with TPSID programs, the agency provided funds for student tuition.

One focus group participant spoke about their partnership with VR and IDD agencies in their state:

“I feel like we have really strong partnerships with our state division of voc rehab and then with our county developmental disability administration in terms of funding the career development services. So all of our students link up with some, one or both of those agencies to fund the career development part [of the program].”

Some translation is necessary in describing or categorizing services when partnering with different kinds of agencies. In the program quote above, the agencies were paying for “community based assessment,” but the method of implementation of this service in the program was via students’ unpaid internships on and off campus.

Given its mission, it makes sense for VR to pay for a course that leads to an employment outcome. However, some courses are initial or intermediate steps toward employment. For example, taking an introductory course in theater may improve the ability of a potential employee to speak publicly and eventually be more skilled in customer service.

Another focus group participant related that their VR funding might impact access to courses at their college:

“So we have VR funding also. VR funds the tuition, and the community based assessment ... But that’s tricky because we want our students to fully have the college experience and to participate in inclusive classes. But we need to have the ...counselor sign off. So I can tell you exactly how this class is going to lead to an employment outcome. VR’s more interested in paying for specialized courses at this point, and we’re more interested in not having any.”

TPSID partners funding student tuition in Year Three

- » VR agencies (n=15)
- » LEAs (n=7)
- » State IDD services agencies (n=4)
- » Private foundations (n=4)
- » CRPs (n=1)
- » Native American tribes (n=1)
- » State departments of labor (n=1)
- » State or local ARC (n=1)

When a VR counselor is not able to look at the larger picture, and decides that an inclusive academic course will not lead immediately to employment, they may be less likely to approve funding for that course. Future efforts must be made to ensure that vocational rehabilitation’s involvement doesn’t limit student access to inclusive courses.

Many partners provided funds for expenses other than tuition. The most frequent instances of this were VR agencies (11/28 partnerships), LEAs (9/35 partnerships), University Centers for Excellence in Developmental Disabilities (8/21 partnerships), and state IDD agencies (6/23 partnerships).

SOURCES OF FUNDS FOR STUDENT TUITION AND FEES

Students used a variety of funding sources to pay for their attendance during Year Three, as reflected in Figures 40 and 41. For tuition and non-tuition expenses, private pay (i.e., personal funds) was the option most commonly used. Fifty-three percent of students enrolled in Year Three used private pay for tuition, and 68% used this source for non-tuition expenses.

It is noteworthy that 14% of students had their tuition waived in Year Three. TPSIDs were not allowed to use grant funds to pay for student tuition. However, non-tuition expenses could be paid for with grant funds. Therefore, the federal/state grants referenced in Figure 40 are not TPSID grant funds but are other state or federal grants that the TPSID used to support tuition.

The high percentage of private pay may be a double-edged sword. While it is a reflection that many students are able to generate the money needed to attend these TPSID programs without relying wholly on outside sources, it may also reflect that only students from families who have substantial financial means are able to afford these programs.

The approved evaluation tool does not capture socioeconomic status information for students, making it difficult to know the impact of financial status on attendance. We know from other research (Madaus, Grigal, & Hughes, 2014) that students with disabilities from lower income families are less likely to attend college than their peers from higher income families. TPSID programs should explore strategies that will provide access to youth with intellectual disabilities who may not have the resources to pay for their attendance.

In 2011–2012, 71% of all undergraduates in the United States received some type of financial aid, federal or other (Radwin et al., 2013). Fifty-seven percent of all undergraduates received federal student aid. Forty-two percent received federal grants, 15% received state-funded grants, and 20% received grants funded by the postsecondary institution they attended (Radwin et al., 2013).

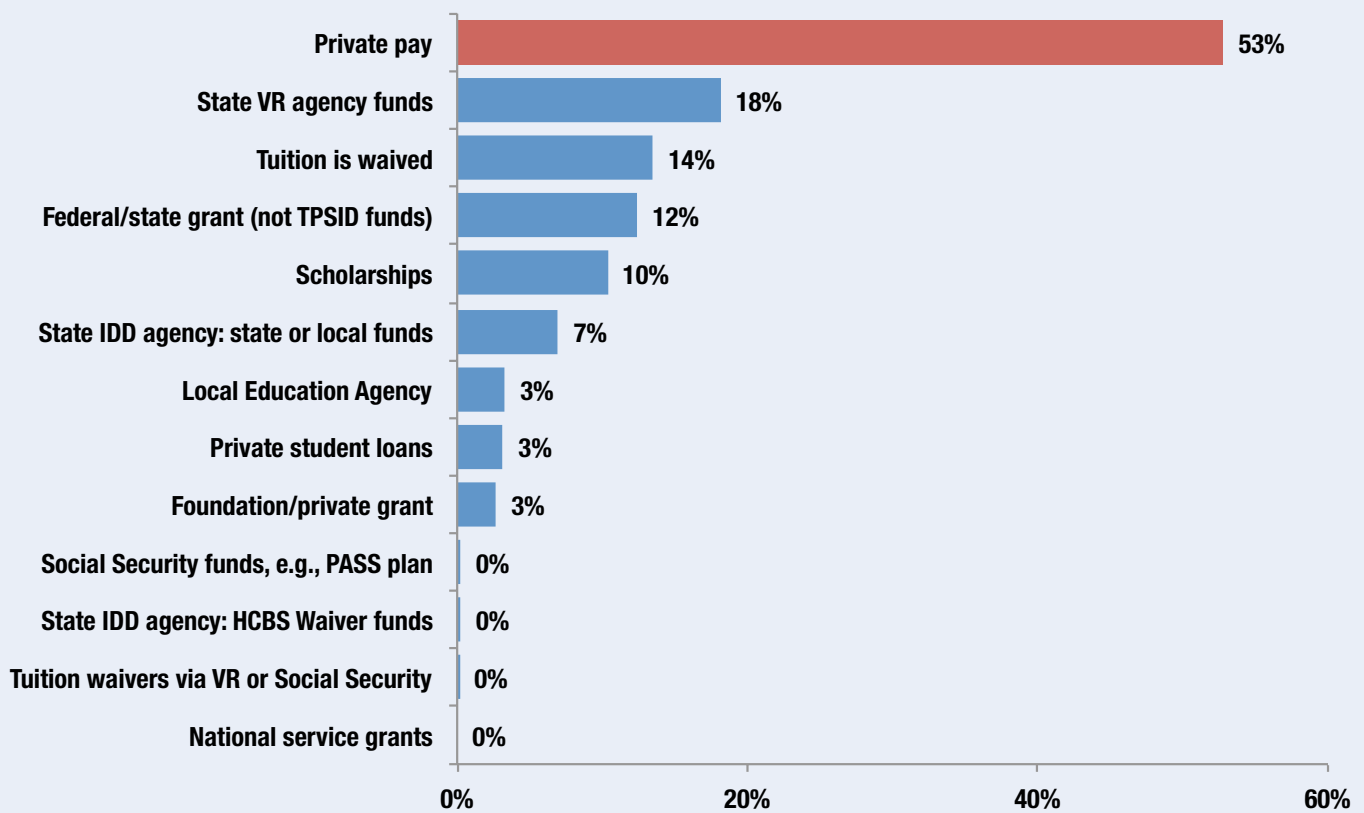
During Year Three, 10 TPSID sites were approved Comprehensive Transition Programs (CTPs), meaning that they could offer their students access to certain forms of federal student aid (see page 9 for a description of CTPs). Pell Grants were the most common form of federal student aid, and students at six TPSID programs received these grants.

Only one of the TPSIDs approved as a CTP had students participate in the college's Federal Work Study program. Another TPSID had been approved as a CTP, but did not have any students access aid in Year 3. It was not clear if this was due to a lack of students who qualified for aid or for some other reason.

Among the 34 TPSID sites that were not approved CTPs, five had applied to become a CTP and were waiting for approval, and 19 were planning to apply at a later time. The remaining 10 TPSID sites were not planning to apply to become CTPs.

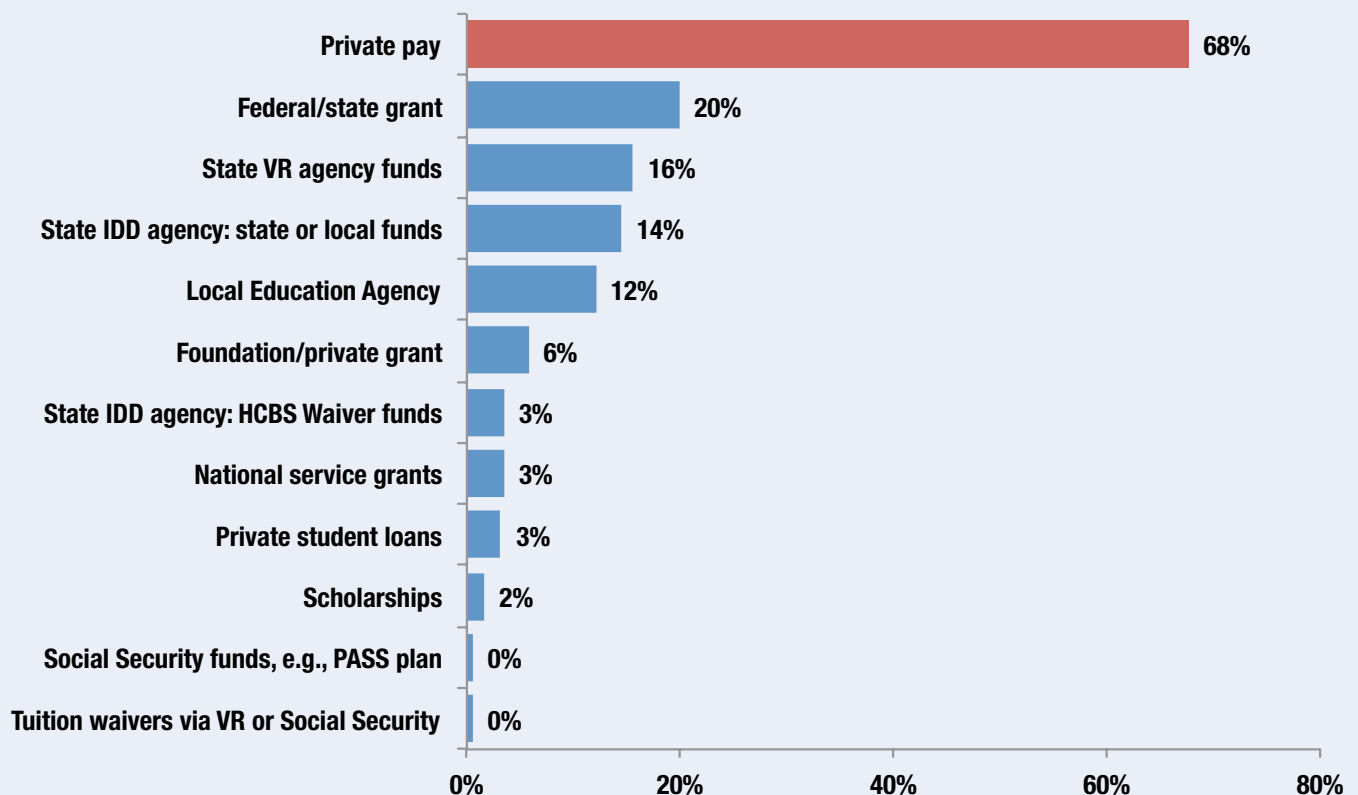
Those TPSID sites that indicated that they were not planning to apply for CTP approval provided a number of reasons for this choice. These included focusing on other aspects of the program during Year Three, staffing changes, operating a program that does not charge students and thus would not benefit from offering financial aid, and concerns from IHE administration about the long-term sustainability of the program. Other sites planned to continue operating a dual enrollment program, making them ineligible to provide financial aid to students as a CTP.

FIGURE 40: FUNDING SOURCES USED BY STUDENTS TO PAY TUITION, 2012–2013 (N=821 STUDENTS)*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

FIGURE 41: FUNDING SOURCES USED BY STUDENTS TO PAY NON-TUITION EXPENSES, 2012–2013 (N=821 STUDENTS)*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level

Funding sources used to pay for TPSID attendance by students at two-year and four-year IHEs

Students attending programs at two- and four-year IHEs were very similar in terms of sources of funding used to pay for tuition and non-tuition expenses, with a few exceptions. Students at two-year IHEs were more likely to use private pay for tuition expenses than students at four-year IHEs (61% versus 46%). Students at two-year IHEs were also more likely to use state VR agency funds (22% versus 15% of students at four-year IHEs) and federal/state grant funds (18% versus 7% of students at four-year schools) to pay for tuition.

Students at four-year IHEs were more likely to use scholarship money to pay for tuition. Sixteen percent of those students received scholarships to help pay for tuition, compared to just 4% of student at two-year IHEs.

COST OF ATTENDANCE FOR TPSID STUDENTS

TPSIDs were asked to provide information on the amount students pay to attend their programs and how charges are structured. To allow for more specificity in costs of attendance, we expanded the residency status types in Year Three to include types beyond all, in-state, and out-of-state students. New categories include in- and out-of-county students, as well as city and non-city students. Overall, 30 TPSID sites reported 37 different fee structures.

Table 10 shows the average cost of attendance for students who attend TPSIDs at two- and four-year IHEs. These programs are differentiated into those that charge the same rate for all students, and those that charge different rates for students based on students’ residency status.

While the small sample size makes it difficult to make comparisons between different settings, there are clear cost implications for out-of-state students. Also, the annual cost of attendance for a program at a two-year IHE was less on average than the annual cost of attendance at a four-year IHE. This follows general trends for all undergraduates in the U.S. Programs that charge the same rate to all students regardless of residential status tend to be the more expensive programs at two-year IHEs.

TABLE 10. OVERALL ANNUAL COST OF ATTENDANCE, 2012–2013 (# OF SITES PROVIDING DATA IN PARENTHESES)

	AVERAGE ANNUAL COST AT TWO-YEAR SCHOOLS	AVERAGE ANNUAL COST AT FOUR-YEAR SCHOOLS
Charge same rate to all students regardless of residence	\$5,606 (4)	\$13,950 (4)
In-state students	\$2,106 (3)	\$9,345 (17)
Out-of-state students	--	\$34,835 (3)
In-county students	\$1,248 (2)	--
Out-of-county students	\$1,611 (2)	--

--No data reported in this category

TPSID sites were asked whether they charge a comprehensive program fee or break charges out into more specific categories. In Year Three, eight sites charged a comprehensive fee that was all-inclusive. Tuition charges were more common than required fees among schools that broke out charges into specific categories.

Room and board charges were less common than tuition and fees, but this is because only 14 of 44 sites serving students in Year Three (31%) offered residential options to their students.

TABLE 11. CHARGES TO STUDENTS ATTENDING TPSID PROGRAMS, 2012–2013 (# OF SITES PROVIDING DATA IN PARENTHESES)*

CHARGE STRUCTURE	AVG. COST TO ATTEND PROGRAM THAT CHARGES COMPREHENSIVE (ALL INCLUSIVE) FEE	AVERAGE COST TO ATTEND PROGRAMS THAT BREAK UP CHARGES INTO COMPONENTS				
		AVG. TOTAL COST TO ATTEND SCHOOLS THAT BREAK UP CHARGES	AVG. TUITION	AVG. REQUIRED FEES	AVG. ROOM	AVG. BOARD
Charge same rate to all students regardless of residence	\$184 (1)	\$11,149 (7)	\$3,630 (4)	\$11,684 (3)	\$5,750 (2)	\$3,817 (3)
In-state students	\$2,555 (2)	\$8,893 (18)	\$4,638 (18)	\$992 (15)	\$5,321 (8)	\$2,922 (7)
Out-of-state students	--	\$34,835 (3)	\$23,436 (3)	\$2,565 (2)	\$7,649 (3)	\$3,046 (2)
In-county students	--	\$1,248 (1)	\$1,010 (2)	--	--	--
Out-of-county students	--	\$1,611 (2)	\$1,458 (2)	\$306 (1)	--	--

--No data reported in this category

SUSTAINABILITY TRENDS ACROSS THREE YEARS OF THE TPSID PROGRAM

Trends in Non-OPE program funding

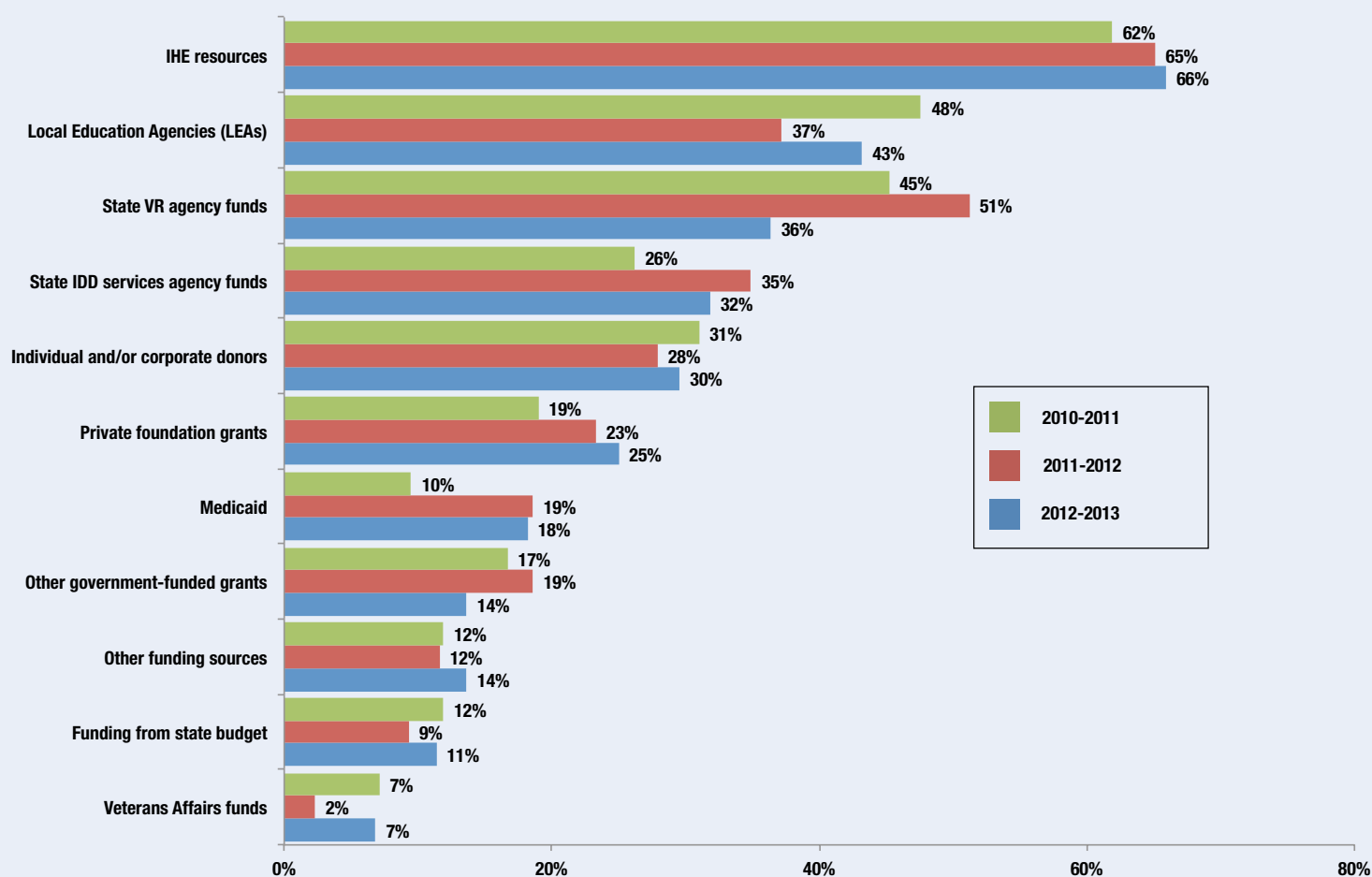
In each of the first three years of grant funding, most TPSIDs used non-OPE funding to help operate their programs: 95% of sites in Years One and Two and 93% of sites in Year Three. Sites reported using on average 3.4 non-OPE sources of funding to help pay for the cost of operating their program.

As shown in Figure 42, the IHE, LEAs, and state VR agencies were the most common sources of non-OPE program funds in Years One through Three. IHE resources and private foundation grants are the only types of funds that increased each year from Years One to Three. IHE resources have consistently been the most commonly cited source of non-OPE funds used, with 66% of all program sites using this source in Year Three.

As TPSIDs plan for long-term sustainability, they should seek out stable funding sources and whenever possible blend and braid private and public funds. They must also work with their host IHE to ensure that the program is a recognized and valued part of the institution's academic community and included annually in the institution's budget.

The NCC has sought to assist TPSIDs in addressing their sustainability via a variety of strategies. In Year Three, the NCC developed a webinar on the use of IDEA funds to assist with program sustainability for IHEs that were serving dually enrolled students. TPSIDs were also supported to use an online sustainability planning tool (<https://sustaintool.org>) to conduct strategic planning related to long-term funding and cultivation of extended partnerships.

FIGURE 42: NON-OPE SOURCES OF PROGRAM FUNDING, 2010–2011 TO 2012–2013



Trends in student sources of funding used for tuition and non-tuition expenses

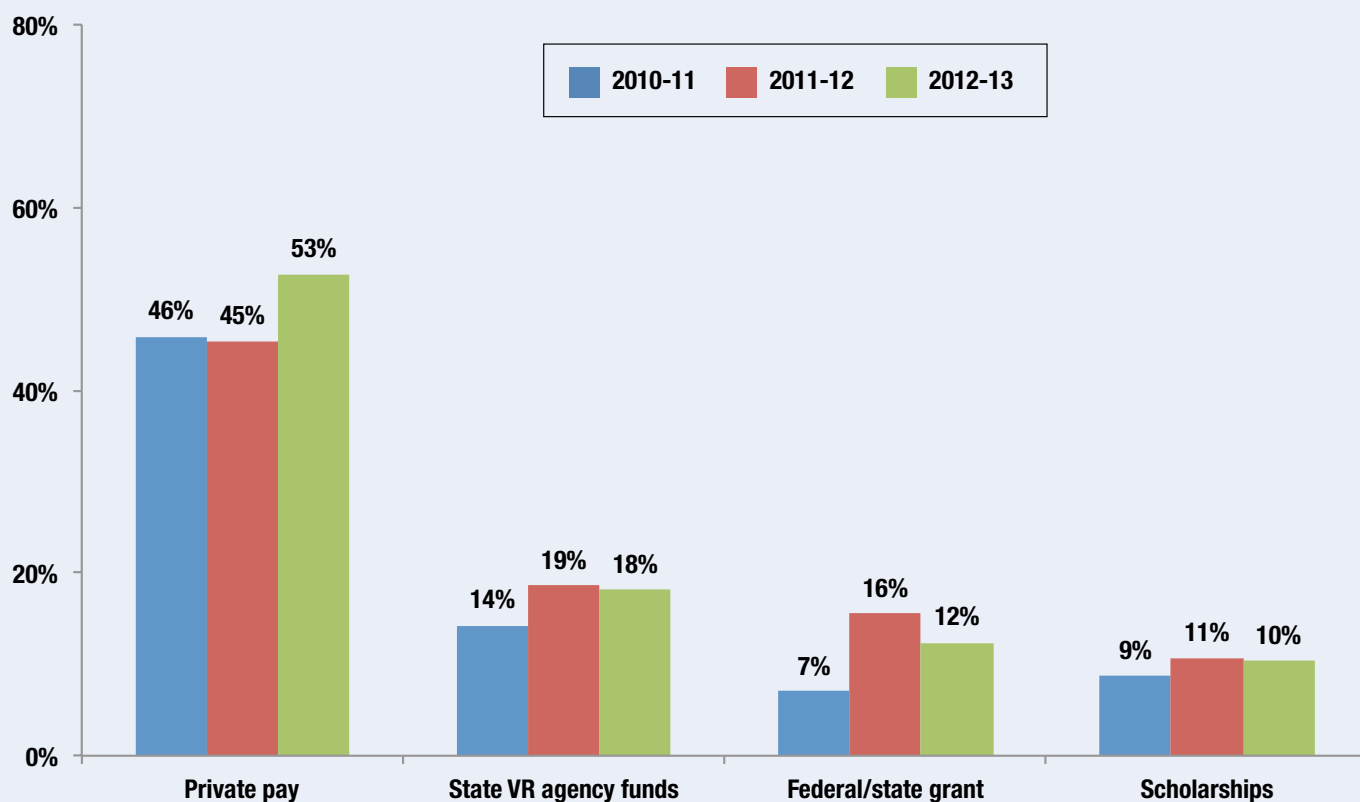
In each of the first three years of TPSID program funding, private pay was the most common source of funds used for tuition and non-tuition expenses (see Figures 43 and 44). Most students only used one source of funding to pay for tuition expenses: 80% in Year One, 70% in Year Two, and 71% in Year Three.

A noteworthy trend is that the percentage of students for whom tuition is waived has increased each year: Five percent were reported as having tuition waived in Year One, 11% in Year Two, and 14% in Year Three. This finding merits further exploration into how programs that waive tuition are supporting student attendance, and what impact this has on overall program funding.

The reliance on private funds as a primary means to pay for tuition and non-tuition expenses may not be sustainable over time. While many current students are able to generate their own funds to pay for attendance, it is likely that there are many more potential students who do not have those resources. Potential students who cannot generate funds from personal and private networks will be prevented from attending for financial reasons.

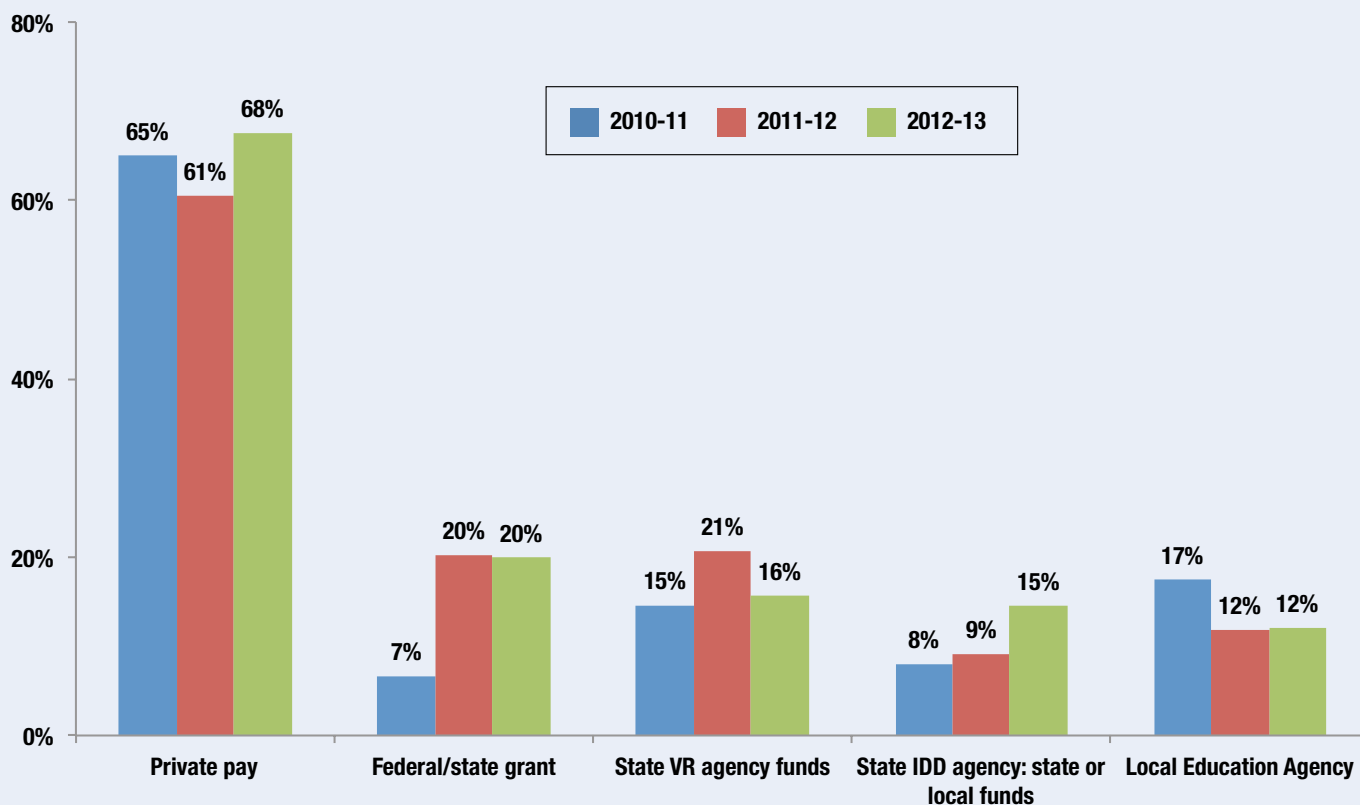
To ensure that programs are inclusive and accessible, TPSIDs should focus on assisting all potential students in accessing a variety of sources of funds that will allow them to attend these programs. One option is for the TPSID to become an approved CTP with the ability to offer federal financial aid.

FIGURE 43: FUNDING SOURCES USED BY STUDENTS TO PAY TUITION EXPENSES, 2010–2011 TO 2012–2013*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level, as well as funding sources that were used by fewer than 10% of TPSID students in each of the three years

FIGURE 44: FUNDING SOURCES USED BY STUDENTS TO PAY NON-TUITION EXPENSES, 2010–2011 TO 2012–2013*



*Omits data reported at the aggregate level, as well as funding sources that were used by fewer than 10% of TPSID students in each of the three years

There are potential sources of student funds that are rarely used to pay for tuition and non-tuition expenses. These sources of funds should be explored, as they will likely allow more students to attend and complete postsecondary education programs.

Every state waiver defines the services and supports that can be funded, and this varies from state to state. For example, Medicaid funds cannot be used for tuition and fees, but can be used to pay for student support services, such as educational coaches, mentors, physical or occupational therapy, transportation, and supported employment. Certain states, like California, Vermont, and North Carolina are currently using Medicaid waiver funds for these types of expenses. The first step in assessing possible use of waiver funds to support inclusive higher education would be to review a state's waiver language to identify the services and supports that are allowable waiver costs.

Another potential source comes from state budgets. A growing number of states have funded initiatives related to postsecondary education for students with ID. Examples include a line item in state budgets to fund start-up costs for new programs (South Carolina, Georgia, & Massachusetts), establishment of a lottery-funded scholarship for students with ID (Tennessee), state VR funding for pilot programs in community colleges (California), and access to state-funded scholarships for students attending an approved CTP (Kentucky).

Types of funds used by fewer than 10% of students each year to pay for tuition and non-tuition expenses

Funds for tuition expenses

- » **Foundation/private grant**
- » **Local Education Agency**
- » **National service grants**
- » **Social Security funds, e.g., PASS plan**
- » **State IDD agency: state or local funds**
- » **State IDD agency: HCBS waiver funds**
- » **Tuition waivers via VR or Social Security**

Funds for non-tuition expenses

- » **Foundation/private grant**
- » **National service grants**
- » **Other funding source**
- » **Scholarships**
- » **Social Security funds, e.g., PASS plan**
- » **State IDD agency: HCBS waiver funds**

LIMITATIONS

The data collected by the NCC is suitable for evaluating TPSID programs in the aggregate, but does not allow for an impact assessment of program activities as they relate to program characteristics and student outcomes. The data presented here is a population file appropriate for describing characteristics of and practices employed by TPSID model demonstration programs, as well as student employment outcomes during and upon exiting the program, use of institutional resources and campus activities, and access to inclusive college courses.

Overall, the NCC data does not provide a representative sample of all U.S. higher education programs serving students with intellectual disability. Therefore its generalizability is limited.

As with any large evaluation initiative, the TPSID evaluation has several additional limitations that are important to keep in mind when reviewing the Annual Performance Report. These key limitations include the following:

1. Despite the NCC's best efforts to develop questions and response choices to fit the needs of all TPSIDs, and to define key terms in a way that allowed for consistency across reporting sites, responses may have been subject to respondent bias due to different interpretations of program operations and student experiences in relation to the questions on the evaluation. While in many instances the NCC provided a text response field to allow respondents to report additional information, some TPSID respondents may have neglected to report information that would allow for better program evaluation.
2. The NCC was not permitted to collect follow-up data on students who had exited or completed the TPSID program. Therefore, the NCC is not able to collect or review longitudinal data on student outcomes.
3. The data reported by TPSIDs is self-reported; therefore, some TPSID programs may have inaccurately reported certain variables. While our team went to great lengths to verify any discrepancies or noted outliers, it is possible that some data were not reported or inputted accurately.
4. Some of the TPSID programs chose to provide only aggregate data thus limiting some of the analyses the NCC was able to conduct.

CONCLUSION

The findings of this Year 3 Annual Report reflect that the TPSID programs continue to make substantial progress toward their goals. As the number of students served in these programs grows, so does knowledge of what policies and practices lead to better outcomes. In particular, the focus group data included in this report offer important insights about how these programs are addressing the challenges of creating inclusive campus communities for students with intellectual disability.

Significant in this report is the positive trend in paid employment outcomes, which continue to grow, albeit slowly, each year of the program. While we hope to see continued increases in the next two years, current data show that these programs have demonstrated the capacity to engage students with ID in paid employment at double the national average.

While it is important that students attending and graduating from TPSID programs are finding paid employment at the completion of their course of study, this is not the only measure of success for the TPSID projects. The Higher Education Opportunities Act required TPSID programs to provide a focus on academic enrichment, socialization, independent living skills, including self-advocacy, and integrated work experiences and career skills that lead to gainful employment.

Judging the efficacy of the TPSID programs should not focus solely on employment rates as the TPSID programs were not specifically required to engage students in integrated paid employment. It is important to look at outcomes in all focus areas – academics, socialization, independent living skills, and self-advocacy – as well as employment outcomes.

Another programmatic area that merits continued scrutiny is that of inclusive academic access. The TPSID programs were required to provide individual supports and services for the academic and social inclusion of students with intellectual disabilities in academic courses, extracurricular activities, and other aspects of the IHE's regular postsecondary program.

Once again the statute provides some latitude when it comes to inclusive course access. The TPSID programs continue to provide academic access predominantly via the use of specialized courses. While inclusive course access increased from Year One to Year Two, a slight decline was evident in Year Three. No parameters or benchmarks were provided to the grant recipients by Congress or the Department of Education regarding the level of inclusion that these programs must offer. Thus, many continue to provide minimal access to inclusive academic opportunities and, in some rare cases, none at all. The level of inclusion not only impacts the education students receive in terms of content, credits, and credentials, but also is reflective of the programs' integration and potential long-term sustainability at the IHE.

The IHEs involved in TPSID programs were tasked with creating, expanding, or enhancing high-quality, inclusive higher education experiences to support positive outcomes for individuals with ID. The TPSID programs will fail to meet this overarching goal if they continue to maintain an emphasis on segregated college courses.

One positive finding is that over the past three years, data show an increase in the percentage of course enrollments that were for some type of credit, and a majority of students who were in inclusive courses were enrolled for standard IHE credit. We hope to see advances made by the TPSID sites in inclusive college course access in the final two years of the program.

The TPSID programs have continued to seek out and strengthen their external partnerships with vocational rehabilitation, local education agencies, and community rehabilitation providers (CRPs). This collaboration is bearing fruit as within programs that partner with CRPs, almost 1/3 of students had a paid job, and 84% were participating in other career activities. As external agencies continue to partner with the IHEs implementing these programs, This will foster a better understanding of how these programs share many of the same goals of integrated community learning and working experiences for youth and adults with ID.

At the completion of three years of funding, noticeable trends are beginning to emerge. Data show that the longer a student is in a program, the more likely they are to be employed. Also, the type of IHE seems to be influencing employment outcomes, as students enrolled in programs at two-year IHEs were nearly twice as likely to have paid jobs as students at four-year IHEs. Finally, it appears that students who attended programs in which they had greater access to inclusive coursework were more likely to participate in both paid employment and other career development activities than students who attended programs that offered primarily specialized courses.

Year Three was also the first year where the majority of the exiting students were involved in some kind of employment or career development activity and earned a credential at the point of exit. As these programs continue to evolve, the focus on the credentials earned will grow and become more important. When the TPSID programs commenced, many were focused on establishing the program by increasing enrollment and accessing the college environment. A shift is now needed to focus greater attention on the credentials earned and the outcomes achieved. This is an important shift, and the NCC will continue to provide assistance and support that helps these programs offer credentials that are recognized by their IHE and supportive of continued learning or employment.

We hope that this report will foster interest and engagement by legislators, federal agencies, state leaders, and education professionals to embed inclusive higher education into future transition and employment initiatives nationwide. Given that the NCC is not authorized to gather data on TPSID students beyond the point of exit, it will be very important for Congress and the Department of Education to gather data on the outcomes of the students exiting these TPSID programs. Without long-term data on employment, continuing education, and independent living, it will be difficult to gauge the long-term impact of this important investment in higher education for students with intellectual disability.

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APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

*The Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities (TPSID)
2012-13 Grantees*

APPENDIX B

*Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities (TPSID)
Government Performance and Results Act (GPRA) Measures*

APPENDIX C

Glossary of Terms

APPENDIX D

*Statutory Language and Definitions Pertaining to the TPSID Programs from the Higher
Education Act of 1965 as amended by the Higher Education Opportunities Act of 2008*

APPENDIX A

The Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities (TPSID) 2012-13 Grantees

State	City	College or University
AK	Anchorage	University of Alaska-Anchorage
AZ	Tucson	University of Arizona
CA	Fresno	California State University-Fresno
CA	Los Angeles	University of California at Los Angeles (UCLA)
CA	Taft	West Kern Community College District
CO	Fort Collins	Colorado State University
DE	Newark	University of Delaware
FL	St. Petersburg	University of South Florida-St. Petersburg
HI	Honolulu	University of Hawaii
IN	Bloomington	Indiana University
IA	Iowa City	University of Iowa
KY	Lexington	University of Kentucky
LA	Baton Rouge	Louisiana State University
MN	Brainerd	Central Lakes College
NY	Rochester	University of Rochester
NJ	Paramus	Bergen Community College
NJ	Trenton	College of New Jersey
NC	Cullowhee	Western Carolina University
ND	Minot	Minot State University
OH	Columbus	Ohio State University
OH	Kent	Kent State University
SC	Charleston	College of Charleston
TN	Knoxville	University of Tennessee
TX	Houston	Houston Community College
VT	Burlington	University of Vermont and State Agricultural College
VA	Richmond	Virginia Commonwealth University
WA	Des Moines	Highline Community College

APPENDIX B

Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities (TPSID) Government Performance and Results Act (GPRA) Measures

A grant recipient must use grant funds to

Establish a model comprehensive transition and postsecondary program for students with intellectual disabilities that:

Serves students with intellectual disabilities;

Provides individual supports and services for the academic and social inclusion of students with intellectual disabilities in academic courses, extracurricular activities, and other aspects of the IHE's regular postsecondary program;

Provides a focus on academic enrichment, socialization, independent living skills, including self-advocacy, and integrated work experiences and career skills that lead to gainful employment;

Integrates person-centered planning in the development of the course of study for each student with an intellectual disability participating in the model program;

Partners with one or more local educational agencies to support students with intellectual disabilities participating in the model program who are still eligible for special education and related services under the IDEA;

Plans for the sustainability of the model program after the end of the grant period;

Creates and offers a meaningful credential for students with intellectual disabilities upon the completion of the model program.

Priority to applicants that form a sustained and meaningful partnership with any relevant agency serving students with intellectual disabilities, such as a vocational rehabilitation agency.

Priority to applicants that demonstrate that their institution of higher education provides institutionally owned or operated housing for students attending the institution that integrate students with intellectual disabilities into the housing offered to all students.

Priority to applicants that involve students attending the institution of higher education who are studying special education, general education, vocational rehabilitation, assistive technology, or related fields in the model program.

This priority is: Applicants that demonstrate that the institution will use TPSID funds to extend or enhance an existing program, rather than supplant other non-federal resources that are allocated to the program. Applicants responding to this priority should describe any existing programs at their institutions, including the number and characteristics of the students served, how well integrated students with intellectual disabilities are in regard to academic courses, extracurricular activities and other aspects of the IHE's regular postsecondary program, and describe how the TPSID grant will build upon current efforts.

APPENDIX C

Glossary of Terms

504 Plan

Spells out the modifications and accommodations that will be needed for students with disabilities to perform at the same level as their peers. Might include such things as wheelchair ramps, un-timed tests, electronically formatted textbooks, preferential seating, or a digital recorder or laptop for taking notes.

Academically inclusive courses

Academically inclusive courses are college or university classes that are a part of the typical college course catalog and are available to all students in the college.

Academically specialized courses

Academically specialized courses are college or university classes that have been designed for, and are only attended by, students with intellectual or developmental disabilities in the TPSIDs.

Accommodations

Changes in an environment to meet the access needs of an individual in accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

Federal legislation that guarantees civil rights protections for people with disabilities and protects them from discrimination on the basis of disability.

The Arc

A national community-based organization advocating for and serving people with intellectual and developmental disabilities and their families.

Assistive technology

Technology that helps individuals with disabilities to participate in activities as independently as possible. This can include “low technology” (e.g., timers, Velcro, calculators) as well as more advanced technology (e.g., wheelchairs, computers, talkers).

Autism

A developmental disability significantly affecting verbal and nonverbal communication and social interaction, generally evident before age three, that adversely affects a child’s educational performance. Other characteristics often associated with autism are engaging in repetitive activities and stereotyped movements, resistance to environmental change or change in daily routines, and unusual responses to sensory experiences.

Community Rehabilitation Providers (CRPs)

Local community organizations that provide services to adults with disabilities. Typically, CRPs provide three main types of day services: (a) employment services leading to integrated employment in the general labor market, (b) work opportunities in a sheltered workshop with other workers with disabilities, or (c) non-work day activities in either a program facility or in the community.

Comprehensive Transition Program (CTP)

CTPs are higher education programs that are able to provide certain forms of Title IV federal student aid to eligible students with intellectual disabilities that attending an approved program.

Credential

Documents that prove a person’s achievements at an institute of higher education (e.g., transcripts or diplomas) or competence/skills in a particular field (e.g., certificates).

Developmental disabilities (DD) councils

Developmental disabilities councils are federally funded, self-governing organizations charged with identifying the most pressing needs of people with developmental disabilities in their state or territory.

Developmental delay

For children from birth to age three (under IDEA Part C) and children from ages three through nine (under IDEA Part B), the term “developmental delay,” as defined by each state, means a delay in one or more of the following areas: physical development, cognitive development, communication, social or emotional development, or adaptive (behavioral) development.

Dual enrollment

Enrolling in postsecondary education and secondary education simultaneously.

Enrollment accommodations

Examples include modified course loads, courses substituted for “required” courses, and priority or early registration.

Federal Work Study (FWS)

Program that provides funds that are earned through part-time employment to assist students in financing the costs of postsecondary education. Hourly wages must not be less than the federal minimum wage.

Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)

A federal law that protects the privacy of student education records. The law applies to all schools that receive funds under an applicable program of the U.S. Department of Education. FERPA gives parents certain rights with respect to their children’s education records. These rights transfer to the student when he or she reaches the age of 18 or attends a school beyond the high school level.

Group paid work

A group of individuals with disabilities working in a particular setting doing the same type of work (e.g., cleaning crew), often making less than minimum wage. Also known as enclaves or mobile work crews.

Group work training site

A work experience for a small group of people with disabilities to receive training but do not receive compensation.

Home and Community-Based Services (HCBS) waiver

Home and Community-Based Services waivers (1915[c] waivers) provide long-term supports to individuals who would receive institutional care without a waiver. HCBS waivers are a way for states to provide long-term care in the community rather than in institutions, and provide states with the flexibility to design a menu of supports that lead to community inclusion and participation.

Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA)

Federal law ensuring services to children with disabilities throughout the nation. IDEA governs how states and public agencies provide early intervention, special education, and related services.

Individualized Education Program (IEP)

Written document that is developed for each public school child who is determined eligible to receive special education services. The IEP is created through a team effort and reviewed at least once a year.

Individual paid job

A person works in the competitive labor market and receives at least minimum wage paid by the employer directly related to the work performed.

Individual work training site

A work experience designed for a single person (as opposed to a group of individuals) to receive job training where the individual is not compensated.

Institute of Higher Education (IHE)

An institution that provides education beyond the secondary level, e.g., an accredited college or university.

Intellectual disability (ID)

A disability characterized by significant limitations both in intellectual functioning and in adaptive behavior, which covers many everyday social and practical skills. This disability originates before the age of 18.

Job coaching

Use of structured intervention techniques to help the employee learn and perform job tasks to the employer's specifications and to learn the interpersonal skills necessary to be accepted as a worker at the job site.

Local Education Agency (LEA)

A public elementary school or secondary school in a city, county, township, school district, or other political subdivision of a state that is recognized as an administrative agency for its public elementary schools or secondary schools.

Medicaid

A government insurance program for people of all ages whose income and resources are insufficient to pay for health care. Medicaid is state-administered and financed by both the states and the Federal Government.

Natural supports

Relationships that are fostered and developed among individuals with disabilities and non-disabled co-workers, classmates, activity participants, neighbors, etc.

Office of Postsecondary Education (OPE)

Federal office that formulates federal postsecondary education policy and administers programs that address critical national needs to increase access to quality postsecondary education.

One-Stop Career Centers (American Job Centers)

Federally sponsored community centers created to serve individuals seeking employment.

Paid internship

A paid supervised work or service experience where the individual has specific goals and reflects on what he or she is learning throughout the experience.

Paratransit

Transportation service for people with disabilities that supplements larger public transit systems by providing individualized rides without fixed routes or timetables.

Planning Alternative Tomorrows with Hope (PATH)

PATH is a planning tool used in a team context, with the focus being on a person with disability who is supported by a planning team to create a vision for their future and plans to achieve that vision.

Person-centered planning (PCP)

Planning that focuses on the individual and his/her interests, strengths, and needs. There are numerous models of this type of planning available (e.g., Whole Life Planning, MAPS, Essential Lifestyles Planning, COACH).

Personal Futures Planning (PFP)

PFP is a planning process to guide futures planning for people with disabilities. It supports activities to identify personal preferences, goals, and helps planning teams create plans to assist in achieving those goals.

Plans for Achieving Self Support (PASS)

A Social Security Administration work incentive policy that allows a person with a disability to set aside otherwise countable income and/or resources for a specific period of time in order to achieve a work goal.

Self-advocacy

The ability of people with disabilities to speak up and ask for what they want and need, on behalf of themselves and others.

Self-determination

The skills needed to understand and address one's wants and needs through decision-making, problem-solving, and goal-setting.

Service learning

Service learning is a method of practical education that links academic learning with student service that provides a benefit to the community.

Sheltered workshop

A facility offering employment to people with disabilities in a largely segregated context. Some individuals may earn a sub-minimum wage and receive continuous job-related supports and supervision.

Specific learning disability

A specific learning disability is a condition giving rise to difficulties in acquiring knowledge and skills to the level expected of those of the same age, especially when not associated with a physical disability.

State Education Agencies (SEAs)

The government agencies within each U.S. state responsible for providing information, resources, and technical assistance on educational matters to schools and residents.

State intellectual and developmental (IDD) services agencies

The state agency or department that funds and manages services for individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities.

Transition-age youth

According to IDEA 2004, the legal definition of transition-age youth is:

(VIII) beginning not later than the first IEP to be in effect when the child is 16, and updated annually thereafter--(aa) appropriate measurable postsecondary goals based upon age appropriate transition assessments related to training, education, employment, and, where appropriate, independent living skills;

(bb) the transition services (including courses of study) needed to assist the child in reaching those goals; and

(cc) beginning not later than 1 year before the child reaches the age of majority under State law, a statement that the child has been informed of the child's rights under this title, if any, that will transfer to the child on reaching the age of majority under section 615(m).

Universal Design for Learning (UDL)

A scientifically valid framework for guiding educational practice that (a) provides flexibility in the ways information is presented, in the ways students respond or demonstrate knowledge and skills, and in the ways students are engaged; and (b) reduces barriers in instruction, provides appropriate accommodations, supports, and challenges, and maintains high achievement expectations for all students, including students with disabilities and students who are limited English proficient. The intent is to provide instruction that is usable to the greatest extent possible by everyone, regardless of their age, ability, or status in life.

University Centers for Excellence in Developmental Disabilities (UCEDDs)

Originally created to serve people with developmental disabilities, UCEDDs are a resource for Americans with a wide range of disabilities. Each UCEDD is affiliated with a major research university and serves as a resource for all people in the areas of education, research, and service relative to the needs of people with developmental disabilities.

Vocational rehabilitation (VR) agencies

Federally funded agencies that support a wide range of services to help individuals with disabilities prepare for and engage in gainful employment. Priority must be given to individuals with the most significant disabilities if a state is unable to serve all eligible individuals.

APPENDIX D

Statutory Language and Definitions Pertaining to the TPSID Programs from the Higher Education Act of 1965 as amended by the Higher Education Opportunities Act of 2008

(Sections 766-769, 20 USC 1140f-1140i)

Institution of Higher Education. For purposes of this Act, other than title IV, the term ‘institution of higher education’ means an educational institution in any State that--

(1) admits as regular students only persons having a certificate of graduation from a school providing secondary education, or the recognized equivalent of such a certificate or persons who meet the requirements of section 484(d)(3);

(2) is legally authorized within such State to provide a program of education beyond secondary education;

(3) provides an educational program for which the institution awards a bachelor’s degree or provides not less than a 2-year program that is acceptable for full credit toward such a degree or awards a degree that is acceptable for admission to a graduate or professional degree program, subject to review and approval by the Secretary;

(4) is a public or other nonprofit institution; and

(5) is accredited by a nationally recognized accrediting agency or association, or if not so accredited, is an institution that has been granted preaccreditation status by such an agency or association that has been recognized by the Secretary for the granting of pre accreditation status, and the Secretary has determined that there is satisfactory assurance that the institution will meet the accreditation standards of such an agency or association within a reasonable time.

(b) ADDITIONAL INSTITUTIONS INCLUDED.—For purposes of this Act, other than title IV, the term “institution of higher education” also includes—

(1) any school that provides not less than a 1-year program of training to prepare students for gainful employment in a recognized occupation and that meets the provision of paragraphs (1), (2), (4), and (5) of subsection (a); and

(2) a public or nonprofit private educational institution in any State that, in lieu of the requirements in subsection (a)(1), admits as regular students individuals—

(A) who are beyond the age of compulsory school attendance in the State in which the institution is located; or

(B) who will be dually or concurrently enrolled in the institution and a secondary school.

(Sec 101. General Definition of an Institution of Higher Education (http://frwebgate.access.gpo.gov/cgi-bin/getdoc.cgi?bname=110_cong_public_laws&docid=f:publ315.110)).

Person Centered Planning (PCP). Person Centered Planning is a way of helping people to think about what they want now and in the future. It is about supporting people to plan their lives, work towards their goals and get the right support. It is a collection of tools and approaches based upon a set of shared values that can be used to plan with a person - not for them. Planning should build the person’s circle of support and involve all the people who are important in that person’s life.

Person Centered Planning is built on the values of inclusion and looks at what support a person needs to be included and involved in their community. Person centered approaches offer an alternative to traditional types of planning which are

based upon the medical model of disability and which are set up to assess need, allocate services and make decisions for people www.inclusive-solutions.com/pcplanning.asp).

Student with an Intellectual Disability. The term ‘student with an intellectual disability’ means a student—

(A) with mental retardation or a cognitive impairment, characterized by significant limitations in—

(i) intellectual and cognitive functioning; and

(ii) adaptive behavior as expressed in conceptual, social, and practical adaptive skills; and

(B) who is currently, or was formerly, eligible for a free appropriate public education under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (section 760 (20 U.S.C. 1140 sec 760 (2) http://frwebgate.access.gpo.gov/cgi-bin/getdoc.cgi?dbname=110_cong_public_laws&docid=f:publ315.110.pdf).

Comprehensive transition and postsecondary program for students with intellectual disabilities (section 760(I) of the HEA).

The term “comprehensive transition and postsecondary program for students with intellectual disabilities” means a degree, certificate, or nondegree program that meets each of the following:

(A) Is offered by an institution of higher education.

(B) Is designed to support students with intellectual disabilities who are seeking to continue academic, career and technical, and independent living instruction at an institution of higher education in order to prepare for gainful employment.

(C) Includes an advising and curriculum structure.

(D) Requires students with intellectual disabilities to participate on not less than a half-time basis as determined by the institution, with such participation focusing on academic components, and occurring through one or more of the following activities:

(i) Regular enrollment in credit-bearing courses with nondisabled students offered by the institution.

(ii) Auditing or participating in courses with nondisabled students offered by the institution for which the student does not receive regular academic credit.

(iii) Enrollment in noncredit-bearing, nondegree courses with nondisabled students.

(iv) Participation in internships or work-based training in settings with nondisabled individuals.

(E) Requires students with intellectual disabilities to be socially and academically integrated with non-disabled students to the maximum extent possible.

Notes

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